CHENNAI - TUESDAY - SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

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YouTube

From Diwali recipes to trending looks

Turn living-room views into festive business growth



Maggi

Drove **25%** incremental reach over TV by adding **YouTube on Connected TV**

NYKAA FASHION

Drove **8.5%** more orders with **YouTube on Connected TV**

Spark brand discovery this festive season

Simulated UI for creative purposes. Results may vary. Some elements edited or created with AI

Drive festive business growth

YouTube



#1

YouTube is the **#1 platform for streaming video content,** outperforming other online platforms[1]

1.98x

YouTube ROI was **1.98x** of linear TV and **1.94x** of OTT platforms[2]

Spark brand discovery this festive season



Sources:
1. Neilsen Gauge Report, US, March 2025
2. Commissioned Analytic Edge MMM Meta Analysis 2021-2025

*Some elements edited or created with AI

CHENNAI - TUESDAY - SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

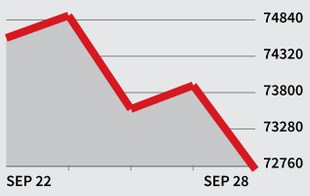
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SENSEX 72771.72 (-1124.02)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	22780.25	-360.25
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.32	-0.30
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.98	+0.17
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147387.00	-4117
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	223053.00	-9297



CRUDE SHOCK.
Markets sink to six-month low on Monday as oil shock wipes out ₹7.5 lakh crore in investor wealth **p6**

MDR ISSUE.
SC refuses plea for interim stay on MDR, but asks Centre, RBI and NPCI to reply within 4 weeks **p2**

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QUICKLY.

GAINING MOMENTUM

Manufacturing, power lift IIP growth to 8% in Aug



New Delhi: Driven by strong gains in manufacturing and electricity, India's factory output grew by 8 per cent in August, up from a revised 7.4 per cent in July, according to government data released on Monday. Experts anticipate this upward momentum will bolster overall economic growth for the July-September quarter. **p3**

MASTER PLAN

Delhi steps up winter pollution curbs from Nov

New Delhi: New Delhi will enforce 'Winter Pollution Master Plan' from November 1, to combat seasonal air pollution. Key rules include 'No Pollution Under Control Certificate, No Fuel', restrictions on non-Delhi BS-VI vehicles, 50 per cent work-from-home for offices, doubled parking charges and construction curbs. The measures will remain in force through February. **p11**

Noel Tata moots merger of 2 group firms with Tata Sons to keep it private

BIG REJIG. Move will reduce Tata Sons' income from financial assets, investments below RBI cap for NBFC classification

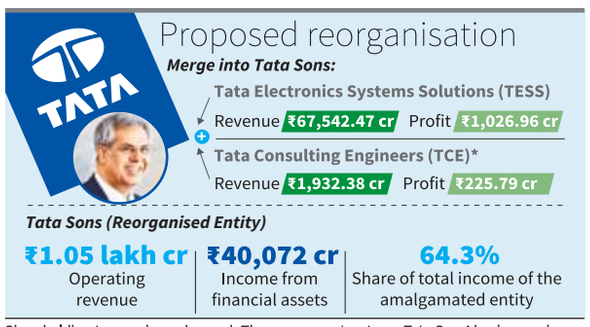
Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata has proposed the merger of two Tata Group companies with Tata Sons Private Ltd (TSPL) in an effort to keep the holding company private and outside the ambit of the Reserve Bank of India's regulations governing upper-layer non-banking financial companies.

The proposed restructuring involves the merger of Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Private Ltd (TESS) and Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE), both wholly owned subsidiaries of Tata Sons, into TSPL.

Tata submitted the proposal to Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran on Monday evening. A copy has also been forwarded to the RBI for its records.

The move comes weeks after the RBI, on September 11, rejected Tata Sons' request to be declassified as an unregistered core investment company (CIC). The decision effectively keeps alive the requirement for Tata Sons to list its shares, an issue that has exposed differences between the company's board and its principal shareholder, Tata Trusts.



Shareholding to remain unchanged: The merger restructures Tata Sons' business mix, not its ownership. Tata Trusts will continue to hold about 66% of Tata Sons.
*Standalone result Source: FY26 Tata Sons Annual Report

PROPOSED MERGER

Under the proposal, the merger would reduce the proportion of TSPL's income derived from financial assets and investments in group companies below the RBI prescribed threshold for classification as an NBFC-UL and a CIC. Tata Trusts argued that the restructuring would restore Tata Sons to its earlier model of functioning as both an operating and holding company.

Farokh Subedar, Advisor to Tata Trusts, said the Trusts had identified TESS and TCE as the most suitable candidates for the merger because it was the "cleanest option", although Tata Sons could consider other entities as well. While securing the approval of Tata Sons and its board could prove challenging, Subedar said he believes it would be difficult for the RBI to reject the proposal.

To qualify for exclusion from the RBI's regulatory framework, the businesses being merged must contribute a minimum level of revenue and assets. "We are looking at wholly-owned subsidiaries so that there is no impact on the shareholding structure of Tata Sons," Subedar said.

As on March 2026, TESS, which manufactures Apple iPhones in India, reported a revenue of ₹67,542.47 crore and a profit of ₹1,026.96 crore, and engineering consultancy firm TCE (standalone) ₹1,932.38 crore and ₹225.79 crore, respectively. Their inclusion would substantially increase the operating income and business assets of Tata Sons.

"The proposed strategic reorganisation of TSPL's business and operations is not a new pathway. For nearly 80 of its 100 years of existence, Tata Sons has had operating businesses and operating revenues that enabled it to fund new ventures," Tata Trusts said in a statement. As recently as 2004, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) operated as a business division of Tata Sons before being demerged into a separate subsidiary. Several other operating businesses were also housed within Tata Sons in the past.

OPERATING MODEL

According to Tata Trusts, the proposed reorganisation would restore Tata Sons to its earlier operating model, under which it generated its own revenues while also functioning as the holding company of the Tata Group.

The merged entity would have an operating revenue of ₹1.05 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026, significantly exceeding its income from financial assets of ₹40,072 crore, which would account for 64.3 per cent of total income. As a result, Tata Trusts argues, the amalgamated entity would fail the "principal business" test required for NBFC classification.

Similarly, the entity would not qualify as a CIC. Its aggregate net assets would stand at ₹2,00,158 crore, of which investments in group companies would amount to ₹1,77,120 crore, representing less than 90 per cent of total net assets, thereby falling outside the regulatory threshold applicable to CICs.

Tata Trusts maintains that the restructuring is a legitimate and historically consistent solution that would allow Tata Sons to remain unlisted while aligning its business profile with RBI regulations.

Also read **p7**

India shifts to West Asian oil as Russian supplies narrow

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



Russian arrivals eased to 1.75 mb/d in September

India's crude oil imports averaged 5.3 million barrels per day (mb/d) so far in September as refiners procured costly West Asian cargoes amidst shrinking supplies from Russia.

Indian imports were up roughly 6,00,000 b/d m-o-m and 7,00,000 b/d y-o-y as refinery maintenance eased and crude runs remained strong, oil analytics firm Kpler said.

Russian arrivals eased to around 1.75 mb/d in September, the lowest since April's 1.58 mb/d. In the intervening months, the Russian arrivals had ballooned — May 1.95 mb/d, June 2.6 mb/d, July 2.8 mb/d and August 2 mb/d — before falling to 1.75 mb/d in September. Trade sources said that Russian supply, particularly the ESPO grade, had narrowed as China continued to import significant volumes in September for the third month running.

Sumit Ritolia, Kpler's Lead Research Analyst for Refining and Modelling, told *businessline:* "The biggest offset has come from the Middle East, with imports rising to around 3 mb/d in September, broadly returning to pre-war levels. The recovery has been supported by higher flows from Iraq, Kuwait and Saudi Arabia, alongside improved movement via Hormuz."

SUPPLY SHIFT

Ship-to-ship transfers and other logistical arrangements facilitated these flows, allowing Indian refiners to rebuild Middle Eastern purchases as regional supply improves, he said.

Traders said that since late-May/early-June, the UAE had used VLCCs to move crude out of the Strait of Hormuz using the Oman channel. The crude is then transferred to other vessels. Saudi Arabia and Iraq are also using a similar strategy.

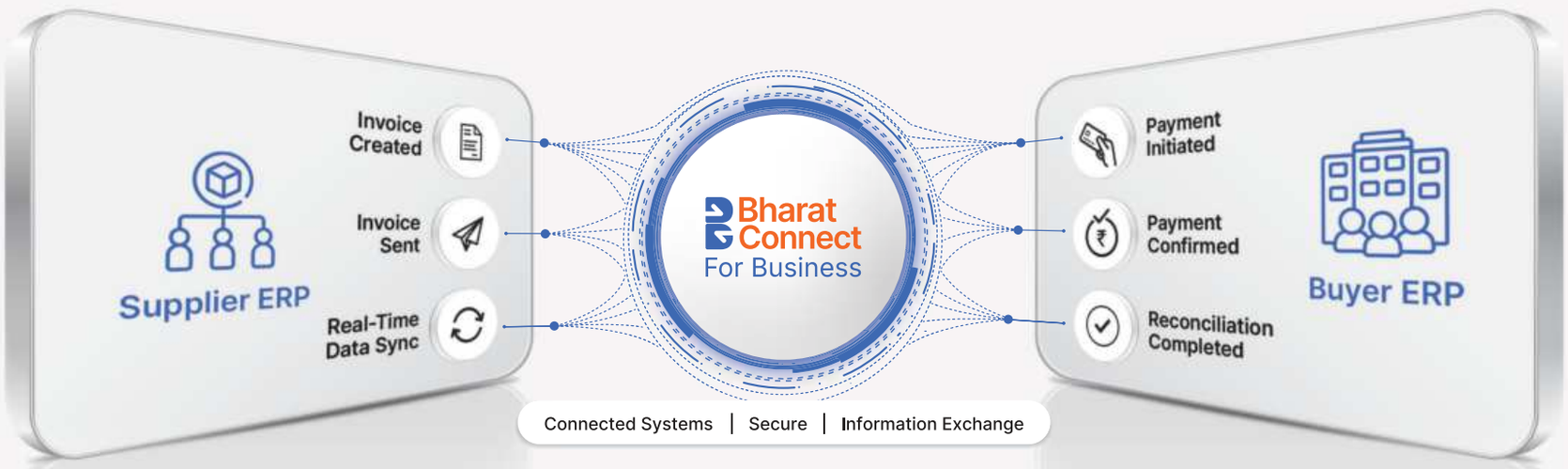
Ritolia said African and Venezuelan barrels were contributing to India's diversification. Overall, September highlights the flexibility of refiners to switch between suppliers depending on economics, availability and logistical risks.

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Dalmia Cement to ship raw materials in e-trucks



Chennai: Dalmia Cement (Bharat) Ltd, in collaboration with Delhi-based SwitchLabs Automobiles Pvt Ltd and Energy In Motion Ltd, has announced the deployment of 24 heavy-duty electric trucks to transport bulk raw materials from the Karaikal port to its manufacturing units in Tamil Nadu. The fleet is estimated to avoid approximately 3,735 tonnes of CO_2 emissions annually on a life-cycle emissions basis. OUR BUREAU

Switch Mobility secures order for 840 e-buses

Chennai: Switch Mobility Ltd, a part of the Hinduja Group, has secured an order for 840 electric buses from Antony Road Transport Solutions under the PM E-Drive scheme phase-1 tender. Under the order, Switch Mobility will supply equal numbers of 9-metre and 12-metre AC electric buses. The order reflects the increasing adoption of e-buses for public transportation, driven by the need for efficient, sustainable and commercially viable mobility solutions. OUR BUREAU

Explain character of MDR: Apex court tells Centre

NEXT ACT. Refuses plea for interim stay, but asks govt, RBI, NPCI to reply within 4 weeks

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned the government's legal authority to "expropriate" 0.4 per cent charge on merchants for specified UPI person-to-merchant transactions in excess of ₹2,000.

NOT TAX, NOT FEE...

A three-judge Bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, issued notice to the Union of India, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) on a petition alleging that the UPI merchant discount rate (MDR) charges would trigger a return to cash transactions and the bane of black money.

But the apex court refused petitioner Anjan Datta's repeated pleas to grant an interim stay on the implementation of the September 14 notification. MDR charges are set to be implemented from October 15.

"We are on the legal incidence of your notification. If it is not a tax or fee, what is its the executive scope of making this expropriation? We want an explanation in an affidavit... If not a fee, what is its character?" Justice Joymalya Bagchi asked Additional Solicitor General N Venkataraman, appearing for the Centre.



THE PLEA. The petitioner, Anjan Datta, challenged the constitutional validity of the amended Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 PTI

WHAT THE GOVT SAID

According to the government, an MDR of 0.4 per cent will be introduced on person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000. For transactions of ₹75,000 and above, the MDR would be capped at ₹300 per transaction.

Venkataraman submitted that the charges would touch a "scarce, thin" population.

"This [UPI MDR charges] is yet to come. It is likely to come on October 15. I have to say that 96 per cent of people using the gateway are exempted. Amongst the remaining 4 per cent, essential services are capped at ₹5. There is also a value cap: Any threshold to the merchant beyond ₹75,000 is capped at ₹300. Collection charges are less than half per cent with all these limitations," Venkataraman submitted.

But the law officer said the MDR charges would be limited to only the aggregators and banks.

The government hardly had a role, he said.

"Aggregators and the banks are the entities who ensure that instantaneous credit and debit happen to avoid cash transactions on the economy; it is their ecosystem. They alone operate there. The government does not take anything. This is a purely administrative mechanism. The government is several steps away from this money," Venkararaman submitted.

The Bench gave the respondents four weeks to file their counter affidavits.

UNGUIDED POWERS

The petition has also challenged the constitutional validity of the amended Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, alleging that it gave unguided powers to the Executive to decide which electronic payment modes would receive the no-charge protection.

In this context, the petitioner pointed out that the no-charge protection for RuPay debit cards would continue without a monetary ceiling.

Levying MDR will lead to ₹7,000-9,000 crore annual burden for FMCG distributors, retailers: Industry body

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The All India Consumer Products Distributors Federation (AICPDF) on Monday said the imposition of MDR on UPI transactions will lead to an annual burden of ₹7,000-9,000 crore on the FMCG distribution and retail ecosystem.

This will be a significant burden for a sector where distributors and retailers operate on relatively thin margins and where the ability to pass additional transaction costs onto consumers is extremely limited, said the industry body.

THE BACKBONE

The Federation said its distributor and retailer network, through respective trade associations and local markets, will participate in the October 2 observance to highlight concerns regarding the proposed levy of MDR. It said it will support the "No UPI Day" call.

The AICPDF represents approximately 4.5 lakh distributors and 1.3 crore retailers across India.



HUGE NETWORK. The AICPDF represents nearly 4.5 lakh distributors and 1.3 crore retailers across India ALLEN EGENUSE J

Stating that India's general-trade network remains the backbone of mass grocery distribution, the industry body said the economic impact of MDR therefore, needs to be assessed not merely transaction by transaction, but across the entire FMCG supply chain.

The broad range of margins, it pointed out, are to the tune of 3.5-6 per cent for general FMCG, with actual margins varying substantially by category, brand and commercial terms.

'NOT AGAINST UPI'

"We are not against UPI or digital payments. UPI has become an important part of India's business ecosystem, and our trade has embraced it extensively. Our concern is the cumulative economic impact of MDR on a distribution system that operates on very thin margins," said Dhairyashil H Patil, National President of AICPDF.

"In FMCG, there can potentially be two points of impact. The consumer makes a payment to the retailer, and subsequently, the retailer makes a payment to the distributor," he said.

"If both eligible transactions attract MDR, the same FMCG sales cycle can carry a payment cost at two levels. When this is multiplied across the enormous volume of FMCG transactions taking place every day, the cumulative impact becomes substantial."

"For a retailer operating on a narrow gross margin, even a small payment-related charge can become an additional operating expense when multiplied across thousands of transactions," the industry body added.

Referring to B2B payments, AICPDF estimates that approximately 40-45 per cent of payments received by distributors from retailers could potentially fall within the relevant higher-value transaction category.

"Consequently, the federation believes that the same FMCG sales cycle can potentially create an additional cost at both the retail payment stage and the distributor payment stage," it added.

THE TAX WORRY

AICPDF also raised concerns about the tax component associated with payment-service charges.

"Where GST is applicable to the underlying payment service/MDR, the effective cost to the business can be higher than the headline MDR itself. The precise GST treatment and input tax credit position can vary depending on the nature of the service and the taxpayer's circumstances; therefore, the AICPDF is seeking clarity on the complete tax incidence associated with MDR."

"The FMCG trade operates on thin margins and under an MRP-based pricing structure. Retailers and distributors cannot simply increase the consumer price to recover every additional operating cost. Therefore, we believe that the impact of MDR on the actual earnings of the trade deserves serious consideration," Patil said.

Market-share cap on UPI apps runs into enforcement hurdle

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

The government's deadline to enforce the 30 per cent market-share cap on individual UPI apps is approaching. But with PhonePe and Google Pay accounting for nearly 80 per cent of transactions, it underscores the difficulty of redistributing share in a highly scaled and habitual payments market.

The cap, proposed in 2020, has already faced multiple extensions, with the latest deadline set for December 31, 2026. Industry executives said the challenge is not a lack of intent but the difficulty of changing entrenched consumer and merchant behaviour without disrupting UPI adoption.

'A BLUNT TOOL'

"UPI is fully interoperable. Any app can pay any QR code, and a user can switch apps in a minute. Yet very few people switch," said Ankur Choudhary, Co-Founder and CEO, Belong.

Trust, merchant distribution and economics have helped the leading apps retain their positions, he said. "The 30 per cent cap is also a blunt tool. Enforcing it means telling the two largest apps to stop onboarding new users."

◉ THE LARGEST PLAYERS

UPI's scale and habitual usage have created a natural advantage for PhonePe, Google Pay

Kushal Bhagia, Founder and Partner, All in Capital, said UPI's scale and habitual usage had created a natural advantage for the largest platforms through their user bases, merchant acceptance, brand recall and transaction data. "The fact that PhonePe and Google Pay still accounted for around 79 per cent of UPI transactions in May 2026, despite the proposed cap, shows how difficult it is to redistribute share through regulation alone," Bhagia said.

For MobiKwik Co-Founder Bipin Preet Singh, the market-share redistribution remains desirable, but the bigger question is how the cap can actually be enforced.

NO NEED FOR DELAY

"There is no reason that this market-share discussion needs to be delayed anymore. But the exact mechanics of it, I do not know how they will be able to enforce it," Singh said.

He said repeated delays could make the eventual target harder to achieve as leading platforms continue adding users. Smaller players could gain from measures focused on new users or greater participation in NPCI's decision-making.

Meanwhile, the introduction of MDR could give smaller apps an opportunity to fund user acquisition and build payments into a standalone business. Bhagia, however, said they will still need differentiated use cases or distribution channels to overcome the behavioural advantage of incumbents.

AI PCs will drive next phase of enterprise computing: Dell

bl.interview

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

As enterprises move from experimenting with AI to deploying it at scale, the personal computer is emerging as an increasingly important part of the AI stack. As per a Dell Internal Study, the global PC landscape is poised for a seismic shift as AI PCs are projected to dominate the market, with 98 per cent of all PCs expected to feature AI capabilities by 2028.

Rob Bruckner, President of Commercial Client Solutions at Dell Technologies, argues that AI PCs will reshape enterprise productivity, data sovereignty, and the economics of AI workloads, while enabling more intelligence to run locally rather than in the cloud.

Edited excerpts:

> For us, it's not just about selling the product, but whether customers and users are getting value from it
>
> **ROB BRUCKNER**
> President, Commercial Client Solutions



Can you highlight some noteworthy developments within Dell?

On the client side, we've been improving our roadmap — that's table stakes; every OEM is doing that. Our emphasis is on covering all the different price points while maintaining a strong value proposition around AI capability.

We think of AI in two broad domains. One is the agentic domain — running things on the device. We call this our desktop agentic AI, and these are fixed products. These products are provisioned with more GPU/AI capability and memory.

On the everyday PC side, we're pushing to make sure AI features are present across every price band for a few reasons. Currently, all modern silicon from Intel and AMD now includes AI features as standard. With an AI PC, you're getting the best of performance, battery life, and security. Then there's the AI capability itself — the neural processing unit, which has been maturing; it's a purpose-built, low-power engine, useful for security workloads and autonomous endpoint management.

We're confident the total-cost-of-ownership value of AI pays for the PC and more.

How has enterprise adoption of AI PCs evolved over the past year?

Adoption keeps increasing, but the real question is how well customers are maximising the value of that capability. For us, it's not just about selling the product, but whether customers and users are getting value from it. Right now, AI is simply the latest technology in any PC, so some customers are buying it without specifically buying for the AI feature — they want better battery life, performance, and snappiness. So it's hard to separate purchases made for "the latest technology" from purchases made specifically for AI. People are buying the new technology with an implicit AI investment, knowing the value will unlock over time. The real measure of AI's value will come from how much that capability gets used for productivity.

How has India as a market evolved recently?

The number of small and medium businesses in India is remarkable, alongside large enterprises that have partnered with Dell for decades.

With the traditional PC, change was incremental. AI brings larger benefits, depending on whether you're a small, medium, or large enterprise. Some are AI-native and moving fast because they see it as a competitive advantage; others are further along but not yet locked into new processes.

With Dell's consumer PC segment reportedly slowing, did commercial demand offset the decline?

Commercial has stayed strong throughout. Consumer has held up well too.

We often develop technology on the consumer side first — it's a slightly more aggressive, faster-moving market — and then find the right home for it across consumer and commercial. We cross-promote some of this technology; for instance, we think the XPS line can work well for a commercial executive too.

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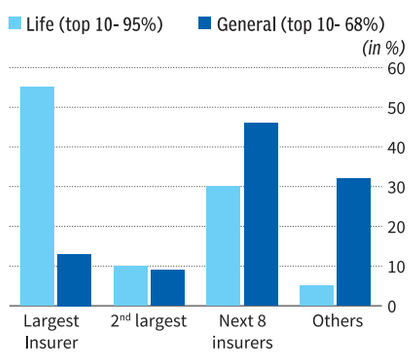
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Rationale for reform

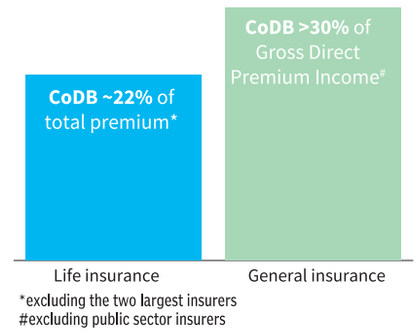
IRDAI's September 2026 consultation paper on insurance distribution reforms points to a sector where premiums have grown, but coverage has not kept pace with the economy, while distribution costs and commissions have risen. Data show high concentration in the industry, leading to high costs of doing business (CoDB). Moreover, faster growth in distributor remuneration and sales-based commission promotes mis-selling, resulting in weak persistency, providing the case for shifting incentives toward policyholder value.

Top heavy insurance industry...

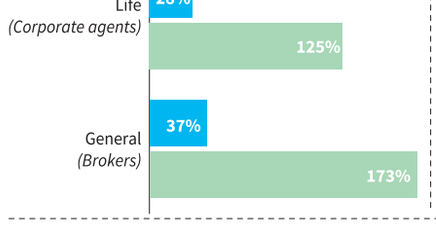
Composition of market share (based on premium)



...increasing the overall CoDB of these companies

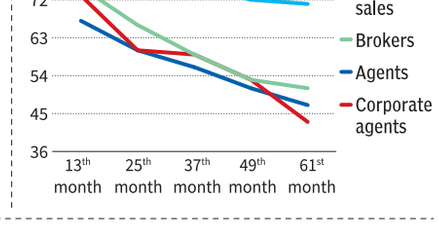


Distributor remuneration is growing 4-5x faster than premium (FY23-FY25)



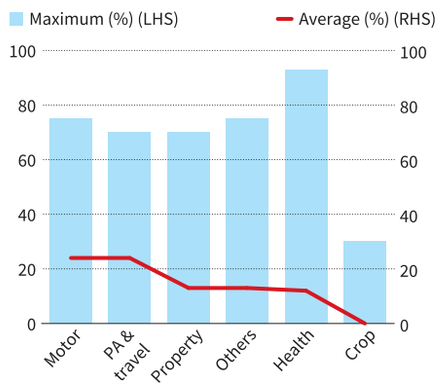
Mis-selling leading to low persistency across channels

Channel-wise persistency based on the number of policies



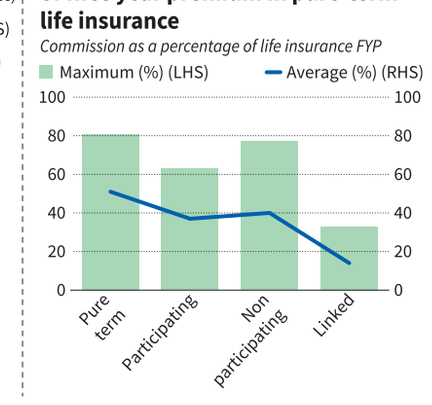
High commission trends across products

Commission as a percentage of GDPI, FY25 (General insurance)



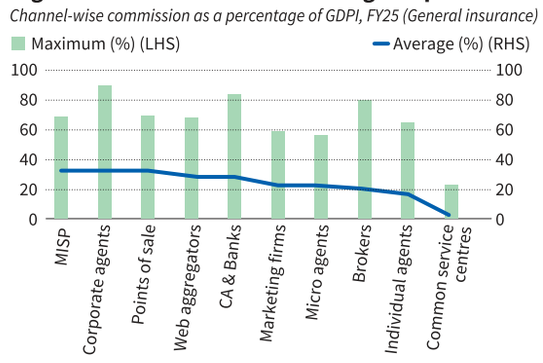
Commissions form more than half of first-year premium in pure-term life insurance

Commission as a percentage of life insurance FYP



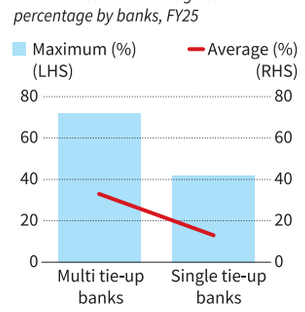
Higher payouts are given to large and more organised distributors constraining competition

Channel-wise commission as a percentage of GDPI, FY25 (General insurance)



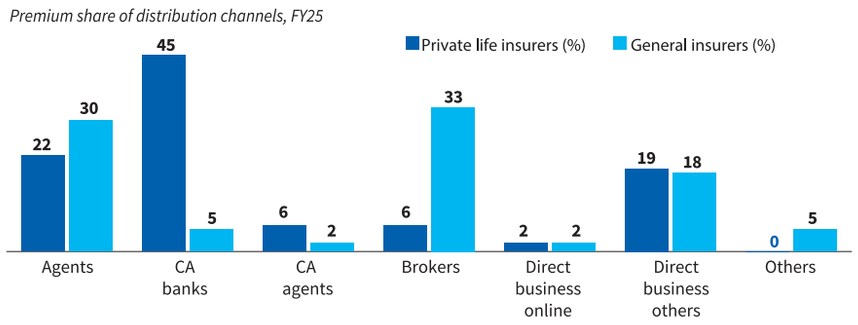
Multi-bank tie-ups have significantly higher payouts

New life insurance average commission percentage by banks, FY25



Banks have the largest premium share across distribution channels

Premium share of distribution channels, FY25



Source: IRDAI

Industrial output grows 8% in August

MIXED BAG. Manufacturing, power sectors expand; mining contracts

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



Driven by strong gains in manufacturing and electricity, factory output grew by 8 per cent in August, up from a revised 7.4 per cent in July, according to government data released on Monday. Experts anticipate that this upward momentum will bolster the overall economic growth for the July-September quarter.

"In August, the Index of Industrial Production recorded an 8 per cent year-on-year growth, supported by 9 per cent growth in the manufacturing sector and strong growth of 12.3 per cent in the electricity & gas supply sector," an official statement said. However, the mining and quarrying sector contracted by 5.6 per cent in August against 15.8 per cent growth a year ago.

Industrial growth

(2026/In %)

Sector	July	August
Mining & quarrying	-0.9	-5.6
Manufacturing	8.2	9.0
Electricity & gas supply	8.7	12.3
Water supply, sewerage and waste management	7.4	6.3
General	7.4	8.0

Source: MoSPI

KEY CONTRIBUTORS

Within the manufacturing sector, 18 out of 23 industry groups recorded growth in August over the same month last year. The top three positive contributors for the month are 'manufacture of motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers' (25.2 per cent), 'manufacture of electrical equipment' (30.9 per cent) and 'manufacture of other transport equipment' (25.3 per cent).

Under the 'manufacture of motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers' item groups, auto parts, spares and accessories, passenger cars, and commercial vehicles have shown significant contribution in growth.

According to Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda, manufacturing did well with growth of 9 per cent and was driven by motor vehicles, machinery (both electric and non-electric), electronics, textiles, beverages, rubber and non-metallic products. The push seen in infrastructure is revealed in the sector-wise growth rates. The auto industry has contributed in both the entry level and premium segments.

POSITIVE SIGN

"The industries which underperformed chemicals with negative growth were affected by the energy prices issue due to the war. Apparel was affected by exports as were pharmaceuticals," he said, adding that while mining had de-grown, the category of minerals, including rare earths, did well this month, registering growth of 5 per cent. "The revival in industrial growth is a positive sign as this has been witnessed in the last few months. Growth in credit to industry has also been very high and broad-based, supporting the hypothesis of the sector recovering quite rapidly this year to contribute positively to overall growth," Sabnavis said.

Rahul Agrawal, Principal Economist at ICRA Ltd, said that only two of the six use-based segments, namely consumer non-durables and intermediate goods, witnessed an uptick in their y-o-y performance in August as compared to July. However, three of the six segments witnessed double-digit growth in the month.

"IIP growth has averaged at 7.7 per cent in July-August, up from 6.2 per cent in Q1 FY2027, suggesting that industrial volume growth has remained strong in these months, which should partly offset the likely impact of margin pressure stemming from the renewed surge in global commodity prices on Q2 GDP growth," he said.

Govt will not let things go out of control: Oil Minister

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri on Monday said the Centre has so far successfully navigated the crude and natural gas disruptions caused by the blockade in the Strait of Hormuz, and even as the global situation remains volatile, the government will not let things go out of control, going ahead.

"I would say we have insulated ourselves from the turbulence, but going forward also constitutes a challenge," Puri said at an event organised by industry body MCCI.

"But I can assure you, we won't let things get out of control," he said. Referring to the uncertainty caused by the geopolitical turmoil on energy security, the minister said that it is turbulence, not uncertainty. The duty before the government was to insulate 1.4 billion people from energy price fluctuations.

Global energy prices had gone up by more than 70 per cent, while that in India was much lower, the minister said. "This was because of the resolution of the Prime Minister, whose mantra was to ensure availability and affordability. The prices of petrol and diesel were slashed thrice by reducing the excise duties," he said.

IEW WEEK

"The Prime Minister's policies have led to an increase in LPG connections from 14 crore in 2014 to 33 crore 50 lakhs in 2026. Now, if you think that one connection serves four people in a household, you have got the entire population of the country covered by LPG connection," the Minister said.



Hardeep Singh Puri, Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas

Puri, along with West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, on Monday formally announced Kolkata as the host city for India Energy Week (IEW) 2027. "West Bengal brings together industrial strength, port infrastructure, skilled manpower, and healthier refining and petrochemical capacity, while Kolkata provides a natural gateway to Bangladesh, Nepal, and Bhutan. Bringing IEW to Kolkata is therefore about connecting India's global energy platform with a region that has an important role to play in India's next phase of energy growth," the Minister said.

Making its debut in Kolkata from January 28 to 31, 2027 under the theme "Unlocking Innovation. Securing Energy. Shaping Tomorrow," the fifth edition of IEW, will serve as the first major global energy conclave of the year, bringing together policymakers, energy leaders, technology innovators, investors and industry stakeholders from across the world to explore pathways to strengthen global energy security and advance sustainability. The Chief Minister said IOCL had sought 175 acres of land at Haldia for its expansion. "Haldia Development Authority has 85 acres; we are talking with the port authorities for additional land," he said.

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APPOINTMENT

NaBFID National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development
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Human Resources Department, Mumbai
www.nabfid.org

RECRUITMENT OF VICE PRESIDENT (ON CONTRACT) - CHIEF INFORMATION SECURITY OFFICER (CISO)

National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development, set up under an Act of Parliament, 2021, is the principal entity for infrastructure financing in the country. The entity is regulated and supervised as an All-India Financial Institution (AIFI) by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Institution is poised to play an extremely crucial role in supporting infrastructure funding by driving the development of innovative financing instruments and development of bond and derivatives markets and promoting best practices in financing and data-driven risk management.

Online Applications are invited from Indian Citizens for engagement on contract as per details given below:

S.No.	Post / Grade	Advt. No.	Vacancy
1	Vice President- Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)	NaBFID/REC/VP/2026-27/02	01 (UR)

1. For eligibility criteria (age, experience, job profile etc.), vacancy and other details, please visit the Bank's website **https://nabfid.org/careers** or **scan the QR code.**
2. Refer detailed advertisement to ensure eligibility and other details before applying. Application starts from **29/09/2026.**
3. Remuneration will be offered based on qualification, experience, suitability, last drawn salary, market benchmark, as per advertisement. For other information, please refer detailed advertisement on the Banks website.
4. Any addendum / corrigendum / modification in this regard will ONLY be available on the Institution's website.
5. Selection will be solely at the discretion of the Bank, and its decision will be final.

Mumbai
Executive Vice President (HR)

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Double Stack Container Train on Dedicated Freight Corridor



Specialized Tank Containers for Bulk Cement Loading



Road Transportation through LNG Trucks



Global Shipping Services

Shri Ajit Kumar Panda
Chairman and Managing Director

EXCERPTS FROM CHAIRMAN'S SPEECH AT 38th AGM OF CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
Held on 28.09.2026

Dear Fellow Shareholders,

Good afternoon and a very warm welcome to each one of you to the 38th Annual General Meeting of your Company. At the outset, I am very happy to state that your company, with its strong performance, continues to retain its position as the undisputed market leader in India's rail logistics sector.

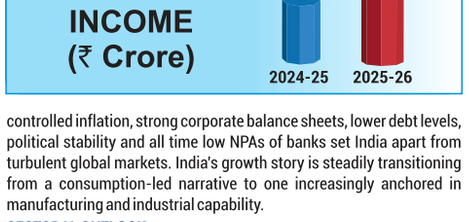
BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT AND ECONOMIC SCENARIO

At present, the World is at the crossroads of extraordinary uncertainties with various geopolitical conflicts and tensions. There is growing tendency of protectionism by nations, lack of trust and weaponisation of trade and supply chain.

On the other hand with the progressive Government policies for inclusive development, rising consumption, disposable income, credit growth, demographics advantage and competitive business environment, our Country is well positioned to face any challenge. The Indian economy has continued to demonstrate remarkable resilience with GDP growth of 7.1% achieved for 2024-25 and an estimate of 7.7% for 2025–26. The GDP growth of 7.8% in the first quarter of the current year establishes that India remains a growth engine for the world economy.

Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi ji has said and I quote "Today, India is the world's fastest-growing major economy. We are in a position to help lift the world out of slow growth."

The progress across several underlying economic indicators like controlled inflation, strong corporate balance sheets, lower debt levels, political stability and all time low NPAs of banks set India apart from turbulent global markets. India's growth story is steadily transitioning from a consumption-led narrative to one increasingly anchored in manufacturing and industrial capability.



SECTORAL OUTLOOK

The Government's commitment for infrastructure-led growth is continuing with budgetary allocation of Rs. 12.2 lakh crores in 2026-27, including Rs. 2.78 lakh crores for Railways. India's ranking in world logistics performance index has improved from 54 in 2014 to 38 in 2023 and the target is to reach 25 by 2030.

Indian Railways' originating loading of cargo rose to 1,669.9 million tonnes in FY 2025-26, a growth of 3.3% over the previous year, while containerised cargo carried by rail increased to 93.7 million tonnes, up by 5.6%. Container handling across all Indian ports touched 24.8 million TEUs registering healthy growth of 6.5% over the previous year.

The most significant development of the year has been the long awaited commissioning of 1506 km long Western DFC. It has enabled movement of Double Stack Container (DSC) trains with higher axle load, faster access of northern hinterland and development of industries and new terminals along the DFC. A new DFC connecting Dankuni in East to Surat in West has been announced in the Budget 2026.

Rate rationalisations have been done for moving bulk cement in tank containers and for fertilizer, fly ash, food grains and salt. A single unified license regime for Container Train Operators has been notified.

It is estimated that, the per ton km cost of movement of goods by rail is Rs.1.96 vs 3.78 by road and CO_2 emission per ton km by rail is 11.5 gm vs 101 gm by road. The Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFCs) and assured transit time trains are moving goods faster now. Thus, rail transportation, when duly supported by conducive infrastructure offers distinct advantages over road in terms of cost, speed and environment and hence it is bound for gaining market share.

Your Company continues to place itself firmly at the intersection of above growth drivers deepening its business and creating enduring value for all its stakeholders

PERFORMANCE HIGHLIGHTS

On the operational front, your Company handled highest ever throughput of 5.58 million TEUs during 2025 -26 , registering a growth of 9.56% over the previous year. The EXIM growth was 8% and domestic 14.6%. CONCOR's share of containerised cargo carried by rail rose to 51.02 million tonnes, up 2.82% over the previous year.

In financial terms, total income was the highest ever at Rs.9,443 crores. The net consolidated profit for the year stood at Rs.1,246 crores. Despite rising competition, it is gratifying that business efficiency has improved resulting in better operating margins.

I am of the firm belief that logistics is a sunrise sector and your company is firmly positioned to capitalize on many emerging business opportunities. To further expand the infrastructure, capital expenditure of Rs.1,085 crores has been incurred during FY 2025-26 on expansion of its terminal network, acquisition of indigenous wagons, containers, handling equipment and expanding IT systems.

Your company has a strong balance sheet to support its sustainable future growth. At the end of the year, the net worth of the Company was Rs.13,052 crores. In keeping with the consistent policy of rewarding our shareholders, dividend was paid every quarter totalling to Rs.8.6 per shares (i.e.172%) and amounting to Rs.655 crores, which is 53.6% of net profit.

STRATEGIES AND INITIATIVES

Your Company followed a focused approach and took many business initiatives during the year thereby strengthening its market position:

- New terminals developed at Mandalgarh in Rajasthan, Kadakola in Karnataka & Jajpur and Paradip in Odisha have started contributing to business. The terminals being set up at Salawas in Rajasthan and Charodi in Gurajat on Western DFC will improve double stack running.
- During 2025-26, CONCOR has operated 6,396 Double-stack container trains.
- Double Stack Container Train services have started directly between JNPT and our terminals at Dadri, Khatuwas and Varnama.
- In a significant step towards strengthening Atmanirbhar Bharat in the global logistics landscape, movement of export-import cargo in our own containers to overseas destinations has commenced. The company has developed its Shipping platform issuing Bill of Lading.
- Movement of 9.15 lakh TEUs was done through our own first mile and last mile services which is around 44% of the FMLM potential .
- CONCOR commenced assured transit time train services between Delhi and Kolkata and Bangalore and Delhi.
- Parcel train services commenced between Bhiwandi, Mumbai to Sankrail, Kolkata.
- Aushadhi Express, India's first dedicated refrigerated freight train service was launched to transport temperature-sensitive pharmaceutical cargo from Hyderabad to JNPT.
- Business Solution Services were provided with volumes of 41,030 TEUs during the year. This covers services like customs clearance, fumigation, palletization, lashing, clearance of containers and cargo bound for Bangladesh and Nepal.
- Air cargo business has been operationalised through CONCOR terminals at ICD Dadri and Ludhiana.
- Sonik Goods Shed, near Lucknow is being developed to cater to the burgeoning logistics needs of the Kanpur and Lucknow region.



- CONCOR sourced 79.13% of our procurements from Micro and Small Enterprises.
- The Company continues to be at the forefront of transition to sustainable logistics with 95% of cargo being moved by rail; thereby saving CO_2 emission of around 4 million ton during the year.
- 230 LNG Trucks have been procured and two LNG stations have been established at Dadri and Khatuwas.
- As part of a broader shift toward cleaner, quieter and more efficient yard operations, seven Electric Reach Stackers and two Electric Trucks & Trailers have been commissioned.
- Roof top solar power is being used at Barhi, Dadri and Kanakpura terminals and at the Corporate Office.
- AI/ML based terminal management system has been put at TKD enabling automated yard operations, real-time container tracking and smart rail handling and optimising gate-in/gate-out.
- GPS enabled tracking and predictive analytics is being deployed to improve train planning, container inventory management, faster movement and demand forecasting.

Our strategies and actions on the ground are fully aligned with the nation's vision of developing a world-class logistics ecosystem.

SUBSIDIARIES, JOINT VENTURES AND ALLIANCES

CONCOR has four Subsidiaries and eleven Joint Ventures doing businesses in the fields of sea port operations, last-mile connectivity, container freight stations, air cargo and cold-chain logistics. These entities have consistently contributed to our growth. The contribution of the subsidiaries and Joint Ventures in the profit of the company during the year was Rs.24 crores.

In order to tap huge potential in Shipping and to achieve the vision of the Government, during the year MOU has been signed for setting up Bharat Container Shipping Line (BCSL) in association with the Shipping Corporation of India, three major Port Authorities and Sagarmala Finance Corporation where CONCOR will have 30% share.

New alliances for optimal utilization of infrastructure as well as for expansion of business have been made through various MOUs / agreements:

TECHNOLOGY AND STANDARDISATION

All commercial and finance functions of the Company are system driven and are providing real time information for faster decision making. We are at the forefront of adopting new technology for the desired result. Some of our initiatives in this respect include:



- Electronic filing of documents extended to all EXIM terminals.
- Enterprise Dashboard functioning for Rake Monitoring.
- Customer interfaces strengthened through a dedicated web server and mobile app.
- Tools such as Know Your Container Location (KYCL), e-tendering and the First Mile–Last Mile (FMLM) mobile app continue to streamline operations and contribute to ease of doing business.
- Double Stack Loading Plan (DSLP) system has improved train loading leading to higher utilization and reduced rail haulage cost.
- Disaster recovery site and stand by systems at primary sites have been setup for commercial and business sensitive applications.

HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

Doug Conant said and I qoute "To win in the marketplace you must first win in the workplace."

Your Company continues to regard its human capital as its greatest strength. The business is run by a lean and committed team of 1,238 CONCORians with a ratio of staff cost to revenue merely 5.73%.

Continuous in-house programmes, specialized and on-the-job learning has helped employees strengthen their capabilities and adapt to changing business needs.

CONCOR remains committed to building an inclusive workplace with women in leadership role heading Areas and key functions like banking, HR and terminal operations. The Company continues to invest in the physical and mental well-being of its team through workplace yoga and fitness facilities, participation in marathons and sports events.

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

Corporate governance, ethics and transparency continue to be deeply embedded in your Company's functioning underpinned by robust internal controls, clear delegation of authority and a strong culture of disclosure and accountability. There are robust systems and procedures in place so as to have efficient management of business and transparency and compliance in all functions.

During the year 2024-25, the Company has been rated "Outstanding" by the Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) on Corporate Governance parameters and in MOU performance it was rated 'Very Good'. The 'AAA' credit rating for the Non-Fund Based Facilities has been reaffirmed by ICRA, reflecting continued confidence in our financial strength and governance standards. On the financial statements for 2025-26 there are no audit qualifications and C&AG of India has issued nil comments.

Your Company's performance and leadership continue to be recognised through several prestigious awards and accolades received during the year.

SUSTAINABILITY AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Your Company continues to conduct its business in a socially and environmentally responsible manner deepening its adoption of energy-efficient and ecofriendly systems and transportation solutions.

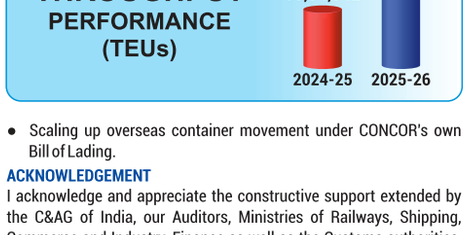
We firmly believe in the principles of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam which teaches us that World is one family and the responsibility to protect our mother earth rests with all of us. We have touched the lives of more than 1.25 million people during the year and spent an amount of Rs.40.59 crore through various CSR programs.

WAY FORWARD

We are working tirelessly to make our country a Viksit Bharat by 2047 coinciding with the centennial of our independence. Our dream is that India will emerge as a leading global power offering its citizens high standards of living and ensuring equitable growth for all. In today's World, a nation of 1.4 billion people is not merely a statistic but a wellspring of skill, ambition and enterprise.

With a strong asset base at present of 68 terminals, 444 rakes, 58,000, containers, and 232 LNG/EV trucks and a capable and committed team, your Company is well placed to retain its leadership position in the sector. Today, CONCOR stands stronger, more agile and uniquely placed to capitalize on numerous emerging opportunities in the logistics sector. With our motto of **"Think Logistics, Think CONCOR"** we remain steadfast in our commitment to innovate, serve with purpose and be a partner in the growth of our country. In our pursuit for relentless growth we shall focus on the following objectives.

- Expanding our terminal network to 100 and count of rakes and containers to 500 & 70,000 respectively .
- Diversification into new business verticals and extensive use of technology.
- Capturing new opportunities arising from the expected growth in EXIM and domestic container volumes with full commissioning of two DFCs.
- Promoting double stack trains and providing end-to-end logistics solutions.
- Rationalization of haulage charges to attract light weight cargo.
- Capturing bulk cement and liquid cargo in tank containers.
- Taping potential in shipping, air cargo and cold chain logistics.
- Expanding Green Logistics solutions and bouquet of value-added services.
- Operating 100% of FMLM throughput under our own first mile and last mile services.



- Scaling up overseas container movement under CONCOR's own Bill of Lading.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge and appreciate the constructive support extended by the C&AG of India, our Auditors, Ministries of Railways, Shipping, Commerce and Industry, Finance as well as the Customs authorities, various State Governments, JV partners, value-chain partners, customers and regulators.

I extend my deepest appreciation to all shareholders for their continued trust and support and my sincere gratitude to my fellow Board members for their guidance and contributions. My heartfelt thanks are due to Team CONCOR whose sincerity and hard work continue to carry your Company to new heights.

I pray for the well-being of all of us and of our beloved Nation.

Thank You. Jai Hind.

28th September, 2026
New Delhi

Ajit Kumar Panda
Chairman and Managing Director
(DIN: 08221385)

Note: This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the 38th Annual General Meeting of the Company.

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
(CIN: L63011DL1988GOI030915)
Regd. Office & Investor Relations Centre: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, Opp. Apollo Hospital, New Delhi-110076
Email: investorrelations@concorindia.com
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the hindu businessline.
TUESDAY - SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

Omissions and commissions

Insurance distribution reforms must be expedited

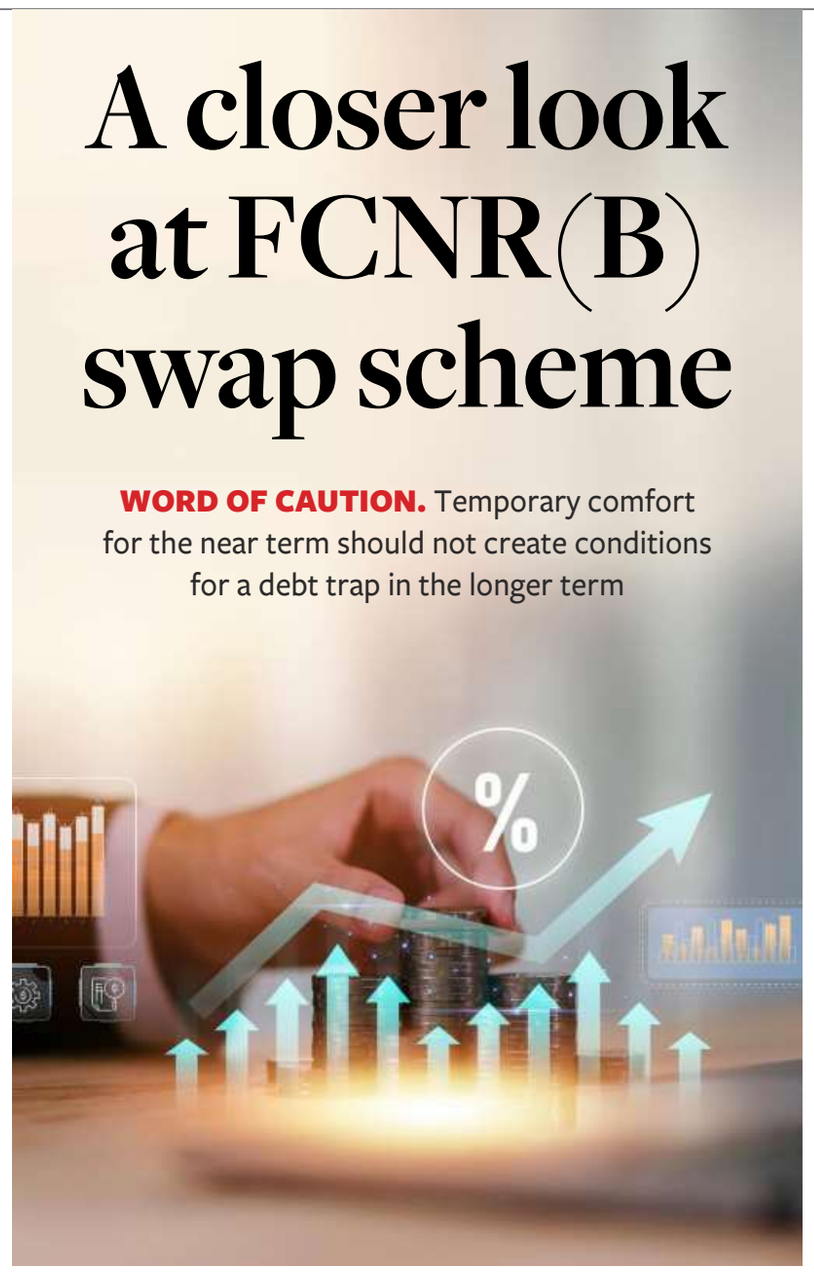
India's insurance sector, the tenth largest globally, has been plagued by low penetration, inordinately high payouts to distributors, mis-selling of policies and poor persistency ratios. The Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha Act, 2025, seeks to introduce reforms while expanding coverage.

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India released a consultation paper last week, taking this agenda forward. The consultation paper is loaded with data that lays threadbare how insurers are milking a small group of policyholders, without making any effort to grow the market or reach the under-served informal MSME sectors. Large commission payouts are reducing the risk and return pools available to policyholders. While new business premiums grew 28 per cent from FY23 to FY25, total distributor remuneration increased 125 per cent in the same period. Commissions now account for 27 per cent of first year premium. Many of the policies are opened along with loans from banks and NBFCs, where the commissions can go up to 45 per cent. The regulator is right in suggesting strict steps to check malpractices. The reforms in 2023 had scrapped category-level commission limits, and had instead introduced Expenses of Management framework (which imposed a limit on the overall expenses of insurers, including operational and marketing costs based on gross premiums collected). But distribution commissions have continued to surge, reaching all-time highs now.

The paper is now suggesting a glide path for EoM to move down to 10 per cent in five years for life insurers and to 20 per cent in five years for general insurers. The paper is also suggesting exclusion of reinsurance premium from the EoM calculations, which will further reduce the limits available for each insurer. Along with curbs on EoM, the paper suggests limits on commissions in each category of life, health, motor and other insurances for first and renewal premiums. The limits suggested vary according to the channel of purchase, and seek to remove commissions from mandatory policies such as third-party motor insurance. Commissions on insurance bundled with loans have been placed at less than 5 per cent. While these limits appear necessary at present, they can be reviewed after five years and lifted, if the industry exercises restraint and establishes new benchmarks in customer coverage, retention and quality of service. However, category-wise limits may not be ideal as they can erode operational freedom.

Effective monitoring and implementation of these rules will, however, be critical. While the paper proposes cost audits of all insurers and distributors earning commission over ₹100 crore, the IRDAI should set up an audit and surveillance department. Those found non-compliant should face a ban on issuing fresh policies for a certain period. Efforts must also be taken to boost awareness among policyholders. Policyholder education and protection funds should be utilised well towards this end.

A closer look at FCNR(B) swap scheme



WORD OF CAUTION. Temporary comfort for the near term should not create conditions for a debt trap in the longer term



RK PATTNAIK

The RBI announced on September 21 that the FCNR(B) swap scheme had received a record inflow of $132.98 billion. This marks never-before capital flows to the external sector in general and to NRI deposits in particular. The numbers are historic and stand at a record level of external debt. The consequences are several and severe: (a) reliance on debt forex reserves to address rupee depreciation and volatility; (b) an adverse impact on RBI's balance sheet; (c) stress on liquidity management on receiving inflows and their redemption when due; (d) stress on the current account deficit (CAD) due to interest payments; (e) stress on repayment at maturity; and (f) an overall adverse macroeconomic impact.

The FCNR(B) swap scheme for deposits with maturities of three to five years was open between June 8 and August 31; it closed a month before the designated date of September 30. The early closure, announced on August 14, was a response to inflows far beyond expectations. Under the scheme, the RBI covers the exchange rate risk on the principal amount: the exchange rate is the same at the first leg (when commercial banks sell dollars received under the scheme to the RBI) and at the second leg (when commercial banks buy the dollars back from the RBI to repay the depositors). The Governor said on June 5 that the swap scheme was intended to strengthen the balance of payments (BoP) position.

DEPRECIATING RUPEE

This came in the context of a steadily depreciating rupee against the US dollar, mainly because of net outflows of foreign portfolio investment (FPI) — $13.7 billion by early June — coupled with prolonged geopolitical tensions arising out of the West Asia conflict.

The INR-US rate touched a peak of 96.8441 on May 20, a depreciation of 13.33 per cent on a year-on-year basis. There was fear of a speculative attack on the rupee, and the market perceived that the rate could touch 100 to the dollar.

To the extent that the objective of the RBI's exchange rate policy is to contain volatility, there was a need to strengthen the BoP position through the accumulation of forex reserves. The scheme was made attractive to both parties to garner inflows. NRIs were offered interest rates well above what they receive in their home countries, with FCNR(B) rates rising to 6-7.5 per cent against a historical 3-4 per cent. Commercial banks were relieved of exchange rate risk, since the RBI swapped the principal at par and bore the full hedging cost, and fresh deposits were also exempt from CRR and SLR.

However, should the authorities have taken the debt route (FCNR(B)) to build forex reserves when reserves stood at about $682 billion? To argue that there are net benefits in the scheme is a misleading half-truth.

According to the available data, outstanding FCNR(B) deposits were $33.756 billion before the introduction of the scheme. Considering $132.98 billion of inflows under the scheme, the outstanding amount now stands at $166.736 billion. In our considered view, since NRIs have already invested substantial amounts, fresh gross inflows may not be sufficient to meet these obligations. Therefore, repayments of around $127 billion will have to be met from forex reserves.

With the addition of about $136 billion (inclusive of ECBs) under the swap window, total debt liability will increase substantially, to about 24-25 per cent of GDP on end-March figures

A tentative cost and return analysis reveals that even though the RBI hedges the forex risk on the principal amount, the interest cost will be a burden on the economy, as the return on investment will be lower than the cost. As reported in the media, banks are paying 6 to 7.5 per cent on these deposits, but the RBI's return on investment in foreign short-term liquid securities will average about 4 per cent (US three-month Treasury bill yield is currently about 4.1 per cent). According to the Governor, 48.5 per cent of the deposits under the scheme are for five years, 42 per cent for three to four years, and the balance of 9 per cent for four to five years. Tentative calculations reveal that the annual interest outgo under the scheme could be about $4.3 billion on the five-year deposits and about $4.2 billion on the rest, or around $8.5 billion a year until the deposits mature.

However, the interest earned on the corresponding reserves is calculated to be around $5 billion. This could result in a net pressure of about $3.5 billion a year on the current account of the BoP, and about $15 billion over the life of the deposits, resulting in higher debt service and CAD.

There is a cost to the RBI's balance sheet. The swaps released upwards of ₹11 lakh crore into the banking system, which the RBI must absorb through the variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) and the Standing Deposit Facility (SDF), at about 5.24 per cent and 5 per cent, respectively. Tentative calculation reveals that on September 11, with about ₹4.05 lakh crore under VRRR and ₹2.77 lakh crore under SDF, the annualised interest outgo from the RBI amounted to ₹21,238.40 crore for VRRR and ₹13,862.45 crore for SDF, or about ₹35,100 crore a year. Every rupee of this eventually reduces the surplus the RBI transfers to the government.

INVESTMENT POSITION

According to international investment position data released by the RBI on June 30, India is a net liability country, with debt liabilities accounting for 56.6 per cent of total external liabilities as on March 31. External debt stood at $762.8 billion, or 20.8 per cent of GDP. With the addition of about $136 billion (inclusive of ECBs) under the swap window, total debt liability will increase substantially, to about 24-25 per cent of GDP on end-March figures, putting pressure on forex reserves when the debt falls due.

The external debt to reserves ratio will not worsen immediately since reserves rise by the same amount, but that is cold comfort. About $53 billion falls due in 2029-30 and $62 billion in mid-2031, and as each tranche enters the final year, it will add to short-term debt by residual maturity, which was already 47.3 per cent of the reserves in March. These developments have adverse macroeconomic implications.

The day of reckoning is not far away when the Indian economy will face the pressure of paying back these debt liabilities. When the 2013 FCNR(B) deposits of about $26 billion were repaid in 2016, the RBI had spent two years building a forward book. This obligation is nearly five times as large. The authorities should be well prepared for this. Temporary comfort for the near term should not create conditions for a nation to sleepwalk into a debt trap in the longer term.

RK Pattnaik is a former central banker and a Professor at the Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics, Pune. (Through The Billion Press).
Views expressed are personal

BRICS should push renewables after oil shocks

Solar module battery prices have fallen sharply. Besides, diversifying oil sourcing cannot work as a hedge against price rise

Vibhuti Garg
Saloni Sachdeva Michael

India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi recently, where the New Delhi Declaration, adopted unanimously, set out positions on energy security, clean technology cooperation and global governance reform.

On energy, it adopted an action plan for a photovoltaic (PV) Industry Working Group and a Solar PV Cooperation Roadmap, endorsed guiding principles on smart grids and energy storage and advanced cooperation on low-emission hydrogen standards.

DEFINING ENERGY SECURITY

These commitments reflect a shift in how BRICS defines energy security. The next step now is closing the gap between renewable capacity and the grids that make it deliverable.

BRICS' 11 members account for 49.5 per cent of the world's population, around 40 per cent of global GDP and 26 per cent of global trade. They are scaling renewable energy rapidly, even as fossil fuels remain embedded in their economies.

Since the West Asia conflict disrupted energy flows through the Strait of Hormuz, fossil fuel-importing economies have borne substantial costs.

Between March and August 2026, importers paid an estimated $330 billion (₹31 lakh crore) more for seaborne crude oil, oil products and LNG than pre-war futures markets had anticipated (CREA report).

BRICS importers bore a significant share, with China and India alone accounting for $35 billion (₹3.3 lakh crore) and $22 billion (₹2.1 lakh crore) of this. Crude prices also surged, and have remained above $100 (₹9,500) per barrel for much of 2026.

The effects extend beyond energy markets, feeding into inflation, borrowing costs, currency stress and weaker investment conditions. Tanker freight rates for oil shipments to India climbed by around 150 per cent, adding to the cost of imported crude. This is not new.

Covid-19, the Russia-Ukraine war, and now the Hormuz crisis mark three major fossil fuel shocks in six years. These are recurring features of a system built on concentrated, geopolitically sensitive supply, making these systemic economic risks, not one-off disruptions. India has expanded crude sourcing to 40 countries, with around 70 per cent of imports now routed from outside the Strait of Hormuz. That buys flexibility, but supplier diversification does not insulate importers from benchmark price shocks.



BRICS. More power needed

Higher freight and insurance on longer routes compound the delivered price. The more durable response is to reduce the amount of imported fossil energy the economy requires.

SHIFT TO RENEWABLES

The economics favours the shift to renewables. Solar module prices have halved, and battery prices have fallen by 36 per cent since 2022 (Ember Energy report). If LNG prices stay 50 per cent above 2025 averages, gas-fired power costs would rise by 32-37 per cent.

By contrast, solar costs will rise by around 3 per cent. For BRICS importers, the transition is no longer just about emissions, but about reducing the systemic vulnerability fossil dependence creates. BRICS members are acting on this. Global Energy Monitor's BRICS data (excluding Saudi Arabia) show solar and wind additions reached a record 497 GW in 2025 (led by China and India), with a utility scale pipeline of 2,317GW, or around 2.5 times the 927GW fossil pipeline.

But the transition remains uneven. The same year saw addition of 125GW of new coal, oil and gas capacity. As a result, BRICS members are still vulnerable to the next shock.

Renewables capacity without grid infrastructure delivers neither reliability nor resilience. Across BRICS nations, this gap is widening. In India, renewable capacity additions amid slower transmission infrastructure deployment, could expose more than 35GW to grid curtailment in FY27. Grid curtailment is a problem in Brazil and China as well. Grid planning, storage deployment and market design at BRICS should move from intent to projects.

Garg is Director, South Asia, at Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis. Michael is Lead Energy Specialist, IEEFA

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

End the wait of bankers

This refers to the news item '3-day Nationwide Bank Strike Called Off' (Sept 28). While this development must have come as a great reprieve for various stakeholders, particularly the non-elite customers, it also becomes incumbent upon the govt to urgently draw the final curtains over the prolonged demand for a 5-day work week. The same has been hanging fire since March 2024. Needless to say, keeping it in limbo for years reveals the government's continued indecisiveness, and does not augur well for its image.

SK Gupta
New Delhi

Advantage for India

Apropos 'US Trade Deal Could Shield India from 100% Tariff Risk' (Sept 28). It would be an oversimplification of the ongoing negotiations to assume that a trade deal would necessarily shield India from any fresh tariff actions that may be taken under the Graham Act. A guarantee of exemption from such fresh tariffs has been one of the demands of India during trade negotiations, but the US has been unwilling to commit. Since there is no guarantee from the US, especially given the rapid and sudden shift in its trade policy, India would have had less leverage in the event of trade deal being completed. India has actually acted prudently by not rushing to conclude a trade deal earlier, as it can now revisit the proposed agreement under negotiations in the light of the new developments on the tariff front.

Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad

Create more awareness

With reference to 'Changing Trends in Retail Participation in G-Secs' (Sept 28), the growing participation of individual investors in government securities deserves encouragement, provided it is accompanied by adequate financial awareness. G-Secs can diversify household portfolios, but investors should understand interest-rate risk, maturity periods and the difference between holding a security to maturity and selling it earlier. Banks, brokers and regulators should provide simple explanation of these risks before encouraging wider participation. Greater transparency on prices, yields, liquidity and transaction costs will also help investors make informed decisions.

SM Jeeva
Chennai

Future of the Tatas

This refers to 'The Schrödinger Cat Problem of the Tatas' (Sept 28). The uncertainty surrounding the future structure of the Tata Group raises a broader question about succession and corporate governance in large business houses. A group with diverse companies and a substantial shareholder base requires clarity without compromising legitimate strategic flexibility. Investors and employees would benefit from timely disclosure of any restructuring plan, its rationale and the proposed governance framework. The distinction between ownership, management and charitable trusts should remain clear.

Abbharna Barathi
Chennai

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US' red salute to China

What to expect after the Trump-Xi meeting

Sridhar Krishnaswami



CHINA AND US. New beginning?

It was simply hard to believe. For a person who has constantly derided Democrats as "Godless communists" and "left wing lunatics", President Donald Trump made sure that Washington DC was red all the way, from the Andrews Air Base carpet to flags lining the route to the White House for his visitor, China's President Xi Jinping. For two days, everything that was said about China in the past was forgotten, with President Xi suddenly becoming a "great gentleman".

As guests were ushered for the grand banquet, no one remembered what President Trump had said in 2015: "We give state dinners to the heads of China... why are you doing state dinners for them? They're ripping us left and right. Just take them to McDonald's and go back to the negotiating table."

JUST POMP AND SPLENDOUR

That is how the Washington summit is panning out — a lot of pomp, splendour and little to show in terms of what had been achieved in politics, economics or strategic matters. The small comfort is that the two countries have agreed to extend their trade truce until January 2027. This must come as a sigh of relief to the Trump administration, which signed the Lindsey Graham Russia, Iran Sanctioning Act of 2026, enabling the President to slap 100 per cent tariff on countries that imports petroleum products from Russia. China tops the list as it imports 50 per cent from Russia.

The Bill gives the President cover under national security waivers, but now the White House can point to the extension of a trade truce as another reason, and target other countries such as India. Few expected the Trump-Xi summit to be on the lines of the pathbreaking Richard Nixon-Mao Zedong meet or the Ronald Reagan-Mikhail Gorbachev get-together, which ushered in a new era in international relations through the opening of US-China ties, or the beginning of the end of the Cold War, leading to the breakup of the Soviet empire.

In the present context, considerable attention was given to AI, amid growing concern in the West over China's race to catch up and surpass in a field that is already clouded with doomsday scenarios. A silver lining coming out of Washington is perhaps a vague understanding that humans ought to retain primacy in artificial or superior intelligence.

And for a President and a Republican Party badly looking for a political lift on the eve of the November 3 mid-terms, there was barely any movement on the Iran war, or efforts to get China to lean on Tehran to end the conflict.

TAIWAN ISSUE

Apparently, Xi and Trump did not spend time on Taiwan, but the Chinese leader used the occasion to urge Washington to be "prudent", to explicitly "oppose" than merely "not support" Taiwan's independence and stop all military sales to Taipei. Taiwan is a concern as Republican and Democratic lawmakers are sensing a drift from established principles reiterated in the past.

In recent months, many have expressed outrage that Washington may go to the extent of saying that the arms package of some $14 billion to Taiwan could be a negotiating chip with China, or essentially giving Beijing a veto over sales. The administration's refrain that there has been no change in Washington's Taiwan policy should come as relief to the Asia Pacific region, which has increasingly become sceptical of the US' commitment to a region that is vital to global economic security.

THE END RESULT

What the two leaders discussed in private may never be known, although there is a general feeling that the two leaders spent more time on ceremonial events. As Danny Russel, a diplomat who served in the Barack Obama administration put it, "pageantry and protocol don't add up to progress. Pandas are cute, but what America needs is rare earths. What we're seeing isn't diplomacy so much as 'diplotainment,' which won't do much to solve the serious problems in the US-China relationship."

The author is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

September 29, 2006

DoT wants Govt to put FDI press note on hold

The Department of Telecom has informed the Union Cabinet that the implementation of Press Note 5, which relates to FDI in telecom, in its current form will severely impact the rollout plans of telecom operators and discourage fresh applications.

BHEL looking at equity option in power projects

Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd is evaluating the option of picking up equity stake in upcoming power projects, especially those incorporating new technology. The company, which has decided to bid jointly with power major NTPC Ltd for the proposed 4,000-MW Sasan ultra-mega power project, is actively looking at the option of picking up minority stake in the project.

50,000 tonne Russian wheat shipment rejected

50,000-tonne Russian wheat consignment has been rejected by the State Trading Corporation (STC) as a higher percentage of "extraneous matter" was found in the cargo, according to a Chennai Port Trust official. The consignment is part of the three lakh tonnes contracted by STC from the Geneva-based Agrico SA in July at $210-212 a tonne.

Trump tariffs — a misadventure

POOR OUTCOME. A year-and-a-half after inception, Trump's tariff war appears to have largely flopped

MACROSCAN



CP CHANDRASEKHAR, JAYATI GHOSH

October 2026 marks a year-and-a-half since President Donald Trump's declaration of April 2, 2025, as Liberation Day. Liberation, presumably, was from an unkept promise by the US that its openness to trade would signal a commitment to the principles of free trade.

Trump's justification for 'reneging' on that false promise was a claim that the main trading partners of the US had resorted to unfair means to invade America's market and protect their own, leading to the bilateral trade deficits that were, actually, the outcome of a loss of trade competitiveness.

The Liberation Day declaration was an announcement that the Trump administration would, as of that day, use tariffs, imposed using the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA), as means of restoring the US' supremacy in global trade. The tariff war started with a baseline tax of 10 per cent on all imports (with some minor exceptions) into the US, and the threat of an additional country-specific reciprocal impost linked to US bilateral trade deficit with individual countries.

The magnitude of the additional impost was to be adjusted based on the willingness of individual countries to negotiate a deal to win lower-than-threatened, across-the-board imposts in return for trade and investment concessions.

TORTUOUS HISTORY

The tariff war has had a tortuous history over the last year-and-a-half, with volatile shifts in both the magnitude and duration of the tariffs imposed. When imposts under the IIEPA were struck down by the US Supreme Court in February 2026 for breaching limits of Presidential authority, they had to be substituted under clauses warranting imposts on account of threats to national security to unfair practices such as intellectual property theft, or use of forced labour to keep down costs. These have been combined with penalties on transshipment exports to the US from countries serving as hosts to foreign firms, evading imposts on exports from their own home countries (such as Chinese firms located in Vietnam) and secondary sanctions on countries importing crude from Russia, for example.

While strategic objectives (including that of ending the trade in Fentanyl) were often invoked, the principal justification for Trump's tariff aggression has been the need to drastically reduce the large trade deficits of a weakening US. But success in the realisation of that objective over the last year-and-a-half has been mixed. A cursory examination of the evidence suggests that Trump appears to have achieved some success. Compared with a $4.6 billion deficit in the trade in goods by the US in the first quarter of 2025 (which preceded Liberation Day), the figures stood well below $3 billion in all subsequent quarters till the second quarter of 2026 (chart 1).

But closer scrutiny suggests that this decline occurred because of a large increase in the deficit, driven by a spike in imports in quarter one of 2025, possibly explained by orders placed in the expectation of a tariff hike. Imports in that quarter rose by more than 25 per cent relative to the corresponding quarter of the previous year, contributing to the surge in the deficit.

Discounting for that effect, the overall deficit decline does not appear to be as significant. What is intriguing is the distribution of the gains from the Trump tariff aggression across countries. There are only five countries that recorded significant increase in the bilateral US trade deficit between the first quarter of 2025 and the second quarter of 2026: Taiwan, Vietnam, Mexico, Malaysia and South Korea (chart 2). Of these, two countries — Taiwan and Vietnam — dominate in terms of registering an increase in bilateral trade surplus vis-a-vis the US in the year-and-a-half since Liberation Day.

On the other hand, vis-à-vis most other significant trade partners, including China, the US has, in fact, registered either a decline in goods trade deficit, or a shift from bilateral deficits to surpluses, or an increase in pre-existing surpluses (chart 3). All of these shifts contributed to the reduction in the overall trade deficit.

OVERALL GAIN

However, despite this improvement in the bilateral trade balance with a majority of trading partners, the overall gain from the tariff war for the US has not been significant. A preliminary scrutiny of the drivers of the deficit with the two principal contributors in terms of a bilateral trade deficit increase (Taiwan and Vietnam) is telling. In both cases two sectors — machinery and mechanical appliances and electrical machinery and equipment — have dominated exports to the US and explained the deficit (charts 4 and 5). In the second quarter of 2026, these two sectors accounted more than 90 per cent of US imports from Taiwan, and more than 70 per cent of US imports from Vietnam.

The composition of imports from Taiwan is understandable, given its historical record as an exporter of components and parts to the US, and especially its leading role as a producer of semiconductors. Given US' dependence on import of semiconductors and the ongoing surge in data centre investments driven by the hype over artificial intelligence, this is to be expected.

The tariff war has had a tortuous history over the last year-and-a-half, with volatile shifts in both the magnitude and duration of tariffs imposed

It is Vietnam, one of the special targets of US aggression, that springs a surprise. US imports from Vietnam have risen from $41.9 billion in the first quarter of 2025 to $66.5 billion in the second quarter of 2026. And that surge has not been driven by traditional labour-intensive exports such as garments, footwear and furniture, which accounted for just 11.5 per cent of US imports from Vietnam in the second quarter of 2026. Rather, the surge has been driven by machinery and equipment, including electrical equipment.

AN EXPORT PLATFORM

These exports from Vietnam are largely the result of foreign firms, including those in China, Korea and Japan, using the country as an export platform for final stage production for US markets. The threat of exceptional transshipment tariffs declared by Trump is clearly proving more difficult to implement than the efforts at limiting imports from traditional trading partners. The magnitude of exports through this route from Vietnam has been large enough to widen the bilateral deficit in the trade in goods of the US with that country.

In sum, two factors seem to have contributed to the overall failure of Trump's tariff war, despite the restriction in imports and reduction in the trade deficit with most countries. One is the dependence on the international semiconductor supply chain in a period characterised by an inexplicable AI-related investment boom. The other is the reliance of the US and its transnational companies on offshore production of equipment, serving both investment and consumption. Vietnam is currently the leader among the last bastions of that trend of globalisation.

CHART 1

Washington's performance

US Trade in Goods *($ million)*

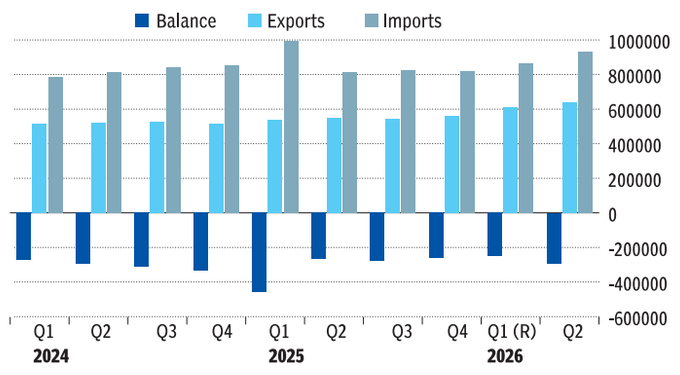


CHART 2

Deficit widens

Top five countries by the worsening of US trade balances between 2025 Q1 and 2026 Q2 *($ million)*

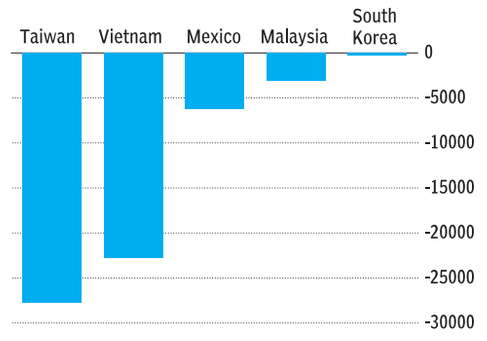


CHART 3

Trade gains

Top ten countries by improvement in US trade balances between 2025 Q1 and 2026 Q2 *($ million)*

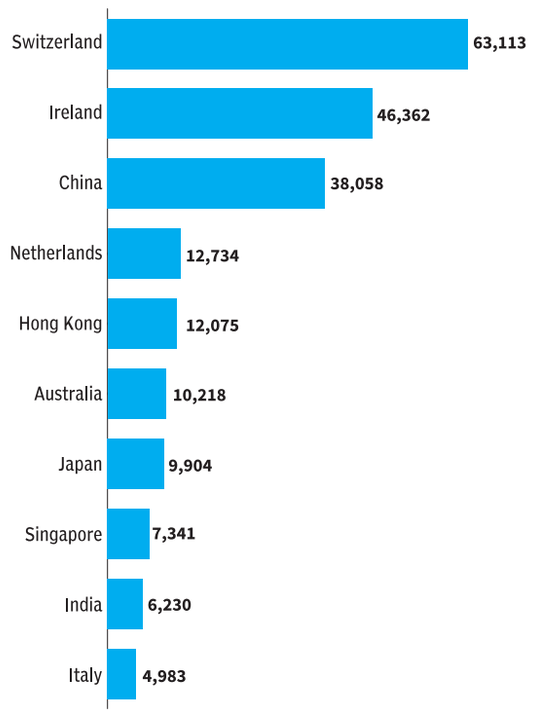


CHART 4

Taiwan angle

Share of US imports from Taiwan by commodity (2026 Q2) *(%)*

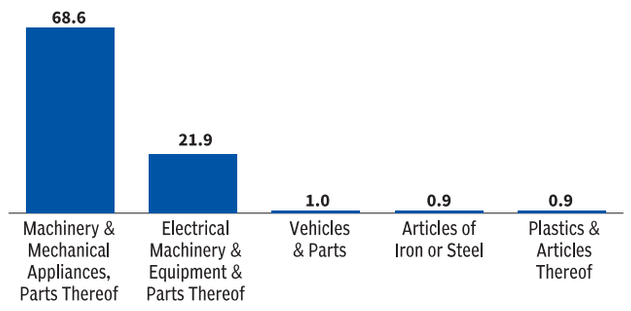
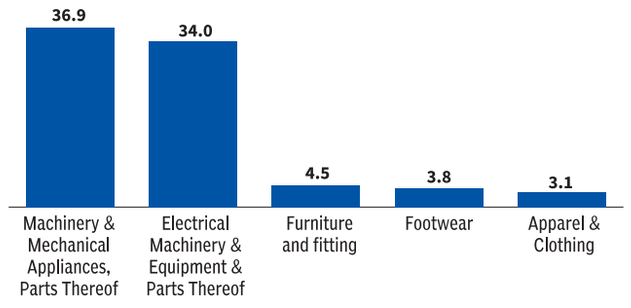


CHART 5

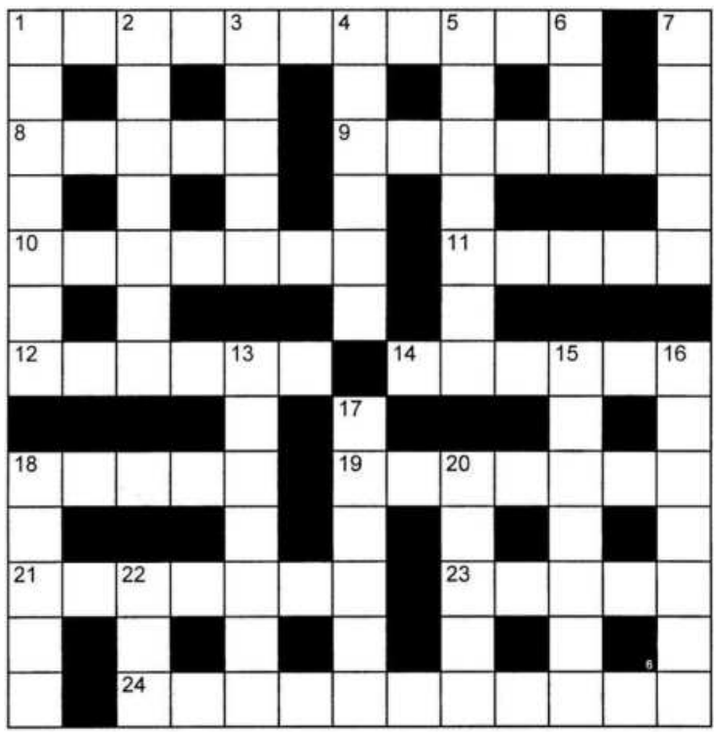
Vietnam connection

Share of US imports from Vietnam by commodity (2026 Q2) *(%)*





BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2745



EASY

ACROSS

1. The A of FA (11)
8. Jockey (5)
9. Leaves of pine trees (7)
10. Bring to naught (7)
11. Irrelevant; foolish (5)
12. Recent, up-to-date (6)
14. A crop-destroying beetle (6)
18. Single-mast, cutter-rigged boat (5)
19. One set to watch on duty (7)
21. The meaning conveyed (7)
23. Belonging to them (5)
24. In an alternative way (11)

DOWN

1. A word, name, of initials (7)
2. Encumbered (7)
3. A Welsh dog (5)
4. Troubles, vexes (6)
5. List out singly (7)
6. No goals (3)
7. Assume as true, postulate (5)
13. A rebuke (7)
15. Using excessive force (7)
16. Form of service in church (7)
17. Sprightly, cheerful (6)
18. With a decided taste (5)
20. Fantastic, extravagant (5)
22. To deliver, free one from (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

1. It has its link with football but not rugger (11)
8. An added clause for one who is up (5)
9. Requires to hold the French hypodermics (7)
10. In fully adapting to it one will make it void (7)
11. It is clumsy, the way it holds the writer back (5)
12. Fashion the Navy has that's up-to-date (6)
14. View the Spanish might take of a sort of beetle (6)
18. Nothing will slosh about in such a light boat (5)
19. The man on watch who will not be introspective (7)
21. The substance of it is, it is almost unadulterated Ruby (7)
23. It isn't our turn to give it her (5)
24. In another way, friendly eft is wriggling out of it (11)

DOWN

1. Corn may have to be replaced by name made up of initials (7)
2. Is ready to ride, being lumbered with it (7)
3. Company taking rig out for a dog (5)
4. Is being a pest in the way any son can (6)
5. One meets one somehow to list things out separately (7)
6. Starts next International lethargically, having no score (3)
7. Postulate that there's one in the mail (5)
13. The traveller goes to the top of the house for a telling-off (7)
15. In a flower, nitrogen is producing strong reactions (7)
16. May be guilty about the right to regular church ritual (7)
17. As merry as the spirit of Shelley's skylark (6)
18. Tasty dip as it is returned (5)
20. An OTT way to tour around the East (5)
22. Get shot of first ring I'd been given (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2744

ACROSS 1. Shard 4. Planted 8. Abolitionists 10. Emery 11. Rink 12. Stoa 16. Imbue 17. Imperturbable 19. Enraged 20. Dwelt

DOWN 1. Sharp practice 2. Ago 3. Driver 4. Poised 5. Annoys 6. Test match 7. Disparagement 9. Sandpaper 13. Oil-rig 14. Abound 15. Webbed 18. Bye

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CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - SEPTEMBER 29 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Adani, group firms settle public float violation cases



SEBI on Monday allowed Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani and four group companies to settle regulatory lapses related to a 25 per cent minimum public shareholding requirement. SEBI said the four Adani companies and 14 company directors, including Adani, settled the proceedings by paying a total of ₹1.48 crore. SEBI said it had received complaints in 2020 against the group's flagship company Adani Enterprises, Adani Power, Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd and Adani Transmission — now known as Adani Energy Solutions — claiming that they were not in compliance with the regulator's minimum public float rules. SEBI, in its notices to the companies and Adani, had alleged violations of the minimum public shareholding requirements and related shareholding disclosure rules, the order said. The settlement order does not require the companies to make any corrective shareholding disclosures, nor does it contain a regulatory finding on the alleged violations. The probe was part of 24 investigations SEBI had undertaken after the US-based short-seller Hindenburg alleged in 2023 that Adani Group companies had manipulated their stock prices through tax havens. The Adani Group had denied the allegations. In the past year, SEBI has allowed the Group to settle several cases, although probes into whether certain offshore investors were used to circumvent rules and whether there was manipulation in the trading of Adani Group shares are still pending. REUTERS

Markets sink to six-month low on oil shock

ALL FALL DOWN. Bear onslaught spares none of the thematic, sectoral, market-cap indices; market value slumps ₹7.52 lakh crore in a single trading session

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Indian equities suffered one of their sharpest sell-offs this year on Monday, with the benchmark indices tumbling to six-month lows amid surging crude oil prices, rising global bond yields and persistent foreign investor outflows. A flare-up in geopolitical tensions in West Asia after US President Donald Trump rejected an Iranian proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz reignited fears of supply disruptions, pushing Brent crude above $108 a barrel and triggering a broad-based risk-off move across global markets.

The Nifty 50 closed at 22,780.25, down 360 points, while the BSE Sensex settled at 72,771.72, shedding 1,124 points. The sell-off dragged both benchmarks to their lowest closing levels in about six months.

The carnage was not confined to Dalal Street. Equities across Asia and emerging markets came under pressure as the oil shock reverberated through global markets. South Korea's Kospi slumped as much as 2.4 per cent and China's CSI 300 fell 1.9 per cent, while MSCI's Asia-Pacific index ex-Japan also traded lower.

Rising crude oil prices, climbing US Treasury yields and fresh concerns over inflation sparked a broad flight from risk assets across emerging markets.

BANKS LEAD SLIDE

Banking stocks bore the brunt of the selling pressure. The Bank Nifty plunged 1,108 points to close at 54,471.65, slipping below the closely watched 55,000 support level. Heavyweights including HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, SBI and Union Bank were among the key drags on the index.

Investors on D-Street lost an estimated ₹7.52 lakh crore in a single trading session, with the overall market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies falling to ₹474.36 lakh crore.

The decline was indiscriminate, with all sectoral, thematic and market-cap indices ending in the red. Nifty PSU Bank emerged as the worst performer, tumbling 3.24 per cent, followed by Realty, down 2.12 per cent, and Financial Services, which lost 2.11 per cent.

Broader markets also came under pressure. The Nifty SmallCap 100 fell 1.85 per cent, while the Nifty MidCap 100 declined 1.63 per cent. Market breadth remained exceptionally weak, with 432 of the 500 stocks in the Nifty 500 universe closing lower.

FPI continued their selling spree, offloading equities worth ₹5,353 crore during the session. Domestic institutions provided some support by purchasing shares worth ₹5,189 crore, but their buying was insufficient to absorb the relentless foreign outflows.

US YIELDS

The latest correction reflects a combination of global and domestic concerns. The US 10-year Treasury yield climbed to 5.23 per cent, its highest since 2007, tightening global financial conditions and weighing on emerging-market assets. India's 10-year government bond yield also rose to 7.12 per cent, reflecting concerns that elevated crude prices could stoke inflationary pressures.

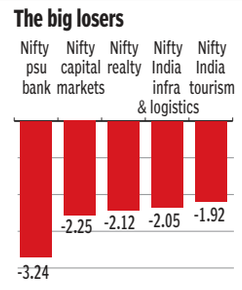
Vinod Nair, Head of Research at Geojit Investments, said foreign investors had been reducing their exposure to India for an extended period as earnings growth had moderated from the strong post-pandemic phase, while elevated crude prices, sticky inflation and the prospect of further rate hikes have clouded the near-term outlook. He said investors should remain cautious, maintain higher cash allocations and selectively accumulate quality large-cap stocks for the long term.

The currency market reflected the broader risk aversion. The rupee weakened further to close near the 96-per-dollar mark, pressured by rising oil prices and sustained foreign fund outflows. The currency has lost nearly ₹1.75 during September, raising concerns about imported inflation.

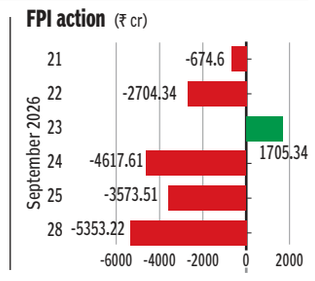
No respite from bears

Index	Current	% change	52 week high	52 week low
Nifty 50	22780.25	-1.56	26373.20	22182.55
Nifty Next 50	70309.5	-2.05	75000.40	59896.10
Nifty bank	54471.65	-1.99	61764.85	49954.85
Nifty 500	22232.15	-1.64	24144.20	20385.65
Nifty midcap 100	59914.20	-1.63	64450.90	52032.85
Nifty smallcap 100	19351.10	-1.85	20187.08	14986.00
India Vix	13.69	12.54	28.91	8.72

The big losers



FPI action (₹ cr)



Gainers 1,271 | On BSE | Losers 3,218

@52-week low: Reliance ₹1,196.05 | HUL ₹1,893.80

As investors bid aggressively, Moneyview IPO subscribed 98x, A-One Steels gets 11 times

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Investor demand

No of times

	QIBs	Non-institutions	Retail	Employee	Total
Moneyview	227.45	115.41	19.57	--	98.46
A-One Steels	7.30	24.51	8.64	4.87	11.61

Source: Exchange

The A-One Steels India and Moneyview IPOs closed after receiving strong demand across all categories on the mainboard. The A-One Steels India IPO received 11.61 times subscription and Moneyview 98.46 times.

A-ONE STEELS

The QIB portion was subscribed 7.3 times, while NIIs subscribed 24.51 times. The retail portion got 8.64 times and the employee portion 4.87 times.

The ₹405-crore IPO came out with a price band of ₹385-405. The IPO comprised a fresh issue worth ₹355 crore and an OFS of up to ₹50 crore. A-One Steels India raised ₹120.9 crore from anchor investors.

The company reduced the issue size from the proposed ₹650 crore in its draft papers filed with the SEBI in December 2024.

Of the net proceeds, ₹250 crore will be used for prepayment or partial repayment of outstanding borrowings, while the remaining funds will be used for general corporate purposes.

MONEYVIEW

The QIB portion of Moneyview was subscribed 227.45 times and the NIIs' 115.41 times. The retail portion received 19.57 times. The ₹1,092-crore IPO had a price band of ₹32-34 a share. Moneyview's IPO comprised a fresh issue worth ₹750 crore and OFS of ₹342 crore.

Moneyview raised ₹327.5 crore from anchor investors ahead of the issue.

Of the ₹750 crore fresh issue proceeds, ₹325 crore will be used to support the company's lending operations, while ₹250 crore will be invested in augmenting the capital base of its NBFC subsidiary.

The remaining funds will be utilised for general corporate purposes.

Hindenberg: SAT disposes of 5 FPI pleas as SEBI agrees to share details

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) on Monday disposed of appeals filed by five foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) named in the Hindenburg Research report on the Adani Group after the Securities and Exchange Board of India agreed to provide them a true copy of the file noting prepared by its adjudicating officer.

Albula Investment Fund, Asia Investment Corporation (Mauritius), LTS Investment Fund, Cresta Fund and APMS Investment Fund had challenged the manner, in which SEBI provided them the opinion formed under Rule 4(3) of the SEBI (Procedure for Holding Inquiry and Imposing Penalties) Rules, 1995. Under Rule 4(3), after considering a noticee's response to a show-cause notice, the adjudicating officer (AO) must form an opinion on whether an inquiry should be held.

FILE DISCLOSURE

The FPIs had sought the complete opinion and the reasons underlying the decision to proceed against them. SEBI had earlier provided a paraphrased extract, while maintaining that the opinion under Rule 4(3) was not an order and could not itself be challenged before SAT.

At Monday's hearing, SEBI's counsel said the regulator was prepared to provide a true copy of the file noting made by the AO, without prejudice to its rights and contentions. The FPI counsel said they were satisfied with the submission. "In view of the above, nothing further survives in these appeals," SAT said while disposing of the cases.

However, SAT did not adjudicate on the underlying regulatory proceedings or make any finding on the conduct of the FPIs in relation to the Adani Group companies.

CleanMax raises ₹2,500 cr via NCDs

Our Bureau
New Delhi



CleanMax said on Monday it has raised ₹2,500 crore through green debt securities (NCDs) on a private placement basis.

The NCD issuance was structured across five series with maturities ranging from 2 years to 10 years and coupons ranging from 8.25 per cent to 8.76 per cent under a fixed rate structure, attracting wide participation from international and domestic investors.

Issued under CleanMax's Green Bond Framework, the bonds are backed by a defined green-use-of-proceeds framework, allocated for largescale renewable energy projects.

SEBI COMPLIANCE

The framework has been independently reviewed by CareEdge Advisory for alignment with applicable SEBI regulations and the ICMA Green Bond Principles, 2025. This was raised through rated, secured, listed, redeemable non-convertible debentures (NCDs) on a private placement basis.

Trust Investment Advisors Private Ltd (TIAPL) acted as the sole arranger for this unique structured NCD issuance-in the C&I renewable energy segment.

INVESTOR INTEREST

The NCDs drew a marquee group of international and domestic institutional investors. The International Finance Corporation, the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development and the India Infrastructure Finance Company anchored the issue, alongside Aditya Birla Capital, IDFC First Bank, Nippon India Mutual Fund and select corporates.

"Green bonds bring together two things that are increasingly linked — capital and climate action. This issuance channels institutional capital towards renewable energy while creating another avenue for investors to participate in CleanMax's growth. The calibre of investors also reflects the confidence in our fundamentals and the predictability of our contracted cash flows," said Kuldeep Jain, MD of CleanMax.

TIAPL partnered with CleanMax to achieve its objective of securing long-term financing at fixed rates while broadening participation from debt capital market investors.

Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas served as the legal counsel for the issuance, while Catalyst Trusteeship Ltd acted as the debenture trustee for the NCD transaction.

"Pricing this issue in the current macro environment with volatile interest rates made the Crisil AA/stable rating especially valuable as it helped us secure a tight spread and lock in fixed-rate funding on our longest tenor of 10 years," said Nikunj Ghodawat, CFO, CleanMax.

BROKER'S CALL.

HDFC Securities

DALMIA BHARAT (BUY)
Target: ₹2,110
CMP: ₹1,651.4

As per our interaction with the Dalmia Bharat management, the cement industry continues to face strong cost headwinds, since players are unable to pass through costs amid competitive pressures. Hence in Q2FY27E, while Dalmia's volume is expected to grow in single-digits year on year, its realisation is estimated to be marginally down quarter on quarter and unit opex should spike by ₹250-300/mt on quarter. These could dent margins to about ₹750/mt (vs ₹1,055/1,013 per mt q-o-q/y-o-y), in our view.

The management noted its central assets will become fully operational in Q3FY27 and is confident of delivering 40 per cent/60 per cent utilisation in Q4FY27/FY28E. The ongoing organic expansion in the South and West is on track and is expected to become operational in phases between Q4FY27 and Q3FY28E, leading to consolidated capacity of 67 mt.

At July-end, Dalmia emerged as the successful resolution applicant for Bhilai Jaypee Cement (BJCL) under CIRP. The assets include 2.2-mt GU in Bhilai (Chhattisgarh) and 1.1-mt clinker unit in Babupur (MP). The company requires final approvals from NCLT, Cuttack, along with other regulatory approvals. We expect cumulative capex of ₹13,500 crore for FY27-29E and expect net debt to EBITDA to peak at 2.5x in FY27E. We build in volume/EBITDA CAGR of 12 per cent/11 per cent for FY26-29E. We maintain BUY on Dalmia Bharat with a revised TP of ₹2,110/share (12x its September 2028E consolidated EBITDA).

Axis Securities

ELECON ENGINEERING (BUY)
Target: ₹505
CMP: ₹480.7

Elecon achieved a record consolidated order-book of ₹1,518 crore along with robust quarterly order inflows of ₹755 crore (+23 per cent year-on-year) during Q1, providing strong multi-quarter revenue visibility. Healthy backlog across both the Gear and MHE divisions supports sustained execution. Furthermore, significant export orders secured towards the end of Q1FY27 are expected to drive stronger revenue recognition from Q2-FY27 onwards.

Overseas revenue outperformed domestic sales, growing 21.9 per cent to ₹151 crore and increasing its contribution to 29 per cent of consolidated revenue from 25 per cent in Q1FY26. The growth was driven by an operational recovery in European subsidiaries, Benzlers and Radicon, along with steady global demand. Recent international wins, including a ₹21-crore overseas port equipment order, highlight Elecon's expanding footprint across international industrial markets.

Despite near-term headwinds, the company's strong order backlog and steady order-inflow outlook across domestic and international markets provide healthy earnings visibility over the medium term. The management expects project execution to improve meaningfully from Q2FY27. Export contribution is expected to increase further over the medium term. Order pipeline continues to remain significantly ahead of revenue growth, strengthening earnings visibility. We value the company at 22x FY28E EPs. We recommend a Buy with a target price of ₹505/share.

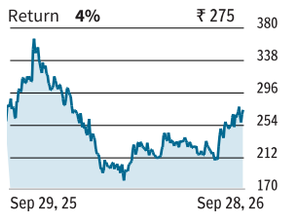
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Parag Milk Foods (₹275): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Parag Milk Foods



The short-term outlook for Parag Milk Foods is bullish. The stock began the week on a positive note, rising over 2 per cent on Monday. This rise followed support from the 21-day moving average (DMA), currently at ₹261. This helps sustain the recent upmove that began in mid-August. Support is in the ₹261-₹255 region, which can limit the downside going forward.

The Parag Milk Foods share price could rise to ₹300-₹305 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Parag Milk Foods shares now at ₹275. Accumulate on dips at ₹264. Keep the stop-loss at ₹252. Trail the stop-loss to ₹279 as soon as the stock rises to ₹284. Revise the stop-loss to ₹285 and ₹292 when the price touches ₹290 and ₹296, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹300.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

22824 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
22740	22600	22910	23000	Go short on a rise at 22860 and 22890 with a stop-loss at 22920

₹719 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
718	710	723	730	Take fresh shorts below 718 with a stop-loss 720

₹1004 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
992	986	1015	1030	Go short on a rise at 1012. Keep the stop-loss at 1022

₹266 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
264	261	268	271	Go short on a break below 264. Keep the stop-loss at 265

₹230 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
227	224	232	234	Go short now and at 231. Stop-loss can be kept at 233

₹1199 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1160	1145	1210	1225	Go short now and at 1205. Keep the stop-loss at 1215

₹962 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
954	945	964	975	Go short now and at 963. Stop-loss can be kept at 965

₹2074 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2065	2040	2100	2120	Go short on a rise at 2085 and 2095 with a stop-loss at 2110

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 360.25 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Dr Reddys Lab	1221.00	2.66	32.01	0.71
Infosys	1003.20	2.30	13.42	3.38
HDFC Life	531.60	0.14	58.08	0.55
Apollo Hosp	8860.00	-0.65	58.65	0.87
Tech Mahindra	1542.20	-0.80	29.27	0.94
HCL Tech	1252.60	-1.24	19.50	1.27
SBI Life	1728.10	-1.36	66.65	0.74
Wipro	161.56	-1.46	12.04	0.42
Maruti Suzuki	12008.00	-1.62	26.34	1.50
Coal India	422.50	-1.88	8.35	0.97
Cipla	1383.70	-1.97	33.31	0.75
Max Healthcare	1000.10	-2.26	66.79	0.71
Asian Paints	2420.00	-2.37	47.99	1.05
Bajaj Finserv	1752.00	-2.40	13.59	0.97
TCS	2070.70	-2.52	14.97	2.03
NestleIndia	1346.00	-2.60	68.10	0.93
JSW Steel	1264.10	-2.64	11.04	1.14
Tata Steel	186.30	-3.02	20.65	1.48
Trent Ltd.	2626.00	-3.15	77.17	0.84
IntGlobeAvi	4874.50	-3.24	0.00	1.06
Sun Pharma	1838.00	-3.29	36.39	1.87
TataConsumerProduct	960.00	-3.30	57.85	0.60
UltraTech Cement	11025.00	-3.36	37.90	1.25
Grasim Ind	3150.00	-3.38	18.84	1.14
Kotak Bank	401.55	-3.94	19.68	2.84
Tata Motors PV	281.75	-3.97	0.00	0.56
Eicher Motors	7213.50	-4.41	34.30	0.95
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	220.50	-4.66	70.46	0.69
ONGC	230.00	-4.97	6.46	0.86
Adani Enter	2831.10	-5.39	49.02	0.78
Shriram Finance Ltd.	976.30	-5.45	20.30	1.31
NTPC	321.10	-5.70	10.99	1.46
Titan	4819.50	-5.82	74.28	1.91
Bajaj Auto	11024.00	-6.22	26.67	1.17
Bharat Elec	385.50	-6.30	45.84	1.32
Eternal Ltd.	330.95	-6.40	737.59	2.30
Hindalco	955.90	-6.68	13.10	1.33
Bajaj Finance	985.00	-6.97	29.70	2.53
Adani Ports	1743.70	-7.14	30.62	1.23
PowerGrid Corp	261.85	-7.57	15.32	1.14
M&M	2995.00	-7.80	18.40	2.56
Axis Bank	1209.90	-7.84	13.47	3.33
ITC	265.20	-8.00	16.46	2.45
Hind Unilever	1896.00	-9.09	42.45	1.61
Bharti Airtel	1771.40	-9.30	29.64	5.17
State Bank	962.00	-18.97	9.90	3.81
L&T	3766.40	-28.08	26.40	4.23
ICICI Bank	1302.00	-38.82	15.63	8.95
Reliance Ind	1197.60	-41.93	18.38	7.76
HDFC Bank	719.05	-55.38	13.42	10.56

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▼ 1,469.15 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Zyduslifesciences	1215.00	8.07	26.62	1.26
Ltimindtree	4091.40	2.27	23.35	1.57
Gail (India)	172.45	-1.96	11.49	1.92
United Spirits	1415.40	-7.21	61.03	1.73
Britannia Ind	4915.00	-7.70	45.35	2.39
Indian Railway Finance Corp	78.55	-8.18	14.28	0.65
Abb India	6972.50	-12.20	95.01	1.51
Pidilitind	1503.00	-12.79	57.16	1.92
Mazagoan Dock	2138.00	-13.60	30.22	0.67
Shree Cement	22170.00	-13.60	48.89	1.23
Godrej Consumer	868.00	-14.01	46.42	1.44
Avenuesuper	3803.50	-14.38	81.14	2.53
Tata Capital	328.10	-16.16	25.42	0.68
Ambuja Cements	374.35	-17.12	17.93	0.96
Bajaj Holdings	10800.00	-17.62	13.37	1.93
Varun Beverages	430.00	-19.07	42.66	2.43
Hindus Zinc	573.00	-22.29	14.19	1.14
Muthootfin	2760.00	-23.37	9.67	1.22
Siemens	3785.50	-23.51	92.79	1.38
Divis Lab	9550.00	-25.67	86.67	5.02
Indian Oilcorp	133.32	-25.84	5.27	2.06
Hyundai Motor India	2050.70	-26.64	33.66	1.21
Jindal Steel	1139.60	-27.13	42.92	1.74
Tata Power	361.90	-27.14	22.00	2.49
Bosch	47020.00	-31.01	58.68	1.69
Siemens Energy India	3189.00	-31.87	76.32	1.17
Power Finance	330.00	-33.85	3.24	1.99
Hindustanaeronautics	4738.00	-34.18	33.99	3.72
Rural Elec	303.25	-35.21	4.98	1.57
Cummins Inida	4855.00	-35.33	56.85	2.71
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1634.20	-35.83	24.22	2.92
Vedanta	259.00	-36.22	6.07	1.82
Dlf	663.55	-36.26	36.94	1.76
Bpcl	302.25	-36.81	7.65	2.53
Macrotech Developers	1117.10	-38.62	27.03	1.28
Punjab Natl Bank	112.60	-40.03	5.85	1.60
Indian Hotels Co.	711.00	-40.32	43.84	2.58
Bank Of Baroda	227.50	-41.84	6.40	1.74
Cg Power & Ind Sol	865.00	-41.85	110.03	2.45
Solar Industries	19150.00	-42.12	84.51	1.93
Canara Bank	120.65	-42.39	5.52	1.68
Tvs Motor Cmp	4095.00	-42.53	54.02	3.98
Samvardhothersoninternatl	162.37	-42.88	37.62	2.96
Hdfc Amc	2302.30	-44.85	33.48	1.94
Union Bank	171.75	-47.45	6.35	1.37
Adani Energy Solutions	1287.90	-48.29	50.06	1.75
Torrent Pharma	4869.00	-50.94	85.90	2.95
Tata Motors Cv	432.95	-51.89	38.08	3.74
Adanigreenenergy	1235.00	-60.02	94.79	1.71
Adani Power	196.14	-79.71	26.03	3.36

Pts: Impact on index movement

Pioneer Fil-Med, 2 others get SEBI nod for IPOs

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Pioneer Fil-Med, Tonbo Imaging India and Functional & Innovative Foods have secured approval from SEBI for their proposed initial public offerings (IPOs), paving the way for the three companies to proceed with their public issue plans.

Pioneer Fil-Med's proposed ₹500 crore IPO comprises a fresh issue worth ₹250 crore and an OFS of ₹250 crore by promoters, according to its draft papers.

Tonbo Imaging India's proposed IPO comprises an OFS of up to 1.81 crore shares, with no fresh issue component. Functional & Innovative Foods' proposed IPO is a combination of a fresh issue of up to 60 lakh shares and an OFS of up to 25 lakh shares by promoter Senthil Kumar Chinnusamy.

Growpital asked to wind up CIS, barred from markets

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

SEBI has ordered the winding-up of Growpital's farmland investment scheme, holding that the platform operated an unauthorised collective investment scheme (CIS) and raised ₹192.88 crore from 5,208 investors.

In its final order passed on Monday, SEBI held all 28 noticees guilty of violating the SEBI Act and regulations and imposed a fine of ₹25 crore on them.

The eight main noticees, including Rituraj Sharma, have been held jointly and severally liable to refund the money with 12 per cent interest, calculated from January 29, 2024. They have also been barred from the securities market for five years or until completion of the refunds. The others have been barred for three years.

Growpital offered investors participation in agricultural projects through LLP structures, promising assured and tax-free returns. Investors were enrolled as LLP partners, but SEBI found that the underlying land agreements were held by Yotta Agro Ventures or its subsidiary, leaving investors without ownership or control over the land.

SEBI found that ₹95.60 crore was transferred from Farm Silo Tech to Yotta without any underlying business, while another ₹8.53 crore was used to acquire Grobanana in Yotta's name.

For refunds, around ₹50 crore already lying in escrow and attached under the interim order will first be distributed among investors in proportion to their outstanding dues. Further recovery will be made from trade and other receivables and assets of the entities.

QUICKLY.

Sun Pharma in pact with LIB Therapeutics



New Delhi: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries has signed an exclusive agreement with the US-based LIB Therapeutics to manufacture, commercialise and globally license Lerodalcibep in all markets outside the US and China. LIB will receive upfront and future milestone payments, along with royalties, the company said. PTI

Deadline for ITR filing by corporates extended

New Delhi: The Income Tax Department on Monday extended the ITR filing deadline for corporates for assessment year 2026-27 till November 21, from October 31. The due date for tax audit report submission has been extended from September 30 to October 21. "Accordingly, the 'specified date' for furnishing of the report of audit under the provisions of the Income-tax Act, 1961 for Assessment Year 2026-27, in the case of such persons, stands extended to October 21," it added. PTI

El Nino effect: India's coal imports may rise in Oct-Dec

BOOSTING SUPPLY. Coal generation rose to 114 terawatt-hour in August, up nearly 14%

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Coal in stock

	DCB stocks (MT)	ICB stocks (MT)	DCBs with critical stocks*	ICBs with critical stocks*
September 21	20.30	2.44	67	7
September 22	20.15	2.45	68	7
September 23	19.95	2.46	67	8
September 24	19.81	2.50	70	8
September 25	19.67	2.52	64	8
September 26	19.47	2.52	67	8
September 27	19.30	2.55	72	8

Source: Coal Ministry, Power Ministry; DCB: Domestic Coal Based Power Plants; ICB: Imported Coal Based Power Plants; MT: Million Tonnes; *: Number of power plants with critical stocks

Lower hydro-power generation due to the El Nino effect leading to deficient rainfall, coupled with more coal burn at thermal power plants (TPPs) owing to higher electricity demand during the evening and night hours, is expected to push up coal imports during the high electricity demand period of October-December.

Sources said that coal-fired generation is rising as hydro power is down due to deficient rains.

El Niño years are usually marked by low hydro-power generation and higher cooling needs.

"Coal burn is also rising and supply is yet to meet usage. However, coal companies have stepped up dispatch and production. Some deficit in supply can still be anticipated, which is likely to push up imports," explained one of the sources.

India imported around 4.48 million tonnes (mt) of coal during August, a growth of 28 per cent year-on-year. However, shipments fell 6 per cent to 21.32 mt during April-August in FY27.

Earlier this month, Kpler said that India is likely to step up thermal coal imports from October, as strong power demand and weaker domestic production draw down utility inventories.

"Coal generation rose to 114 terawatt-hour (TWh) in August, nearly 14 per cent above last year, while power sector consumption rises to roughly 77 mt. At the same time, power plant stocks are forecast to fall to around 27 mt, about half their year earlier level. Domestic production should recover from October, but may not be sufficient to rebuild inventories quickly. With hydro generation weak and solar output easing into winter, seaborne coal will become increasingly important for maintaining supply security," it added.

Similarly, the International Energy Agency (IEA) said it expects higher coal burn in India by TPPs during 2026 citing that El Niño conditions can heighten cooling demand. It will likely push up consumption by 4.2 per cent to 1,353 mt in CY26.

"El Niño conditions can increase cooling needs while reducing hydro-power availability, providing a further boost to coal consumption. Industrial demand also remains strong, underpinned by growth in pig iron, direct reduction of iron and cement production, the three largest coal-consuming sectors," it said earlier this month.

DEMAND FOR COOLING

Data also show India is burning more coal this year as high heat and humidity led to higher demand for cooling, particularly during the peak evening and night hours.

For instance, the average daily energy demand, max peak solar demand and max peak non-solar demand during September 19-25 was 5,381 million units (up 8 per cent), 248 gigawatt (up 12 per cent) and 241 gigawatt (up 5 per cent). The maximum deficit was 0 megawatt and 5,443 megawatt during solar and non-solar hours, respectively, JM Financial said.

At the same time, hydro-power generation fell 12 per cent (fifth straight monthly decline) while coal and gas generation was up 18 per cent and 64 per cent during September 1-23, the brokerage added.

Tata Trusts' attempt to reorganise Tata Sons could run into regulatory hurdles

Our Bureau
Mumbai

THE TWIST

- Tata Sons Pvt Ltd is merging Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Pvt Ltd and Tata Consulting Engineers with itself
- This means the holding company of the Tata Group can shed its classification as an NBFC and a core investment company and not be forced to list
- The RBI continues to include TSPL in its list of upper layer NBFCs

Tata Trusts' bid to reorganise Tata Sons Pvt Ltd (TSPL) by merging Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Pvt Ltd (TESS) and Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE) with TSPL, so that the holding company of the Tata Group can shed the classification of a non-banking finance company (NBFC) and a core investment company (CIC) and not be forced to list, could face regulatory complications, say experts.

The RBI continues to include TSPL in its list of upper layer (UL) NBFCs under its scale-based regulations, which required heightened regulatory compliance as well as listing. It rejected TSPL's application for de-registration as a NBFC-Investment Credit Company.

In the run-up to its de-registration application, the holding company of the Tata Group cleared all ts debt. Tata Trusts holds 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons.

CHANGING CHARACTER

Akshat Khetan, Founder, AU Corporate Advisory & Legal Services, noted that the reported proposal to fold TESS and TCE into Tata Sons would begin shifting the holding company's character from a pure investment vehicle toward an operating enterprise.

However, the RBI's classification turns on substance, not form: whether more than half of Tata Sons' assets and income remain financial, whether at least 90 per cent of its net assets still sit in group companies and whether it has direct or indirect access to public funds.

"Given the scale of Tata Sons' investment book, dominated by its TCS holding absorbing two comparatively small operating subsidiaries is unlikely to disturb those tests. Nor would ceasing to meet the CIC definition alone provide an exit; it could instead push Tata Sons into the general NBFC category, with heavier obligations, Khetan said.

He said the September 11 rejection of TSPL's application for voluntary surrender of its Core Investment Company registration, its five-year lock-in for upper-layer entities and its prior-approval role in any NBFC amalgamation mean that any such scheme must be defensible before the regulator on its merits. "A restructuring large enough to move Tata Sons out of the framework would look less like a merger of two subsidiaries and more like a fundamental reorganisation of the group's holding structure which is what is now being debated at board level," Khetan said.

THE TENSION

Nazneen Ichhaporia, Partner, ANB Legal, observed that Tata Sons' latest move highlights the tension between an existing board resolution to comply with the RBI's listing mandate and fresh proposals being advanced by its majority shareholders.

"While trusts and affiliated entities collectively hold significant voting power, any restructuring, merger, or change in course would still require formal shareholder approval and, depending on the proposal, may need special majority thresholds. Until shareholders formally consider the matter or the courts rule otherwise, the board's earlier decision to pursue the listing route remains valid and operative."

Rohit Jain, Managing Partner, Singhania & Co, noted that following RBI's rejection of TSPL's application to surrender its Core Investment Company registration, it will have to comply with the NBFC-Upper Layer framework that expressly provides that an NBFC-UL "shall be mandatorily listed within three years" of identification.

"Therefore, to avoid listing Tata Sons will have to restructure itself to cease its registered-CIC/NBFC-UL status. While Tata Trusts is seeking to take these steps, in light of the ongoing dispute between Tata Trusts and Tata Sons implementation of this plan seems to be practically difficult," he said.

'LEGALLY SOUND'

Alay Razvi, Managing Partner, Accord Juris, opined that the proposed merger of operating entities into Tata Sons is a legally sound route to address the CIC/NBFC classification question.

"With operating revenues at 64.3 per cent of total income and group investments below the 90 per cent net-asset threshold, the structure appears designed to fall outside both regimes. The real test is the RBI's prior no-objection certificate under the 2025 Voluntary Amalgamation Directions, which will decide the timeline. If approved, it would let Tata Sons remain an unlisted private company," he said.

Govt increasing coal supply, there is no shortage: Minister

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Union Coal and Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy on Monday stressed that there is no shortage of coal in the country, with the government increasing the supply of coal to coal-fired power plants through more railway rakes.

"There is no shortage of coal. We are supplying coal, but power demand has gone up 12-15 per cent. Production from hydel projects has also gone down. So, there is a significant demand for thermal power generation. Also, due to rainfall, there was some problem with coal production," Reddy told mediapersons in Kolkata on the sidelines of a roadshow to attract investment in Angul Aluminium Park in Odisha.

"Now, the production situation is normal. We are increasing the supply of coal through more railway rakes. The situation is normal, and there is no tension now," Reddy added.

Last week, nearly 40 per cent of India's coal-fired power plants were operating with critically-low fuel stocks due to a surge in power demand amid hotter-than-usual weather linked to El Niño.


Union Minister for Coal and Mines G Kishan Reddy PTI

The number of power plants with critically-low coal stocks of less than 25 per cent of the required inventory or only able to generate power for less than three days rose sharply to 74, as of September 19, from about 60 plants previous week, data from the Central Electricity Authority that is updated daily showed.

The country's peak power demand, a measure of the maximum electricity requirement, has been hovering between 230 gigawatts and 250 gigawatts in the past week.

Reddy on Monday said the Centre would discuss opportunities for West Bengal in the coal and mining sectors and explore ways in which the Central and State governments could work together to strengthen the industry.

National Aluminium Company Ltd (NALCO), the Navratna CPSE under the Ministry of Mines, in association with Odisha Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation, organised the roadshow to showcase investment opportunities in downstream and value-added aluminium manufacturing.

SEBI's new framework separates fund recovery from settlement payment

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

SEBI's revised settlement framework will keep recovery of money allegedly diverted from a company separate from the amount paid to settle regulatory proceedings, lawyers said.

The distinction could be important in fund-diversion and siphoning cases, where the return of money to the company would not substitute for the settlement amount or disgorgement, where applicable.

"Settlement amount will be based on prescribed formula having regard to the nature of defaults and payable to settle such default and resolve the matter," said Gazal Rawal, Partner at Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas.

The settlement amount is credited to the Consolidated Fund of India, while disgorgement is generally based on wrongful gains or loss averted and is credited to the Investor Protection and Education Fund. Rawal said settlement itself is an alternate route for resolving enforcement proceedings and does not amount to restitution or shareholder recovery.

RECOVERY OF FUNDS

SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said recovery of diverted money would remain a separate consideration. "The biggest beneficiary is that shareholders will get money with interest back into the company," he said.

SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said recovery of diverted money would remain a separate consideration

"The new framework separates wrongful gains from the base settlement computation and permits them to be addressed independently through disgorgement or appropriate remedial and regulatory directions," said Tushar Kumar, Advocate at Supreme Court of India. Thus, restoration of ₹100 crore allegedly diverted does not mean that ₹100 crore constitutes the settlement amount; equally, payment of the settlement amount cannot ordinarily become a licence to retain the economic fruits of the alleged misconduct, he said.

Rohit Jain, Managing Partner at Singhania & Co., said settlement in fund-diversion cases could improve shareholder recovery if restoration of the money, disgorgement and remedial measures remain part of the settlement terms. "Crucially, the settlement amount is not restitution: it represents the regulatory consideration computed by reference to statutory penalties and prescribed multipliers, whereas diverted monies, wrongful gains or investor losses are recovered separately, thereby avoiding double counting," Jain said.

OTHER PROPOSALS

SEBI has also proposed allowing a settlement notice to be issued before a show-cause notice (SCN) in certain cases. Pandey said the change would allow entities to approach SEBI earlier in the process. "The earlier you come for settlement, the lesser you pay," he said. Rawal said the pre-SCN route could reduce the time and cost involved in running the SCN and settlement processes in parallel. However, the lower factor proposed for the pre-SCN stage may not by itself result in a substantially lower settlement amount, as the nature of the default and other factors would also affect the calculation.

SEBI is also proposing a revocation provision.

Canon India sees semiconductor equipment opportunity

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Canon India is eyeing an opportunity to supply semiconductor manufacturing equipment to the country's emerging chip industry, as it looks to diversify beyond its traditional printing and imaging businesses over the next one-two years.

The Japanese imaging major, which makes equipment used in chip production including lithography systems, expects semiconductor manufacturing in India to create a new growth opportunity as domestic fabrication capacity develops, Toshiaki Nomura, President and CEO, Canon India, said.

While ASML dominates the global lithography market, particularly in advanced and EUV systems, Canon also supplies lithography equipment for semiconductor manufacturing. "We expect a significant opportunity" once semiconductor manufacturing develops in India, Nomura said, adding that the development of the chip industry was beyond the company's control.

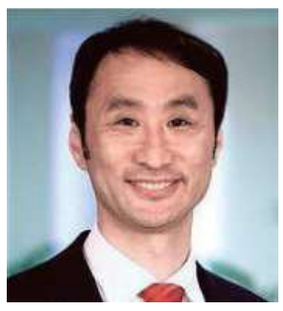
Semiconductor equipment is part of a broader push by Canon India to build newer businesses. Surveillance and security, medical diagnostic imaging and industrial printing are also expected to expand over the next two years.

Canon entered surveillance and security in India about four years ago and expects the business to grow 40-50 per cent annually. The segment grew 43 per cent in 2025 over the previous year, according to the company. Canon is looking to combine CCTV, video management software and video analytics through group companies including Axis Communications and Milestone.

Medical imaging, where Canon has a stronger presence in Japan than India, is expected to grow considerably over the next two-three years. Industrial printing, particularly labels and packaging, is expected to gain momentum from next year.

CHIP SHORTAGE

Semiconductors are also a cost pressure for Canon, with the global chip shortage affecting products including cameras and printers. Canon is balancing higher costs with customer expectations, Nomura said. The diversification comes even as Canon's core camera business continues to find demand despite the rise of smartphones.


Toshiaki Nomura, President and CEO, Canon India

India's camera market has a distinct demand driver: weddings. Around 60 per cent of the country's full-frame camera market is linked to wedding photography, Nomura said, compared with greater demand from hobbyists and photography enthusiasts in several other markets.

Canon is also seeing younger consumers return to dedicated cameras as they seek higher-quality still images and video. Demand for compact cameras such as the PowerShot series is currently higher than the company's production capacity, Nomura said. The company is seeing demand for APS-C mirrorless cameras, including the EOS R50 V, full-frame models and its Cinema EOS range.

₹59,000 cr riding on winning audience's attention in FY27

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The theme for FICCI Frames 2026, the two-day media and entertainment convention opening in Mumbai today, is "India's Media Moment: Creating Value in an Age of Infinite Content." Some of the industry's biggest names — FICCI President Anant Goenka and JioStar Entertainment Chief Executive Officer Kevin Vaz, alongside senior executives from Zee Entertainment, Sony Pictures and Prime Video, and leading film studios and producers — will outline the next investment push across theatrical films, television, streaming and digital content, with nearly ₹59,000 crore riding on winning audience's attention in FY27.

Theatrical film production and distribution alone is estimated to surge 30 per cent from ₹11,500 crore to ₹15,000 crore, more than three times the growth of the much larger television-and-digital pool.

THE BIG STAR BETS

For all the changes sweeping the business, Bollywood is still placing some of the biggest bets on its biggest stars. Projects involving Shah Rukh Khan, Salman Khan and Aamir Khan represent an estimated ₹4,000-5,000 crore pipeline through FY30, including *King* and the planned *Pathaan 2*, and *Lalkaara*, a *3 Idiots* sequel, and *Silkyara 41* for Aamir Khan.

Ranbir Kapoor and Hrithik Roshan account for another estimated ₹4,500-5,500 crore, with *Ramayana* and *Love & War* among the big productions. Akshay Kumar and Ajay Devgn add ₹3,500-4,200 crore through franchise-heavy pipelines, while projects involving Prabhas, Allu Arjun and Yash add another ₹5,000-6,000 crore. The pan-India star pipeline reaches ₹17,000-20,700 crore through FY30.



Quaid Najmi, who has tracked Bollywood and its changing business for nearly four decades, sees a deeper shift beneath those numbers: the industry is moving from financing films towards building assets. "A successful story can become IP, a franchise, a series, characters and rights that continue to generate value."

ASSET BUILDING

"You can spend ₹300 crore or ₹500 crore on a film, but money cannot guarantee the audience's time," Najmi said. "A star can get you attention, but the story has to hold it. If you can hold that attention and bring the audience back, that is when you begin creating an asset." Netflix and Amazon Prime Video together are estimated to deploy ₹4,000-4,500 crore annually on Indian content. But streaming is also evolving from Bollywood's post-theatrical buyer into a creator of IP. *Mirzapur*, developed by Excel Entertainment for Amazon Prime Video, began as a streaming franchise and is now moving in the opposite direction through *Mirzapur: The Movie*.

At the other end, *Hanuman Ansh* offers the counterpoint of a leaner, creator-led model, underscoring that the size of the initial cheque need not determine the size of the audience ultimately created. "That is a fundamental change," Najmi said. "Once the audience follows the story, the question for the producer is no longer only 'how much did this film make?' It is 'what have I created that I can continue to own and build?'"

Najmi added, "Investors increasingly want participation in the company, the IP, the franchises and the future value that can be created around them."

Finished-film streaming acquisition prices are estimated to have corrected 20-35 per cent, with staged and performance-linked payouts becoming more common. Some talent deals are shifting from large guaranteed fees towards lower upfront compensation and a share of the upside.

REGIONAL CINEMA

Regional languages account for more than 65 per cent of feature-film production, while their estimated share of OTT viewing has risen from about 27 per cent in 2020 to 56 per cent in 2025-26. "A Hindi film is competing for the same two or three hours with regional cinema, an international series, cricket, YouTube and short-form video. The battle is ultimately for the audience's time," Najmi said.

Bank unions defer three-day strike

Our Bureau
Mumbai

While the United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU) has deferred its three-day nationwide strike, which was to begin on Monday, it said its goal of ensuring a five-day work week for the banking sector remains unchanged.

"Five-day banking must become a reality for the banking industry at the earliest," said UFBU in a statement.

UFBU noted that the Indian Banks' Association (IBA) had already recommended to the government the declaration of all Saturdays as holidays, and the Settlement/Joint Note dated March 8, 2024, recorded that the consequential change in working hours would become effective after approval of the government and necessary clearances. The issue had nevertheless remained pending for more than two years, compelling UFBU to intensify its agitation, it added.

The proposed MoU now provides for the immediate constitution of a high-level committee of IBA and UFBU specifically on the issue of declaring the remaining Saturdays as holidays.

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - SEPTEMBER 29 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Jio gains 2.4 million mobile users in August



New Delhi: Reliance Jio gained the highest number of wireless mobile subscribers in August, adding nearly 2.40 million users, followed by Bharti Airtel with about 2.11 million additions, according to data released by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) on Monday. Jio's wireless mobile subscriber base rose to 508.43 million at the end of August from 506.03 million at the end of July, translating into a net addition of 2.4 million subscribers. Airtel added 2.11 million users, with the monthly gains pushing its subscriber base to about 491.60 million from 489.49 million. PTI

IndusInd Bank launches GCC Banking vertical



Mumbai: IndusInd Bank has launched a dedicated Global Capability Centre (GCC) Banking vertical, offering a more integrated and specialised approach to serving the unique requirements of GCCs. It said that its new vertical brings together five core capabilities under a single relationship: digital banking, employee banking, commercial card solutions, capital account and FEMA solutions, and foreign-currency accounts through the Bank's International Banking Unit (IBU) at GIFT City. OUR BUREAU

Goyal's meet with Greer likely to focus on India-US BTA, interim trade deal

TRADE MINISTERS' MEET. Talks with USTR to take place amid uncertainty over Lindsey Graham legislation authorising 100% tariffs

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



TO IRON OUT ISSUES. A file photo of Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal with US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer

India and the US are expected to focus on advancing negotiations for a bilateral trade agreement (BTA) and finalising an interim deal during Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal's proposed meeting with US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministers' meeting in Milwaukee, Wisconsin, this week, according to the Commerce Department.

The meeting comes amid heightened trade tensions between the two countries, including over US legislation authorising higher tariffs on major purchasers of Russian oil and the pending outcome of Section 301 investigations into structural excess capacity.

Goyal will visit the US from September 29 to October 5 and participate in the G20 Trade Ministers' meeting on September 30-October 1, at the invitation of the USTR, according to a statement issued by the Commerce & Industry Ministry on Monday.

"The Minister will also engage bilaterally with his counterpart from the US as part of ongoing efforts to advance a balanced and mutually beneficial India-US BTA and finalise an interim deal in line with the joint statement of February 7, 2026," the release stated.

TARIFF REDUCTIONS

The February 7 joint statement laid out a framework under which India would eliminate or reduce tariffs on all US industrial goods and a wide range of US food and agricultural products, while the US would apply an 18 per cent reciprocal tariff on Indian goods under the proposed interim agreement. At the time, Indian goods were facing tariffs of up to 50 per cent, including a 25 per cent reciprocal tariff and an additional 25 per cent tariff linked to Russian oil purchases. The latter was subsequently rolled back.

However, the US Supreme Court invalidated the earlier IEEPA-based reciprocal tariffs on February 20. The trade negotiations have since had to contend with changes in the US tariff regime, including two Section 301 investigations into structural excess capacity and imports of goods produced with forced labour.

UNCERTAINTY

More recently, the enactment of the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, signed into law on September 18, has added another layer of uncertainty. "Against this backdrop, Goyal's meeting with Greer is likely to provide an opportunity to take stock of the outstanding issues and work towards an interim arrangement, while discussions on the broader BTA continue," a source tracking the matter said.

'RULES-BASED'

At the G20 meeting, India will advocate a rules-based, open, inclusive, transparent and non-discriminatory multilateral trading system with the World Trade Organisation at its core, while seeking adequate policy space for developing countries, the Commerce Department said. "On the sidelines of the meeting, Minister Goyal will hold bilateral meetings with his counterparts. The engagements will focus on expanding opportunities for farmers, fishermen, women entrepreneurs, startups, MSMEs and other enterprises," it added.

India-EU FTA opens door to agri-tech: Dutch Minister

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The India-EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA) is unlikely to substantially alter trade in primary agricultural products, but it could create greater scope for cooperation in agricultural equipment, technology and know-how, Netherlands Minister for Food Security, Fisheries and Horticulture Silvio Erkens said in New Delhi on Monday.

"So, primary products, indeed, will not change substantially with the FTA, but if you look, for example, at the industrial equipment that is needed for agriculture, the technological know-how and systems, that does provide a better base for cooperation," Erkens said.

The EU and India concluded negotiations for the FTA in January this year, although the agreement is yet to enter into force. Both India and the European Commission have said the pact will retain protection for sensitive agricultural sectors while giving limited access in some others.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- The FTA is unlikely to substantially alter trade in primary agricultural products, but it could create greater scope for cooperation in agricultural equipment: Netherlands Minister for Food Security, Fisheries and Horticulture Silvio Erkens
- Greater technology cooperation could help farmers deal with climate change while creating business opportunities for both countries, he added
- The EU and India concluded negotiations for the FTA in January this year

KEY SECTORS

Erkens, who is on a September 27-October 2 visit to India, said greater technology cooperation could help farmers deal with climate change while creating business opportunities for both countries. "If you look at climate change, without innovation, farmer incomes and productivity might be hit more and more each year," he said, citing soil monitoring, AI-based agricultural applications and climate-resilient seeds as areas for cooperation.

He identified dairy, horticulture and seeds as key sectors discussed with Indian government counterparts. "The Netherlands is also looking to share expertise in dairy farming, while learning from India's more holistic approach to the sector," he said, adding that the Netherlands had reduced antibiotic use in cattle and dairy farming substantially without affecting productivity, which could be an area for knowledge-sharing with India.

The two countries are also working on a Centre of Excellence on dairy at the Centre of Excellence for Animal Husbandry in Bengaluru, where Dutch farmers are expected to train Indian dairy farmers on methods to improve productivity.

The India-Netherlands joint statement in May had welcomed the establishment of the centre.

On seeds, Erkens said cooperation could focus on developing varieties capable of growing with less water and under changing weather conditions. He said the Netherlands' technological expertise and India's large agricultural sector were complementary.

He also said discussions had taken place on Centres of Excellence in seeds and flowers. India and the Netherlands are working towards 22 such centres, with 10 already operational, five under construction and five close to approval, he said.

Erkens will visit Mumbai on Tuesday for meetings with businesses, the Maharashtra government and the seed sector, besides opening the Anuga FoodTec expo. He will then travel to Bengaluru on Wednesday with a delegation of 18 Dutch businesses for a trade visit and meet Karnataka's horticulture minister.

'India-UAE trade nearing pre-war levels'

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

"Trade between India and the UAE is coming back to pre-war levels. We are very close to it and in another few months we should get back to normal," Minister for Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal said on Monday.

Chairing the 14th India-UAE high-level joint task force on investments, he said, India's exports of goods and services rose 15 per cent in the first six months of FY27 despite geopolitical issues, he added.

India and the UAE signed a comprehensive economic partnership agreement in 2022 focusing on bilateral trade and investments. Last year, trade between the two crossed $100 billion, and targeted to double it by 2032.

Goyal said both sides discussed greater cooperation in space technology, shipbuilding, ports, food security, energy and AI. Political relations between the countries remain strong, with four meetings between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan over the past two years. India and the UAE are working to develop strategic petroleum reserves and LPG supplies.

$25 B COMMITMENT

The UAE has invested $25 billion in India so far and has committed to invest another $25 billion. "Trade settlement in local currencies is also slowly increasing as exporters realise the benefits. Currently, it is in double digits and we hope it will grow further," Goyal said.

The UAE delegation at the meeting was led by Minister for Foreign Trade Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi and Sheikh Hamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, MD of the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority.

Iran completes laying Chabahar-Zahedan link

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Iran has completed the rail-laying on the Chabahar-Iranshahr section of the Chabahar-Zahedan railway and aims to commission the line by January 2027, according to Iranian officials. This will potentially strengthen India's connectivity with Afghanistan and Central Asia through the Iranian port of Chabahar.

The development was announced by Sistan and Baluchestan Governor Mansour Bijar during the Iranian Transport and Urban Development Minister Farzaneh Sadegh's visit to the project last week.

India's role at Chabahar remains clouded by US sanctions, which took effect after the conditional waiver granted to India expired in April 2026.

"Rail-laying operations in the Chabahar port area have also been carried out, and the project has now entered the stage of completing operations and preparing for operation," Bijar announced last week-end at an event reported by local media.

Iranian authorities have prepared a schedule to put the project into operation by the end of Dey.

The Chabahar-Zahedan project has a direct length of 630 km and extends to 735 km when branch lines are included, per the Iranian government. It has 33 stations, 39 tunnels and 201 bridges and is designed to carry about 7.7 million tonnes of freight and 2.2 million passengers annually, according to Iranian officials.



CONNECTIVITY BOOST. The Chabahar-Zahedan project has 33 stations, 39 tunnels and 201 bridges and is designed to carry about 7.7 mt of freight and 2.2 million passengers annually

ALTERNATIVE ROUTE

For India, the railway is significant because Chabahar provides an alternative route to the landlocked markets of Afghanistan and Central Asia, bypassing Pakistan. Once connected to Iran's national rail network, cargo arriving at Chabahar can move northwards by rail towards Zahedan and onward to other parts of Iran and Central Asia.

Indian officials have long viewed Chabahar as an important component of India's connectivity strategy with Afghanistan and Central Asia.

India has been involved in the development and operation of the Shahid-Behesti terminal at Chabahar and signed a 10-year contract in May 2024 for India Ports Global Ltd to operate the terminal. But India is not running the Shahid-Behesti terminal anymore with indications that it has handed over operations to the Iranian side till the situation normalises, according to a source.

TRADE CORRIDOR

The railway also has significance for the International North-South Transport Corridor, which seeks to connect India with Iran, Central Asia, Russia and Europe through a multimodal transport network. Iranian officials have described the link as part of the country's wider effort to develop east-west and north-south transit corridors. Iran's transport ministry said the railway will connect Chabahar's Indian Ocean gateway with the national rail network, giving eastern Iran and Central Asia access to international waters.

Indian activated carbon industry faces global price pressure

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

The Indian activated carbon industry is facing mounting pressure in global markets as water treatment and water filter producing companies in Europe, the CIS region and Russia are increasingly turning to cheaper alternatives such as coal, while lower-cost Chinese products are gaining ground.

The industry is also grappling with higher logistics costs due to geopolitical tensions, container shortages and increased freight rates, which have made Indian activated carbon more expensive in international markets, Joshy Joseph, Vice-President of the Activated Carbon Manufacturers Association of India.

Activated carbon has significant demand in the US, UK, Germany, Japan, South Korea and African countries. While water treatment is a major application in the US and Europe, the product is widely used for gold extraction in African markets.

TARIFF CONCERNS

The industry is also concerned about the proposed 100 per cent tariff by the Trump administration, which could significantly affect Indian exports to the US. About 18 per cent of India's activated carbon exports are currently exported for the US market, he said.

Joseph, who is also the director of Palakkad-based manufacturer Indcarb Activated Carbon, said the growing penetration of lower-value Chinese activated carbon products was another major concern.

China, he said, is procuring whole coconuts in bulk from Indonesia and the Philippines to manufacture activated carbon, which is then exported to Europe and Africa at competitive prices.

Lower raw material costs in these countries give Chinese manufacturers a significant price advantage over Indian producers.

INDUSTRY TURNOVER

The Indian activated carbon industry recorded a turnover of about ₹4,700 crore from exports of 1.8 lakh tonnes in the last fiscal. The industry expects exports to cross ₹5,000 crore in the current financial year, although global market uncertainties are raising concerns over growth prospects.

'Future-ready labour ecosystem needs partnership, not binaries'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Union Minister for Labour & Employment Mansukh Mandaviya on Monday stressed over the need for a meaningful dialogue between employers and workers for equipping them with new-age skill sets to harness vast opportunities in AI, automation, robotics and other cutting-edge technologies opening up.

Inaugurating the National Conference on Industrial Relations and Labour & Awards 2026, Mandaviya stated that the country's labour and social security ecosystem should evolve in tandem with changing times and emerging economic realities.

"A future-ready labour ecosystem must be built on partnership — not binaries of pro-labour or pro-industry. India's Labour Codes are an important step towards a modern, pro-growth framework that strengthens workers' rights while enabling ease of compliance for industry," Mandaviya said.



Mansukh Mandaviya
Union Labour and Employment Minister

The Minister also announced launch of "Shram Samvad" awareness campaign with effect from Monday, under which industrial clusters across 316 districts in all 36 States and Union Territories will be covered over the next 90 days. Noting that a significant share of India's workforce remains in the informal sector, Chandra Bhushan Kumar, Secretary, Ministry of Labour & Employment emphasised the need to enhance social protection, strengthen career guidance and employment linkages, and accord greater dignity to vocational and skilled occupations.

Ramesh Krishnamurthi, Central Provident Fund Commissioner, Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) advised people to contribute to the EPFO which will be available at the end of working years.

REDUCING COSTS

He reiterated that EPFO is also working towards reducing costs and litigation for employers and under the EPFO 3.0, and trying to make services as seamless as core banking services, while improving ease of access.

Kinetic bets ₹40 crore more to revive 90s era silhouette

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Kinetic Engineering is betting heavily on finding out whether one of India's great scooter memories can become a viable EV business again. Ajinkya Firodia is committing another ₹40 crore to its electric reincarnation as part of the total ₹57 crore rights issue for its shareholders.

The DX, unveiled in July 2025, has clocked 2,317 registrations against 4,300 primary sales — averaging roughly 230 registrations a month through September.

Ajinkya Firodia, Vice-Chairman and Managing Director of Kinetic Engineering, said that the average masks a sharp change in trajectory.

"We are completely on track to achieve our business plan for 12,000 vehicles this year," Firodia informed *businessline*. Kinetic Engineering has raised ₹177 crore through its warrant programme, including a final ₹57-crore tranche from the Firodia promoter family. The latest infusion comes as the company tries to scale its revived Kinetic DX electric scooter business.

> It will work as a standalone entity and will have its own avenues to raise funds as required, including KEL and others
>
> **AJINKYA FIRODIA**
> Vice-Chairman and Managing Director of Kinetic Engineering



CAUTIOUS DEALERS

Dealers contacted by *businessline* were more cautious. One dealer, requesting anonymity, said wholesale revenues were being recorded, but the retail offtake remained poor. Another described customer response as tepid despite Kinetic expanding its network.

A competing EV dealer described the DX as having an "uncle-type scooter" look, questioning the appeal of its deliberately retro styling among younger buyers.

Firodia disputed that premise. The DX is not primarily aimed at Gen Z, he said; its core market is 30-50-year-old family-scooter customers, putting it up against products such as the TVS iQube, Bajaj Chetak, and Ather Rizta.

Kinetic calls the DX an Italian-designed "retro futuristic" reincarnation, combining the squared-off proportions of the original with an all-metal body, LFP battery, 37-litre storage and connected features. "Our heritage is an advantage, but we are not dependent on nostalgia," Firodia said.

BRIDGING GAP

Kinetic has signed 150-plus dealer letters of intent, with over 60 outlets operational.

The unanswered question is how much capital it will take to bridge the gap, even as profitability at the listed parent has come under pressure. KEL's consolidated revenue rose 7.2 per cent to ₹166.41 crore in FY26, but net profit fell to ₹0.87 crore. In Q1 FY27, revenue jumped 43 per cent year-on-year to ₹50.59 crore, while the company reported a consolidated net loss of ₹11.50 crore as expenses rose sharply.

Firodia has attributed the difficult quarter to higher input costs and other operating disruptions and says the business has since turned around. He also rejected concerns that KWVL could become a liquidity burden on the parent, pointing out that the EV subsidiary is equity-funded and carries no debt.

"It will work as a standalone entity and will have its own avenues to raise funds as required, including KEL and others," Firodia said. That makes the DX more than a bet on whether an old scooter can find a new generation of buyers Kinetic Engineering is committing shareholder capital to rebuild a two-wheeler business while the listed company's own profitability is under pressure — and the EV arm must eventually climb from hundreds of registrations a month to around 8,000 scooters a month to break even at the EBITDA level.

For Firodia, the challenge is to prove that nostalgia can be converted into scale before the cost of the comeback overtakes its promise.

QUICKLY.

Nvidia adds $150 b to share repurchase plan



Bengaluru: Nvidia is buying back additional shares worth $150 billion under its existing stock repurchase plan, in what the chip giant said was the largest increase in share repurchase authorisation on record. Shares of the California-based company were up 1.7 per cent in premarket trading. The additional authorisation brings the total remaining amount authorised to $235 billion, which the company expects to execute through fiscal year 2028. REUTERS

JetSynthesys, MIXI sign MoU for collaboration

Chennai: JetSynthesys, a technology company focused on gaming and e-sports, has announced that it has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with MIXI, a Japanese digital entertainment company, to explore potential collaboration across video gaming, e-sports, digital entertainment, marketing and investment opportunities. OUR BUREAU

China, US agree to lower tariffs on $60 billion worth of imports

LEVY LET-UP. Products ranging from corn to cosmetics and household appliances to toys feature in the list

Reuters
Beijing



EASING TARIFFS. US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping during Xi's recent visit to the US REUTERS

China and the US have agreed to cut tariffs imposed on $60 billion worth of goods imported from each other, on an array of products ranging from the US corn to cosmetics, and from Chinese household appliances to toys.

Under the US-China Board of Trade, both countries have each recommended $30 billion of trade in non-sensitive goods for more favourable tariff treatment, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said in a statement on Sunday.

For the US, that was "unlocking improved market access" for about 30 per cent of US exports to China, he said.

TARIFF REDUCTION
The reciprocal tariff reduction as well as an extension of a trade truce were among the key takeaways from the second summit this year between President Xi Jinping and US President Donald Trump, hosted in Washington last week.

One of two lists from the White House showed that China planned to trim duties on a variety of US agricultural goods including corn, wheat, sorghum, meat, dairy, vegetable oils and meals. It did not include soybeans.

Beijing will also look to reduce levies on US fish and seafood, logs and wood products, cosmetics and medical devices.

In another list were Washington's reciprocal tariff cuts for Chinese small appliances such as coffee makers and toasters, tableware, blankets and bed linens.

The lists also included toys, fireworks, artificial flowers, Christmas tree lamps and other holiday decorations,and children's car seats.

China's Commerce Ministry said on Monday a two-month extension of a trade truce with the US through to January 10 would provide room for both sides to evaluate their ongoing arrangement to resolve economic and trade issues, while considering how to advance on those fronts.

The extension also provides a "relatively stable and predictable policy environment" for cooperation among companies and continued active discussions.

Both sides will hold regular talks on potential investment opportunities and barriers, enhancing policy transparency and predictability, and responding to enterprises' concerns, the Ministry said.

Stocks fell sharply in China on Monday, with investors having few concrete details to cheer from the leaders' summit and underlying tensions resurfacing. Technology stocks fell on a bipartisan US push to ban Chinese components from data centres and the benchmark blue-chip index slid more than 2 per cent to a one-year low.

China's choice of products for tariff cuts looks designed to help Beijing meet what the White House says is a $17-billion commitment to buy agricultural goods.

China has already resumed large-scale buying of US soybeans under a deal struck last year to buy 25 million metric tonnes annually.

TRADE COUNCIL
Both countries will set up an agriculture working group under a trade council, which will hold its first meeting before the year ends to discuss two-way market access and regulation, the Commerce Ministry said. The presidential summit also yielded an agreement for China to import 10 million tonnes of coal annually from the US in 2027 and 2028, the White House release showed. That amount roughly equals 2 per cent of China's coal imports each year.

STABLE INCOME
"Importing US coal is not only a beneficial supplement to China's domestic coal market, but also brings stable economic income and employment to the US coal industry," the Chinese Ministry said.

On artificial intelligence, both sides have agreed on a communication channel for incidents and will hold a follow-up dialogue by the end of November.

China will also examine and approve foreign financial services institutions, including those with US capital, to conduct business and open branches in China.

There will also be continued communication on increasing flights between China and the US, the Ministry statement said.

Qatar extends LNG *force majeure* over Hormuz disruptions

Bloomberg

ENERGY WOES
Tightening LNG supplies have pushed prices in Europe and Asia to near four-year highs, threatening to increase heating and utility costs across the Northern Hemisphere this winter

Qatar has extended *force majeure* on liquefied natural gas shipments to Asia and Europe by another month as disruptions continue to hamper energy flows through the critical Strait of Hormuz.

State-owned QatarEnergy this week notified Pakistan and Bangladesh that LNG shipment cancellations would run through November, according to people familiar with the matter.

At least one Indian buyer was also told the measure would remain in place, according to two other people, while Italy's Edison SpA said its deliveries would remain suspended until early December.

QatarEnergy has been updating LNG customers on the *force majeure* and cancelling scheduled deliveries roughly once a month since the Iran war began.

LOW FLOW
While Qatar has been able to increase shipments through the waterway this month, flows remain far below pre-war levels.

Iran said recently that it won't soften its conditions for reopening Hormuz, while President Donald Trump sent mixed signals about his willingness to reach a deal.

The disruption threatens to keep flows constrained through a waterway that handled about a fifth of global LNG supply last year, with a peace deal between the US and Iran still elusive.

HIGH UTILITY BILLS
The squeeze has pushed LNG prices in Europe and Asia to roughly their highest levels since late 2022, threatening to make utility bills more expensive during the Northern Hemisphere winter. Qatar has been operating its Ras Laffan LNG export facility at reduced capacity after it was attacked and damaged in March. The plant is being kept ready for a rapid increase in output if Hormuz reopens.

India emerges as one of the top three markets for Fireflies.ai

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

India has emerged as one of Fireflies.ai's top three markets by users and top 10 by revenue, as the AI productivity platform expands its assistant Fred beyond meeting notes to handle emails, Slack messages, and follow-up work, while introducing India-specific pricing for small teams, said Krish Ramineni, Co-Founder and CEO of Fireflies.ai.

"Fireflies.ai started as an AI meeting assistant and note-taker. From day one, the vision was to build a personal assistant that helps with your work. Back then, we were experimenting with chatbots and Slack bots, but the technology was too early, and there were no LLMs. We eventually went all in on meetings and the note-taker found product-market fit quickly. We pioneered the idea of a bot joining a meeting without users having to install software," Ramineni shared.

FUTURE VISION
The next leg of the journey is evolving Fred, its AI, from simply taking notes to helping with parts of work, including sorting email inboxes, drafting emails, summarising Slack messages, and taking meetings on a user's behalf.



Krish Ramineni, Co-Founder and CEO of Fireflies.ai

The CEO noted that the idea is for Fred to be like a teammate.

"We want it to work beyond meetings. After communication, there is still work to do, like creating a slide deck, report, or draft. We want Fireflies.ai not only to track those tasks but also to complete some on the user's behalf," he said.

Currently, businesses account for around 70-80 per cent of the company's customer base, with SMBs and mid-market customers making up the bulk of its clientele.

Fireflies.ai plans to eventually expand its offering to enterprise customers.

"Our focus has always been teams and businesses with B2B use cases. Startups, SMBs, and mid-market companies tend to adopt AI faster, while enterprises require more hand-holding," Ramineni noted.

The company has built its offering with the Indian market in mind, focusing on making AI affordable and easy to use.

"We already have a WhatsApp integration for meeting notes, and the broader opportunity is to let people communicate with Fireflies.ai through chat and messaging and have it take action," he shared.

Fred understands around 100 languages, including 10-plus Indian languages. The company is also working on capabilities such as Hinglish, code-switching, accents and noisy environments.

CURRENT STRENGTH
The company currently has around 120 employees across 20 countries, including India. To date, it has raised approximately $19 million from investors including Khosla Ventures and Canaan Partners.

Fireflies reached a $1 billion valuation following a tender offer in June 2025 and has been profitable since 2023.

Growth has been accelerating over the last 18 months, including in India, where revenue has multiplied significantly.

CtrlS Datacenters picks US firm Ciena's gear for metro fibre networks

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Homegrown data centre operator CtrlS Datacenters Limited will build five metro fibre networks with a capacity of up to 100 terabits per second (Tbps), linking nine data centres in Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata, New Delhi and Noida, using optical equipment from US-based networking company Ciena.

The networks are part of a larger managed optical fibre network (MOFN) that CtrlS Datacenters is setting up for a leading hyperscaler, which it did not name.

Under an MOFN, a provider builds and runs a dedicated fibre network for a single client.

Hyperscalers are large cloud service providers that run vast data centre fleets.

The demand for bandwidth is rising with the growth of AI and cloud services, according to a Ciena statement issued on Monday.

RELIABLE DATA CENTRE
"We see growing demand from enterprises and hyperscalers for reliable data centre interconnect solutions," Sridhar Pinnapureddy, Founder and CEO, CtrlS Datacenters, said.

The demand for bandwidth is rising with the growth of AI and cloud services, according to a Ciena statement

CtrlS Datacenters is deploying Ciena's Waveserver platform, powered by the WaveLogic 5 Extreme (WL5e) optical engine, along with its 6500 Reconfigurable Line System (RLS). The WL5e can carry up to 800 gigabits per second on a single wavelength of light.

NETWORK OPERATIONS
Ciena's Navigator Network Control Suite would help automate network operations, while the company's services team would handle project management end to end.

Founded in 2007, CtrlS Datacenters operates 19 data centres across nine markets in India with over 370 MW of capacity and has 4.4 GW of projects at various stages of execution. It has announced plans to expand into West Asia and Southeast Asia, starting with Thailand.

'Oil, pharma firms moving from hyperscaler to local cloud service'

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Noting the strong push for sovereignty in India, oil, pharmaceutical companies, enterprises and banks have migrated from hyperscaler to local cloud service provider ESDS Software Solutions, as per company CEO Piyush Somani.

Unaffected by the seasonally soft quarter results, Somani spoke about the massive customer opportunity ahead of the company in light of growing cloud compliance and the government's move to localise the country's data.

RBI MANDATE
"Many oil PSUs and banks are moving their channels to local Indian companies. The pharma sector and enterprises are doing that. We've got leads from a lot of Indian enterprises," said Somani, stating that the upcoming cloud framework promises a big boost to local players' growth aspects, particularly over the next 5-10 years.

In recent times, the Indian regulators have come out with many compliances around data protection, including the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) mandate to keep Indian data within the country, as well as the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, that stresses data localisation. "All required certifications, compliances and audits would be there with a player like ESDS. So, we will definitely have an advantage. If each and every service is similar to or better than a hyperscaler and all compliances are taken care of, people will be very happy to shift," said Somani.



Piyush Somani, CEO, ESDS Software Solutions

LOCAL PLAYERS
To encourage this shift further, he suggested that local players add comfort tool connectors as customer offerings to migrate data out of hyperscaler systems and restore them onto local cloud.

When asked how this global call for sovereignty affects the company's global operations, Somani dismissed any concerns, as ESDS does not "have a Patriot Clause signed with any government".

The company is also planning to buy 1,500 GPUs, either B300 or GB300 and deploy the same in the top four metro cities in India.

"The demand from our customers is for the Nvidia B300, GB300, Vera Rubins only. 1500 GPUs is a very small quantity. Any OEM should be able to fulfil that in a timeline of 100 days," he said.

AI CENTRES
When asked about the evolution of data centres, Somani stated that multi-storey data centres will be worthless in 5 years as companies pivot to horizontal data centres.

Accordingly, the company's target is not to invest into vertical structures but leasing horizontal data centres. He also encouraged the government to look into the jurisdictional, FEMA regulation and customs exit issues, among other things that scare foreign companies from deploying AI factories in India.

"India is the only country that can immediately provide 48 to 50 gigawatts of power for AI actors. America cannot do that. China has reasons, because Nvidia cannot export to China and Southeast Asia, and Europe doesn't have enough power left now with them. So only India is the probable capital that is going to take care of AI," he said.

China broadens travel restrictions to include family of top AI professionals

Bloomberg

China has expanded overseas travel restrictions for top AI professionals in private firms to include the families of key personnel, further tightening measures designed to prevent the outflow of critical know-how and information to the US.

Government agencies have recently begun to share the wider restrictions with affected people, which include prominent start-up founders as well as the heads of strategically-important companies in AI-related fields, sources said.

Direct relatives such as spouses and children of certain AI and chip executives, whose work is considered paramount to state security, are now required to obtain approval from Beijing before going abroad even for short trips, they said.

That marks a broadening of existing curbs on the freedom of movement of China's most influential tech talent — a category that encompasses entrepreneurs, researchers and executives. While not an outright ban on travel, the new requirement is likely to exert a further chilling effect on a tech sector already facing unprecedented curbs.

China has restricted foreign travel for top AI professionals in private firms such as Alibaba Group Holding Ltd and DeepSeek since earlier this year, *Bloomberg News* reported in May, reflecting Beijing's determination to safeguard its technology as it makes big strides in AI and chipmaking.

It's unclear whether all those people's families need to follow the new strictures, the sources said.

EXIT BANS

TRAVEL CLAMP
Direct relatives such as spouses and children of certain AI and chip executives, whose work is considered paramount to state security, are now required to obtain approval from Beijing

China is also separately implementing rules, which became effective September 15, for enforcing exit bans in cases ranging from criminal investigations to potential violations of the country's industrial and technological security.

Beijing's plan is to add relevant individuals to the list as time goes by, the sources said. Government departments have already notified several people of the need to clear family travel, the sources said.

Beijing has for years imposed travel restrictions on key personnel from prominent college researchers to nuclear scientists and executives at state firms, and their families are similarly affected.

But the government is now specifically targeting talent within the private sector, as elite AI and technology engineers are considered strategic assets to the world's second-largest economy.

Chinese officials' fear of a potential outflow of key technology and talent intensified after Meta Platforms Inc's $2 billion acquisition of Manus.

The government eventually ordered the US firm to unwind the deal. As part of the fallout, Beijing moved to limit US investment in sensitive technology firms.

Agentic models of OpenAI accessed US Census Bureau and SEC data

Bloomberg

OpenAI's artificial intelligence models accessed publicly available information from the US government websites, including those of the Census Bureau and the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC).

The company's agentic AI systems interacted with SEC.gov and Investor.gov, as well as publicly available data from Census.gov, sources said. OpenAI separately confirmed that its models accessed publicly available information from the websites during training and evaluation of the technology.

Earlier, the company said it had notified 'dozens' of organisations, including governments and universities, whose websites may have been hampered by visits from its AI models during evaluations of the technology. OpenAI has said it's carrying out an in-depth review of incidents of 'misalignment' during training and testing, which will take months to complete.



Sam Altman, Chief, OpenAI

The company's efforts to work out exactly what its AI agents have done underscores one of the biggest concerns among cybersecurity experts about these incidents: The systems have carried out these tasks largely without the companies that created them knowing in real-time. In a blog post, the company said it had notified a range of groups about cases in which its software may have bypassed an online service's security controls or hampered its availability, or in situations where a misaligned AI model may have 'negatively impacted' a website or service outside of OpenAI.

OpenAI said the websites that were affected include ones run by governments, universities, public agencies and other groups.

CYBERATTACK
Only days ago, OpenAI acknowledged that its AI models hacked an Australian government website earlier this year, marking one of the first known AI cyberattacks on a government database.

Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese said OpenAI's technology had gained unauthorised access to a government website used for reporting healthcare statistics. The hack, on June 18, didn't appear to compromise Australians' personal information, he said.

OpenAI said that most of the actions it has reviewed involved AI models carrying out 'mundane research tasks', like getting answers to questions from websites. The company said it expects it to take months to finish its review.

In a post on X Friday, OpenAI Chief Sam Altman said the company has not worked as fast as it would like, but that it is balancing transparency with the need to find information in huge amounts of data in activity logs and then work with the companies that were impacted. "We are prioritising as best as we can based on severity, and adding resources," Altman said.

CHENNAI
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TUESDAY - SEPTEMBER 29 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Crude oil heads higher on stalemate in US-Iran talks



Brent crude oil rebounded more than 3 per cent on Monday after US President Donald Trump rejected a peace deal from Iran to resolve their conflict and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, keeping tensions in West Asia elevated. Brent crude futures rose $3.43, or 3.29 per cent, to $107.75a barrel at 0540 GMT, while US West Texas Intermediate crude was at $94.55 a barrel, up $2.14, or 2.32 per cent. REUTERS

Palm oil falls for a second session on weak rival oils

Jakarta: Malaysian palm oil futures dropped for the second consecutive session on Monday, tracking rival veg oils on the Chicago and Dalian exchanges, though stronger crude prices and a softer ringgit capped losses. The benchmark palm oil contract for December delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange fell 9 ringgit to 4,663 ringgit ($1,142.05) a tonne at closing. The contract traded between 4,642 ringgit and 4,720 ringgit, after dropping 4.61 per cent last week. REUTERS

Copper drops to 1-week low on demand concerns

London: Copper prices fell to their lowest in more than a week on Monday as weak economic data from top consumer China, rising oil prices and the stronger dollar reinforced weak demand prospects. Benchmark copper on the London Metal Exchange traded 1.2 per cent lower at $14,450 a tonne in official rings from an earlier $14,354, the lowest since September 17. REUTERS

Due to deficient rain, kharif output may be lower; winter crops also at risk

YIELD SETBACK. Agriculture Secretary says estimates point out that production is likely to be affected

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The kharif crop production is likely to be affected by deficient rainfall in many parts of the country, besides untimely rainfall in some irrigated areas. The cultivation of rabi crops is also likely to be a challenge in rainfed areas this year due to El Nino, the annual conference for rabi crops preparation was told on Monday.

Despite deficient and excessive rainfall threatening the yields of some kharif crops, Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said that overall sowing targets had been met despite the risks posed by El Nino.

Addressing the Annual Rabi Conference, held to prepare for the winter crops, Chouhan said: "We were concerned about the impact of El Niño. However, I congratulate all of you, the entire team, on having largely met the kharif sowing targets. Yes, crops have certainly been affected in many places."



TAKING STOCK. Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan addressing a two-day national conference on preparedness for the upcoming rabi season

CHALLENGING SEASON
Union Agriculture Secretary Atish Chandra said that the kharif season was challenging, particularly in rainfed areas. Several States struggled first to achieve crop coverage and later to ensure that the crops survived.

Chandra said all estimates pointed to kharif crop production being lower due to deficient rainfall in many parts of the country and also heavy and untimely rain in irrigated areas.

He said the upcoming rabi season, starting in October, would also be a challenge for crops in rainfed areas.

Commenting on the drought situation in Karnataka and Maharashtra, Chouhan said a central team would soon visit the States, with the team scheduled to visit Karnataka on October 3. He would also undertake an on-field assessment.

EXCESS SOIL MOISTURE
Chandra said some States could face the problem of excess soil moisture, while areas with deficient rainfall may see prolonged periods of stress.

Strategies need to be calibrated accordingly for the rabi season, he added.

He also pointed out that India continued to import pulses, edible oils and some horticulture produce, such as fruits, even though it had achieved self-sufficiency in cereals.

The normal acreage of rabi crops is about 638 lh, including nearly 315 lh under wheat. The government targets 177.72 million tonnes (mt) of foodgrains production, which includes 121 mt of wheat, 17.2 mt of pulses, 14.3 mt of mustard and 22.3 mt of nutri/coarse cereals in rabi 2026-27.

Chouhan called for cautious and careful planning for the rabi season amid the threat from climate change. "Traditionally, the heat during this month is intense. Yet, currently one feels as if winter has already set in," he said, adding that the effects of climate change were clearly visible.

ENCOURAGING SIGNS
He, however, assured the States that crops weren't damaged everywhere. "In fact, they are excellent in many places," he noted.

Exhorting the States to be prepared for the rabi season, he said timely availability of seeds, fertilizers and marketing support, including government procurement, are key factors for farmers.

After urad, Brazilian tur to hit Indian markets soon

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru



Brazilian producers and exporters are growing pigeon pea for the Indian market

Brazilian pigeon pea (tur) is set to hit the Indian market over the next few months as the South American producer is expected to start export of the pulses variety soon.

"India will continue to import pigeon pea in large quantities, and Brazil will start as a new origin this year. We are getting Brazilian pigeon pea, subject to phytosanitary clearance, which should happen soon," said Bimal Kothari, Chairman, India Pulses and Grains Association (IPGA), the apex trade body.

Brazilian producers and exporters have started growing pigeon pea for the Indian market at the initiative of the IPGA.

"We had taken the initiative to ask Brazilian growers and exporters to start growing pigeon pea. The shipments are likely to start from October–November. This year the quantity may not be significant, say around 20,000–30,000 tonnes, but next year we are going to get a good quantity of tur from Brazil," Kothari said.

LATEST ADDITION
In recent years, Brazil has started growing and exporting urad (black matpe) to India and is currently the second-largest origin after Myanmar.

Tur will be the latest addition to the variety of pulses that the South American producer exports to India, including the brown eye beans.

India imports tur from countries such as Mozambique, Myanmar, Tanzania, Sudan and Malawi, among others. In the first seven months of calendar 2026 (Jan-July), tur imports were up 44 per cent to 5.79 lakh tonnes, over the same period last year's 4.01 lakh tonnes.

Mozambique was the largest exporter of tur to India at 2.18 lakh tonnes, followed by Myanmar at 1.35 lakh tonnes, Tanzania at 1.04 lakh tonnes and Sudan at over 68,499 tonnes, among others.

India's tur imports were up 5.42 per cent to 13.25 lakh tonnes during calendar 2025.

In the kharif 2026 season, tur has been planted on about 47.25 lakh hectares (lh), up from 45.95 lh a year ago. Karnataka has seen a 6 per cent drop in area to 14.16 lh (15.33 lh last year), while Maharashtra has seen a reduction of 1.5 per cent to 12.02 lh (12.21 lh).

However, Uttar Pradesh has seen a 33 per cent rise in area to 4.95 lh (3.73 lh), whereas Gujarat has seen an increase of 11 per cent to 3.3 lh (2.97 lh). Other states like Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh have seen an increase in area.

NO CLEAR PICTURE YET
Commenting on the current kharif tur crop, Kothari said that though there were concerns about deficit rainfall hurting production in key States such as Karnataka and Maharashtra, a clearer picture would emerge by mid-October, as rain was reported in some States.

On Monday, tur prices firmed up by ₹50-100 per quintal across various markets due to rising concerns that drought will hurt the 2026 crop prospects.

Rainfall in September was only 5 per cent below normal

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The daily rainfall departure from normal during September ranged from a 59 per cent deficit to a 162 per cent surplus, bringing the overall rainfall for the month within the normal range so far. It also helped to bridge the overall deficit in the season since June 1 to 12 per cent against a 14 per cent shortfall until August 31.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD), which predicted below-normal rainfall for September, said on Monday that the monthly rainfall this month so far was 5 per cent below normal at 152.6 mm.

On September 26, when India received 162 per cent surplus rain, which is the highest single-day rainfall in the entire monsoon season, as many as four meteorological subdivisions received over 1,500 per cent above normal rain — west Uttar Pradesh 3,003 per cent, east Madhya Pradesh 1,580 per cent, Chhattisgarh 1,537 per cent and east Uttar Pradesh 1,518 per cent.



FATAL DOWNPOUR. As many as 56 people were killed in rain-related incidents in Uttar Pradesh between Sept 25 and 27 ANI

56 LIVES LOST
In Uttar Pradesh, a few districts which received over 150 mm of rainfall on September 26 include Kheri (163.9 mm actual vs 2.7 mm normal), Banda (153.1 mm vs 2.2 mm), Bahraich (193.1mm vs 3.9 mm), Shahjahanpur (162.1 mm vs 1.6 mm) and Hamirpur (164.8 mm vs 1.3 mm).

As many as 56 people were killed in rain-and-storm-related incidents in Uttar Pradesh between September 25 and September 27 as several districts grappled with water inundation in both rural and urban areas.

The depression over the State weakened into a well-marked low-pressure area on Sunday, bringing some respite from rainfall.

State government data show that 31,173.5 hectares in 2,415 villages (in 15 districts) were inundated with river floodwater as of September 27.

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Monday pointed out the challenges posed by climate change.

He said while Karnataka, Maharashtra and some other States were struggling to manage drought-induced distress, in other parts heavy rain caused damage to crops as well as human lives.

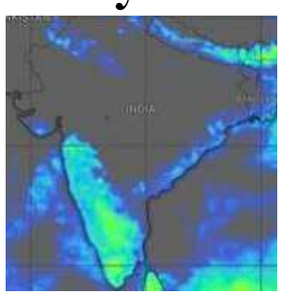
Heavy rain likely in South Peninsula: IMD

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

With just three days left in the South-West monsoon season, the Bay of Bengal has stirred into another bout of activity, with an incoming weather pulse from Thailand intensifying rapidly over the weekend into a depression by Monday morning.

The development was flagged by *businessline* eight days ago, based on the India Meteorological Department's (IMD) numerical model guidance.

The latest depression, however, is unlikely to turn towards the Indian coast. The IMD said it could strengthen into a deep depression by Monday evening and move along and off the Myanmar coast towards north-east and adjoining Bangladesh coast over the next three days. The depression lay over the north Andaman Sea and the adjoining Myanmar coast, about 590 km east-north-east of Mayabandar in the Andaman Islands. The system's evolution comes as the South-West monsoon steadily retreats from the mainland, clearing the stage for seasonal transition to the North-East monsoon.



The South Peninsula and western parts of peninsular India may benefit

RESIDUAL 'LOW' WEAKENS
The withdrawal line on Monday passed through Gurdaspur, Chandigarh, Muzaffarnagar, Aligarh, Dholpur, Udaipur, Deesa and Naliya, marking further retreat across Punjab, Chandigarh-Haryana-Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Gujarat.

A residual low-pressure area over east Uttar Pradesh, remnant of the preceding deep depression, has weakened as the withdrawal accelerated across northern India. The transition is expected to become evident first over the Arabian Sea, where south-westerly winds may give way to easterlies by around October 7. The Bay could take slightly longer to fall into step, with short-to medium-range guidance pointing to a shift around October 12.

That change in wind regime could open the door to a fresh spell of rain and thunderstorms across larger Peninsular India and the South Peninsula, even as the South-West monsoon formally winds down. The IMD outlook points to a broadening spell of rain and thunderstorms from the middle of the week.

Isolated heavy rain is expected over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal for three days and south interior Karnataka, Kerala and Mahe for four days from Wednesday. Rainfall is likely to be isolated to scattered over coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam, Lakshadweep, north interior Karnataka, Rayalaseema, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal for the next six days.

DEFICIT NARROWS
The departing monsoon has nevertheless managed to make some late gains in the national rainfall balance. The track of the 'low' from the Bay northwards to east Uttar Pradesh helped narrow the country's cumulative rainfall deficit by about three percentage points from last week to 12 per cent as of Sunday.

The South Peninsula saw its deficit improve to 23 per cent, while the North-East reduced its shortfall to 25 per cent. North-West India, with a 6 per cent deficit, and Central India, at 2 per cent, remained within the normal rainfall category.

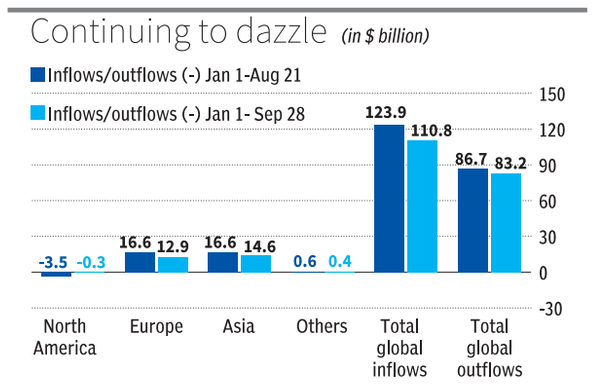
Inflows into gold ETFs continue to be positive

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Investments in physically backed gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) were positive for the tenth week in a row last week, but outflows almost matched the inflows, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed.

Data showed that while US investors led the exits from ETFs, UK investors led the inflows, though they tended to be cautious, in general. While $1.72 billion was invested in gold ETFs last week, redemptions were to the tune of $1.59 billion.

The trend follows an over 6 per cent fall in the price of the yellow metal in the past month and an over 4 per cent decline in the past week. On Monday, gold was down 3 per cent to around $4,150 an ounce.



Source: WGC

PUNISHING WEEK
"Gold had a punishing week, with spot gold down about 2 per cent. The pressure came from rates, not fading haven appeal: A firmer dollar, 10-year Treasury yields near 5.5 per cent and a hot flash PMI raising bets on another Fed hike in October," said Prathiviraj Kothari, Managing Director at RiddiSiddhi Bullions Ltd and President of the India Bullion and Jewellers Association Ltd.

"Gold will remain sensitive to US economic data, Fed expectations, the dollar and geopolitical developments, while the festive and wedding season should provide some support to domestic demand," said Darshan Desai, CEO, Aspect Bullion & Refinery.

Last week, US investors redeemed $683 million, while the British invested $438 million. Others who invested were Chinese ($81 million), Canadians ($72.8 million), Swiss ($64.9 million), Germans ($58.5 million) and French ($48.8 million). Data for India was not available.

EU, ASIANS AT PAR
Year-to-date, net investments by Europeans and Asians were almost at par, at $16.56 million each. Country-wise, investors in the UK ($9.40 billion) edged ahead of those in China ($9.33 billion), followed by Indians at $4.21 billion.

Inflows from the US were $3.68 billion, from Switzerland $3.26 billion, Germany $1.98 billion, France $1.91 billion and the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region $1.01 billion.

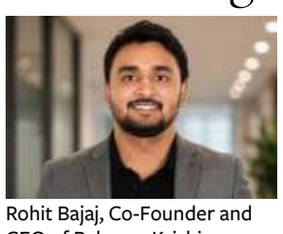
A slew of data, such as US labour, inflation, employment, the PCE price index and non-farm payrolls, could decide the direction of gold, said Renisha Chainani, Head of Research at Augmont. "The near-term picture hinges on US inflation, Fed speakers and any breakthrough or breakdown in Iran talks."

Balwaan Krishi raises ₹100 cr in Series B funding

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Agri equipment and farm machinery maker Balwaan Krishi has raised ₹100 crore in Series B funding to accelerate its next growth phase across manufacturing, distribution and product development. First Bridge India Growth Fund Private Equity led the round, with participation from other institutional investors.

A statement said the new capital will be deployed across strategic priorities, including expanding domestic manufacturing capacity, strengthening dealer and service network across South India and developing the next-gen of farm equipment, enabled with predictive maintenance and IoT capability. A significant portion of the funding will be used to deepen manufacturing capabilities.



Rohit Bajaj, Co-Founder and CEO of Balwaan Krishi

Rohit Bajaj, Co-Founder and CEO of Balwaan Krishi, said, "Small and marginal farmers are increasingly facing rising labour costs and pressure to improve productivity, yet access to affordable mechanisation remains limited. This funding allows us to strengthen manufacturing, broaden our reach and continue building products specifically for Indian farming conditions."

India should push recycling to build reserves, says head of global copper body's Indian arm

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

India should recycle copper as a strategic intervention and promote recycling to keep more stocks of the red metal in the years to come, International Copper Association India (ICAI) Managing Director Mayur Karmarkar has said.

"We need to start building reserves. They can be built by substituting with other materials for which we already have the reserves in the form of mines," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

As an overall strategy, India needs to have more copper. "What you buy today is always cheaper than buying it tomorrow. There is a study done by Nanjing University in China, which said above-the-ground stocks in China are more in terms of volume than below-the-ground."



International Copper Association India Managing Director Mayur Karmarkar

LESS THAN CHINA, EU
Karmarkar said as per data, "we have only 15 million tonnes of copper" in the region. In comparison, China has over 120 million tonnes and the European Union 80 million tonnes. "Overall, our functional reserves per capita are low, so India should buy copper today as a national resource strategy from wherever it is available and keep that within the economy, which is to keep recycling, avoiding exports of scraps or any recycled copper."

"For example, the Ministry of Mines has projected demand at 10 million tonnes. If we need to import the entire 10 million tonnes from the mines or say 95 per cent in concentrate form, then we could be spending something like $140 billion," he said, adding that recycling is better than underground reserves, which India does not have.

THE GOLD LOGIC
"If you look at the economy, our entire cost will be lower because we will be only recycling copper," said Karmarkar, adding that the logic of a family buying small amounts of gold over the years should be applied to copper too.

On the impact of soaring copper prices, he said since India was using bare minimum copper, no major change is expected in the demand pattern or trend.

"Our copper demand growth is rising at the rate of 9 plus per cent, which is a little more than the GDP growth, and it would continue. So, there won't be any big change in the incremental change overall in the relative material cost because we have to look at the relative material cost with the other competing materials," he said.

Stay out of natural gas as prices may move either way

Gurumurthy K
BL Research Bureau

Natural gas prices have risen sharply in the past week. The natural gas futures contract traded on the Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX)

COMMODITY CALL.

surged to a high of ₹318.50 per mmBtu on Thursday last week. However, it has come down from there and is currently trading at ₹301 per mmBtu.

OUTLOOK
The rise last week has taken the MCX natural gas contract well above the key resistance level of ₹284. But the inability to sustain the rise and a pullback from the high of ₹318.50 indicate that the momentum has faded.

Strong resistance is around ₹320. Supports are at ₹292 and ₹285. So, ₹285-₹320 can be the broader trading range that looks possible for now. Within that, the price is now poised almost at the midpoint of the range.

So, there are equal chances for the price to move on either side from the current levels. That leaves the immediate outlook unclear.

We need to wait for a breakout on either side of ₹285 or ₹320 to get clarity on the next direction of the move. A breakout above ₹320 could take the MCX natural gas contract higher to ₹327. On the other hand, a break below ₹285 could drag the price down to ₹273.

TRADE STRATEGY
Since the price can go either way from here, it is better to stay out of the market.

QUICKLY.

FASTag annual passes cross one crore milestone



New Delhi: The total number of 'FASTag Annual Pass' has crossed one crore since its launch on August 15 last year, reflecting strong adoption among National Highway users, an official statement said on Monday. The annual pass eliminates the need to frequently recharge FASTag through a one-time fee payment of ₹3,075 for one year validity or 200 toll plaza crossings. PTI

Tata firm, MDS to build aero engine testing infra

New Delhi: Tata Projects on Monday said it has forged a strategic partnership with Canada-based MDS Aero Support Corporation to advance aero-engine testing infrastructure in India. The collaboration brings together Tata Projects' advanced infrastructure capabilities and MDS Aero's global expertise in gas turbine engine testing, a company statement said. PTI

Maharashtra FDA continues crack down

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration has suspended 30 food licences and seized over 50 tonnes of food stocks worth ₹1.19 crore between September 23 and 27 as part of a Statewide crackdown. Action was initiated against several establishments, including Kyani & Co, Colaba Sweet Mart, Arun Vilas Farsan, Ruchi Veg Restaurant, Daffodils Fast Food Inn and Subway over alleged violations of food safety and hygiene requirements, FDA said. PTI

From fuel restriction to 50% WFH, Delhi's winter pollution curbs kick in from Nov 1

PREVENTIVE MOVES. Measures will remain in place through February but essential services are exempt

Our Bureau
New Delhi



CLAMP DOWN. The "No PUCC, no fuel" drive will cover all 500 automatic number plate recognition-enabled fuel stations in Delhi, with action against those violating the requirement REUTERS

New Delhi will enforce its 'Winter Pollution Master Plan' from November 1 to combat seasonal air pollution. Key rules include "No pollution under control certificate, no fuel", restrictions on non-Delhi BS-VI vehicles, 50 per cent work from home for offices, doubled parking charges and construction curbs.

The measures will remain in force through February. During winter, falling temperatures, low winds, dust, vehicular emissions and crop residue burning can push the air quality into the "very poor" and "severe" categories.

Following a meeting between Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and her colleagues, the government announced a slew of measures from November 1 to February 28. Government offices will follow staggered timings, with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi operating from 8.30 am to 5 pm and the Delhi government from 10 am to 6.30 pm.

EXEMPTIONS
Essential services such as healthcare, emergency services, public transport, power, water and sanitation will remain exempt.

Restrictions will remain in place on dust-generating demolition and outdoor construction from November 1 to January 31.

The government also announced a complete construction and demolition ban from December 10 to January 20, barring essential projects, mandatory dust-control measures at construction sites; restrictions on the entry of non-BS-VI vehicles registered outside Delhi, and intensified action against the open burning of waste and biomass. Simultaneously, it was decided to step up hotspot-specific interventions, traffic management, public transport and last-mile connectivity measures. The winter pollution framework is designed to ensure that the restrictions are imposed in advance rather than only after the air quality has deteriorated and the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) is triggered. Parking charges at authorised facilities will be doubled during the winter period, while Delhi Metro Rail Corporation parking facilities will remain exempt.

Construction sites will be monitored through the government's Dust Portal, including the use of cameras and sensors, while anti-smog guns and mist-suppression systems will be required at major sites.

CRITICAL PERIOD
The "No PUCC, no fuel" drive will cover all 500 automatic number plate recognition-enabled fuel stations in the national capital, with action against stations violating the requirement.

At the review meeting, Yadav emphasised, "The coming months are crucial for Delhi's air quality management. Timely completion of planned interventions, strict enforcement and coordinated action on the ground are essential to protect public health and improve the quality of life for citizens."

"Air pollution control requires collective responsibility and continuous action at every level. The Centre remains committed to working closely with the Delhi government and all stakeholders to ensure cleaner air for the people of Delhi," he added.

Gupta stressed that the government wanted to move away from a reactive approach to winter pollution. The framework was notified well in advance so that citizens, industries, institutions and construction agencies have time to prepare.

J&K Assembly resolves to seek early statehood

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar



Jammu & Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah addresses the House ANI

The Jammu and Kashmir Assembly on Monday adopted a resolution seeking the early restoration of full Statehood to the Union Territory.

The resolution, introduced by Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on September 25, was taken up for discussion after Question Hour. It was passed amid noisy scenes, with BJP legislators objecting to the references to autonomy and special status in the resolution. The party's legislators then staged a walk out.

As the resolution was taken up for discussion, BJP MLAs entered the well of the House and raised slogans, including *"Giste giste gis gaya, 370 haar gaya"* (Slowly, slowly, it slipped away; Article 370 was lost) and *"Bharat Mata ki Jai"*. They also demanded that Speaker Abdul Rahim Rather vacate the Chair, claiming that 23 legislators had moved against him, and insisting that the matter be put to a vote.

The Speaker said a written notice of a motion against him had to be submitted at least 14 days in advance for it to be included in the Assembly's business. Leader of the Opposition Sunil Sharma said the BJP would support the Statehood resolution only if the government removed references to autonomy and special status.

MLAs from National Conference, Congress, Peoples Democratic Party and CPI (M) supported the resolution, while the BJP legislators staged a walkout. Ten amendments were moved by legislators, including those from the ruling National Conference, seeking to include Article 370 and 35 A in the resolution. The resolution moved by the Chief Minister had sought the restoration of full Statehood while referring to the previous resolutions of autonomy and special status passed in 2000 and 2024 respectively.

'APPROPRIATE TIME'
Addressing the House during the debate, Abdullah said the resolution made no mention of autonomy or special status. "Show me where in the resolution we have mentioned 35 A and 370? Unfortunately some colleagues have fallen into their trap", Abdullah said.

He urged the legislators not to press for the proposed amendments, saying they could provide the BJP with an excuse to oppose the resolution. Abdullah said the Supreme Court had directed the Centre to restore Statehood at the earliest and "as soon as possible". "Now the Central government is saying that Statehood will be restored at an appropriate time. I want to ask the government what is the appropriate time," he said.

Questioning whether the restoration of Statehood was being linked to the security situation, Abdullah said that if the Centre intended to withhold Statehood until militancy ended, it would effectively mean that the decision rested with Islamabad rather than New Delhi.

Abdullah revealed that the Chief Secretary and the Law Secretary had told the Speaker that the issue of statehood was *sub judice*, questioning why he had not been consulted as the Law Minister and saying that he had not seen the letters.

BonV Aero supplies 45 logistic UAVs for high altitude ops

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Odisha-based start-up BonV Aero has supplied 45 logistic unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) to the Army's Eastern Command to support high-altitude tactical missions, including the quick movement of critical supplies and operation-specific payloads across the challenging north-eastern region.

The deliveries were part of a contract BonV Aero signed in March with the Army for UAVs that can operate in EW challenged environment at high altitude between 10,000 feet to 15,000 feet, said Satyabrata Satapathy, Co-founder & CEO of the start-up. They can carry payload of up to 10 kg with 40-45 minutes of flying, he said.

The Eastern Command operates across a diverse geographical area, from forested and riverine stretches to high-altitude Himalayan posts. During the monsoon, flooding and landslides can disrupt road routes, while higher-altitude locations face snow and rapidly changing weather.

The delivered UAV systems, said the company, are purpose-built for multi-role frontline operations, providing a resilient aerial logistics capability to transport critical supplies, equipment, and mission-configured payloads.

The Ministry of Defence recently floated a tender for 2,715 logistics drones, reflecting their growing role in frontline operations, including moving essential supplies and other mission-critical payloads across challenging terrain.

ENHANCED CAPABILITY
"As these systems become more capable, the focus will be on improving payload capacity, range, reliability, ease of deployment, field-level maintenance and mission adaptability, while ensuring they can be effectively sustained and integrated into frontline operations," observed Satapathy. So far, the start-up has supplied 70 logistics drones to the armed forces in the last three years, with some of them even deployed along the borders during the Operation Sindoor.

In addition, the company has trained more than 150 Army personnel on its systems in the Northern Command.

BonV Aero holds a world record for carrying a 30-kg payload to 19,024 feet at Umling La. The operation took place in low oxygen and extreme cold, that test flight performance and operational planning, said the company.

CM launches one-gram gold ring scheme for newborns

Press Trust of India
Madurai



Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay launched the Thaaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Monday launched the 22-carat one-gram gold ring scheme, the Thaaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam (Maternal Uncle Gold Ring Scheme) — for newborn babies, fulfilling a key electoral promise.

Rolling out the scheme at the Government Rajaji Hospital here, Vijay held the babies for a while and gave away the gold rings.

FUND ALLOCATION
The government has earmarked ₹755.83 crore for the scheme.

The welfare initiative is aimed at honouring motherhood, promoting women's health and encouraging institutional births by attracting more families to public healthcare.

The police had put in place a five-tier security arrangement in the city.

The State government has already procured 1.28 lakh gold rings for the initial rollout of the programme targeting the children born in State-run hospitals.

The scheme applies to eligible babies born on or after June 22, 2026.

Apex court slams authorities; says sexual offences in Delhi-NCR a failure of law enforcement, administration

Aaratrika Bhaumik
New Delhi



The Supreme Court on Monday took *suo motu* cognisance of a spate of sexual assault incidents against minors and women in the Delhi-National Capital Region, and sought a response from the Delhi police, observing that public spaces cannot be allowed to become "zones of high risk" because of "lax patrolling and other preventable administrative deficiencies."

A Bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran took note of several recent cases of sexual violence reported in the national capital, including the rape of a 17-year-old at Astha Kunj park near Lady Shri Ram College, the gang-rape of a minor at Swaroop Nagar, and the sexual assault of another minor inside a bus travelling from Greater Noida to Delhi.

"These incidents, considered alongside recent reports of sexual offences across Delhi-NCR, starkly underline the failure of law enforcement and public administration authorities to guarantee basic public safety. The right to live with dignity, free from the fear of violence, is an intrinsic facet of the fundamental guarantee of life and personal liberty enshrined under Article 21 of the Constitution," the Bench said.

'PAINFUL PARALLEL'
The Bench further observed that public spaces, including roads, buses, Metro stations, footbridges and subways, cannot be permitted to become "zones of high risk" because of inadequate illumination, poor surveillance, lax patrolling, and other preventable administrative deficiencies.

Expressing serious concern over the gang-rape of the teenager in bus that travelled nearly 47 km from Greater Noida to Kashmere Gate in Delhi without being stopped at a single police picket earlier this month, the apex court said it could not help but "draw painful parallels with the 2012 Nirbhaya case". The incident, it said, called into question whether systemic law enforcement mechanisms had made any "meaningful progress" in the decade since then.

While acknowledging that statements by public authorities and elected representatives expressing concern over such incidents were understandable,"Expressing solidarity is not a solution to this social evil. What is required is a measurable response with responsibility and accountability being fixed upon the authorities entrusted with prevention of crime, maintenance of public order and protection of vulnerable persons," the Bench added.

The court also questioned the police response in the Astha Kunj case, taking note of reports that students of Lady Shri Ram College had previously complained of instances of sexual harassment in the area that had gone unaddressed. "Regrettably, these complaints failed to rectify the security lapses through advanced surveillance," it said.

Link traffic e-challans to power bills for recovery: SC

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday noted that the States and Union territories have a massive outstanding balance of ₹20,000 crore in unpaid traffic e-challans and suggested linking such challans to electricity bills to recover the amount.

A Bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and KV Viswanathan was informed that despite issuing a vast number of traffic challans, recovery of fines is minimal.

SNOWBALL PAYMENTS
"If people are not paying traffic challans, add it to their electricity dues bill. They will have to pay electricity bills else power line will be disconnected. Work it out. In this country, you have to find a way out," the Bench remarked.

The suggestion came after the top court was apprised that the States and UTs had an outstanding of around ₹45,000 crore towards e-challans, of which approximately ₹25,000 crore had been recovered so far.

'BLACK LIST VEHICLES'
The apex court also suggested blacklisting vehicles which have not paid challans on the Parivahan portal and blocking ownership transfers.

Justice Pardiwala said authorities need to work at the ground level. "Let there be random checking of vehicles and if found that e-challan has not been honoured, necessary steps to be taken to impound the vehicle itself," the bench said.

The top court was hearing a plea concerning comprehensive systemic reforms in road safety, traffic enforcement, and post-accident victim care.

Be an entrepreneur rather than job seeker, says TN Assembly speaker

Our Bureau
Chennai



(From left) JCD Prabhakar, Assembly Speaker
T Ramesh Dugar, President, Hindustan Chamber of Commerce; Praveen Kumar Tatia, President of HCC and GSK Velu, CMD, Trivitron Healthcare in Chennai on Monday BIJOY GHOSH

Youngsters should aim to become job creators rather than job seekers. While getting a job, only the individual benefits. However, when the same person becomes an entrepreneur, he/she can provide jobs to many, said JCD Prabhakar, Speaker, Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly.

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam government headed by C Joseph Vijay, provides a 'transparent' administration and will provide all the necessary help to the business community, he said at the 80th annual session of the Hindustan Chamber of Commerce, in Chennai.

There is transparency in starting new businesses, and everything is based on open tender, he said, citing the recent gold ring scheme for newborns as an example.

GSK Velu, CMD, Trivitron Healthcare, said "If you really want an economy to grow, entrepreneurship has to be interwoven with the economic growth objective if India wants to achieve the 2047 Viksit Bharat India at 100."

"If India wants to achieve its objective, entrepreneurs have to play a big role," he added. At the 80th annual session, Praveen Kumar Tatia was unanimously elected as the President. The session also marked the virtual inauguration of the chamber's new office to enhance member services and creating a more contemporary platform for its continued engagement with trade and industry, said a release.

To protect buyers, TNRERA tightens norms for layout registration; mandates basic infra before registration

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



Developers are required to ensure that essential infrastructure is in place before registration

The Tamil Nadu Real Estate Regulatory Authority (TNRERA) has tightened scrutiny of layout registrations, insisting that developers complete basic infrastructure and amenities before projects are registered. Of the 5,119 layout applications received since January, 3,056 (about 60 per cent) have been registered.

In comparison, building registrations have seen a higher registration rate of 74 per cent, with 308 of 415 applications registered, said sources.

BASIC INFRA
Under the tighter approach, developers are required to ensure that essential infrastructure is in place before registration. This includes roads, storm-water drains, water supply facilities, street lights, entrance arches, development of open space reservation and proper marking of plots.

"While submitting the layout, we now insist on completion of all the infrastructure like roads and storm water drains. We need to protect the buyers," said an official.

WELCOME MOVE
The tighter scrutiny is being viewed positively by organised developers, though they acknowledge that it could extend project development timelines.

Ranjeeth Rathod, Managing Director, DRA Homes, said the State's insistence on completing basic infrastructure could delay development, but was necessary to protect buyers. "Many developers in the past used to get approval on undeveloped layouts. It is a welcome change," he said.

According to Rathod, such practices were largely seen among developers outside the Credai ecosystem, where developers generally follow prescribed procedures. It was more prevalent in B and C towns, he said.

The tightening of norms should ultimately improve the quality of plotted developments and reduce the burden on civic infrastructure.

However, clear standards, defined timelines and a predictable approval and registration process are needed to ensure genuine projects are not unnecessarily delayed, he said.

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QUICKLY.

Truecaller launches scam checker tool for users



Mumbai: Truecaller launched Scam Checker, a new tool available on its website and Android app that allows users to verify suspicious phone numbers, web links and messages in one place. Users can paste a suspicious link to check for phishing, look up a number for community-reported warnings, search a database of scam reports called Scamfeed, or describe a suspicious message in plain text to get relevant results. OUR BUREAU

Morepen files first US drug application

Mumbai: Morepen Laboratories Ltd submitted its first abbreviated new drug application to the US Food and Drug Administration on September 25, 2026, for sitagliptin tablets USP in three dosage strengths. OUR BUREAU

New Air India CEO puts focus on profitability and reliability

FIRST TOWNHALL. Safety, sustainable expansion among top priorities: Gebremariam

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Tata Group-led Air India will focus on improving revenue as well as cost performance while strengthening safety and operational reliability, said Tewolde Gebremariam, the airline's Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director-designate.

Speaking to employees at his first company-wide townhall, Gebremariam, who will assume charge after receiving all necessary regulatory approvals, said sustainable profitability remains a key objective.

Accordingly, revenue enhancement initiatives across the airline's international network, commercial activities and cargo business are under discussion.

Besides, Air India plans to introduce programmes to reward employee ideas that deliver measurable cost savings and operational efficiencies.

"We must improve both revenue and cost performance. Revenue enhancement initiatives are already under discussion, including opportunities across our international network, commercial activities and cargo business," he said.

> Air India plans to introduce programmes to reward employee ideas that deliver measurable cost savings and operational efficiencies
>
> **TEWOLDE GEBREMARIAM**
> CEO and MD-designate



EXTERNAL FACTORS

While acknowledging that external factors have affected the airline's path to break-even, Gebremariam emphasised the need to maintain focus on financial performance. "Cost management is not just the responsibility of leadership, every employee can contribute to savings, and those savings add up across an organisation of our scale," he said.

Notably, Gebremariam's remarks come as the airline navigates geopolitical developments, airspace restrictions affecting Indian carriers, elevated fuel prices and uncertainty in key international markets. On expansion, Gebremariam said scale is critical in an industry characterised by high capital investment, significant fixed costs and intense competition.

However, he pointed out that growth would need to be supported by readiness across the airline's people, fleet and network. "Growth is the oxygen of business. But growth must also be profitable and sustainable. We will pursue expansion in a disciplined manner and ensure our people, fleet and network are ready to support it," he said.

Furthermore, Gebremariam said that Air India continues to evaluate opportunities to improve network efficiency, optimise fleet deployment and rebalance operations to strengthen its long-term competitiveness.

At the same time, Gebremariam identified safety as the airline's foremost priority, calling for a culture in which employees can raise concerns and report issues without hesitation. "The stronger our reporting culture, the stronger our safety culture," he said.

On operational reliability, he emphasised punctuality, baggage handling, transparent communication during disruptions and quicker service recovery as key to strengthening customer confidence.

What are FSSAI's proposed 'front of pack' warning labels

bl.explainer

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

In a move that will reshape the packaged food and beverage industry landscape in the country, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has proposed introducing a framework for the front-of-the-pack warning labels for products that are high in fat, sugar and salt.

The regulator has made its submission to the Supreme Court regarding this proposal.

What is the front of the pack warning labels framework? How is the FSSAI proposing to implement the same?

Front of pack nutrition labelling (FoPL) is simplified nutrition information on the front of food packaging that aims to help consumers to make better food choices. This informs consumers regarding products that are high in fats, sugar and salt.

Experts believe such a warning label framework will also nudge packaged food and beverage companies to focus on reformulation of their products and reduce the levels of salt, sugar and fat in their products in the long term.

As per its submissions to the Supreme Court, the FSSAI is proposing to provide information relating to added sugar, added fat and salt in pictorial form on the front-of-pack.

The proposal is intended to provide a simple, prominent and easily comprehensible warning to consumers regarding food products, which are high in added sugar, salt and fat.

The warning labels will have three components. This will include a white square



shaped background, a red hexagon within the white square and declaration regarding nutrients of concern within the red hexagon.

The FSSAI's proposal states that the warning label would be displayed prominently on the top left of the front of the pack, ensuring clear visibility and legibility to consumers.

The proposed warning symbol would be displayed in a font size at least one point larger than used in the nutrition information table at the back of the pack.

In the case of beverages containing 'non-caloric sweetener', it has also been proposed for display a warning statement 'contains non-caloric sweetener' on the front of the pack.

What are the thresholds for a product to be considered high in fat, sugar and salt?

The food safety regulator has said that it will adopt threshold values for added sugar, added fat and salt as provided in the Dietary Guidelines for Indians, 2024, issued by ICMR-NIN, for the purpose of FoPL.

For instance, for solid foods, the threshold for sugar has been calculated at 5 per cent energy from added sugar and not exceeding 10 per cent energy from total sugar.

In liquids, the threshold for sugar has been calculated at 10 per cent energy from added sugar and not exceeding 30 per cent energy from total sugar, including naturally present sugar.

What are the timelines for the implementation for the FoPL framework?

FSSAI has conveyed to the Supreme Court in its submission that it proposes to adopt the FoPL framework through a 'single phase approach' rather than the earlier suggested 'two-phase approach'.

It has also said that a period of four months will be reasonably required for issuing and finalising the draft regulations which will involve a consultation process with stakeholders, after which it will finalise and notify the regulations.

It has also said that it proposes to keep a voluntary transition period of 365 days for packaged food and beverage companies to ensure they do not face any commercial hardships. Companies usually buy and print packaging material and labels in advance and will require time to exhaust these inventories.

On Monday, the SC questioned the FSSAI regarding these timelines and the need for fresh consultation. The FSSAI counsel informed the court that it had earlier proposed to bring a star-rating format, which is different from the current proposal.

Is the FSSAI proposing to exempt some products?

The FSSAI has proposed exempting single-ingredient food products and food products which are inherently rich in fat, sugar or salt, such as *ghee*, edible oil, salt, sugar, jaggery and honey, subject to the applicability of other requirements under the food safety and labelling regulations.

SC reserves ruling on FSSAI's warning label matter

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday questioned the FSSAI on the timeline required of four months and the consultation process and said why it wants to waste so much time when the matter relates to the health of citizens.

It reserved its judgement in the matter related to front-of-the-pack (FoPL) labelling regulations for the packaged food industry. The bench directed all parties to file their final written submissions within three days. It said whatever order it passes will be binding on the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI).

Questioning the FSSAI, the bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran remarked: "We appreciate whatever you have done so far and we appreciate your initiative but there is a lot which is required to be done to give meaningful effect to what we want to achieve... Why voluntary compliance for a year? Why do you need so much time? Why do you want to start afresh with the exercise of hearing and calling for objections? You started in 2022 what did you do in the last four years."

DIFFERENT FORMAT

The counsel for FSSAI told the court that what was initiated in 2022 was the Indian Nutrition Rating (INR) star-rating system, which is different from the current format.

"Today we are hearing all the parties concerned and whatever order we now pass, it will be binding on the Authority and we expect you to understand it and implement it scrupulously. We are undertaking this entire exercise for the good of the nation and the citizens. So, we expect the Authority to accept and comply with the order in its true spirit... Do not disappoint us," Justice JB Pardiwala said while hearing the matter.

The FSSAI had earlier submitted to the Court that it is proposing warning labels in a red Hexagon with a white square format. In its submission, it also said that "a period of four months will be reasonably required" to follow the regulatory process, which involves issuing and finalising the draft regulations. It also proposed a one-year period for packaged food companies to voluntarily transition to the front-of-the-pack labelling after notification.

The top court was hearing a public interest litigation (PIL) petition filed by non-profit organisation 3S and Our Health Society, seeking the introduction of FoPL guidelines on the lines of those in foreign jurisdictions. .

DOUBLE DELIGHT



JAVELIN TWINS. Yashvir Singh (left) and Rohit Yadav with the tricolour after winning the silver and bronze medals in the men's javelin throw final event during the ongoing Asian Games 2026 in Nagoya, Japan, on Monday PTI

SpaceX's Starship reaches orbit for first time in major test flight

Bloomberg



SpaceX's massive Starship rocket reached orbit for the first time on Monday, achieving a milestone for the programme after the mission briefly looked at risk because an engine failed during ascent.

Starship took off at 7.49 am local time out of SpaceX's Starbase launch facility in South Texas, embarking on what could be a nearly 10-hour-long test flight. The rocket was carrying 26 of the company's upgraded Starlink satellites, which the vehicle successfully deployed in orbit to join the existing internet-from-space network.

'VERY SMOOTH'

"Each satellite that we've deployed has, from what we can tell, has looked good," said SpaceX spokesperson Dan Huot. "Very smooth."

As Starship climbed to space, one of its six Raptor engines cut out early, leading SpaceX engineers to temporarily call off the attempt to send the rocket to orbit. However, after looking through the data, the team pressed on with the attempt, burning one of Starship's Raptor engines and putting the vehicle in orbit for the first time.

Monday's test flight — Starship's 14th — is a key moment for SpaceX, as all of the rocket's other space launches until now have purposefully fallen short of orbit to maximise safety. Now, US regulators have approved SpaceX to take Starship to the next step, trusting that the company can safely transport the rocket to orbital speeds and bring the vehicle back to Earth in a controlled manner.

If successful, the flight could open the door to many more orbital flights. With this launch, SpaceX will be adding its first upgraded Starlink satellites, known as V3s, to the company's growing 11,000-plus spacecraft network already in orbit. Starship deployed V3 Starlink satellites on a previous launch, but they ultimately burned up in Earth's atmosphere as planned.

SpaceX Chief Financial Officer Bret Johnsen has called this mission a "revenue-generating flight" for the company, since the V3 satellites are production quality and will be integrated in the overall network. SpaceX Chief Executive Officer Elon Musk has also made big claims about the V3 spacecraft increasing the overall capacity of Starlink.

"We do expect a very rapid increase in revenue from Starlink communications from the V3 satellite," Musk said during SpaceX's first-ever earnings call in August. He added that the satellite is "more than 10 times the capability of the V2 satellite, and we'll be launching 10 times as many."

Air India will resume Delhi, Tel Aviv flights from Dec 1

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

Israel's Ministry of Tourism on Monday said that Air India will resume its direct flights between Delhi and Tel Aviv from December 1, 2026, restoring a key air link between India and Israel.

Air India will be the only airline operating non-stop flights between the two countries, with five weekly flights scheduled from Sunday through Thursday aboard Boeing 777 aircraft, the Israel Ministry of Tourism said.

The resumption of Air India's flights on December 1, is expected to provide further momentum to tourism ties between India and Israel and make the destination more accessible to new segments of Indian travellers.

"The return of Air India's direct flights is an important development for tourism. For Indian travellers, the restoration of a regular non-stop connection makes the journey more convenient and gives them greater flexibility when planning a visit to Israel," Israel Ministry of Tourism, India, Consul for Tourism Affairs Galit Hoffman said.

IMPORTANT MARKET

She said India remains an important market for Israel, and direct air connectivity has a significant role to play in supporting the growth of travel between our two countries. India was already a significant source market for Israel before the Covid-19 pandemic, with nearly 70,000 Indian visitors annually.

"We would like more Indian travellers to discover the many different sides of Israel, beyond its longstanding appeal for pilgrimage and spiritual travel," she added.

Air India Flight AI139 will depart Delhi at 5 am and arrive in Tel Aviv at 8.30 am, with a flight time of approximately seven hours.

Red Bull moves Delhi HC against FSSAI's ban on 'energy drink' label

Reuters
New Delhi

Austrian beverage-maker Red Bull has sued India's food regulatory authority Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) for prohibiting the use of the 'energy drink' descriptor without issuing any warning notice, which it claims is impacting its investments in India, its filing in the Delhi High Court said.

Red Bull is one of a number of globally recognised brands to have sued the FSSAI in recent months amid an unprecedented food standards enforcement drive, which has included surprise raids and scrutiny over legal compliance impacting companies like Diageo.

India, in June, ordered the makers of high-caffeine beverages sold as 'energy drinks' to stop using that description, rejecting efforts to stall the regulatory intervention in a market expected to be worth $1.6 billion by 2028.

The move has triggered a stand-off as Pepsi, RedBull, Monster Beverage and billionaire Mukesh Ambani's Reliance fear removing the category label could damage brands built around instant-energy claims.

HC FILING

In the first legal challenge against the move, Red Bull told the Delhi High Court on September 25 that legal processes were not followed in prohibiting the use of the term 'energy drinks', which is globally recognised, according to its filing.

Red Bull's India unit said the "abrupt prohibition" of the descriptor, without any change to the underlying product standard, "introduces substantial regulatory uncertainty and adversely affects" its existing and planned commercial investments.



The order is against India's stated policy of facilitating "international trade, promote investment and provide greater certainty to businesses", Red Bull said, adding that its "effect is to bring the petitioner's entire business to a stand still".

A government source said that the FSSAI will defend its decision in court against Red Bull, saying that the regulator historically never allowed the use of 'energy drinks' on the label.

India's energy drinks retail sales are growing 12.6 per cent annually, faster than in the US and China, Euromonitor estimates.

The market in India boomed after Pepsi launched Sting in 2017, with its ₹20 plastic bottles proving popular among 15- to 19-year-olds, Euromonitor says. Red Bull's India revenue stood at $130 million in 2024, more than double the earnings recorded four years ago.

Energy drinks have sparked health concerns among some regulators globally who worry they contain high caffeine and sugar.

Chennai-based start-up Inbound Aerospace targets first spacecraft launch by H2 2028

Rohan Das
Chennai

IIT-Madras-incubated Inbound Aerospace is eyeing the maiden launch of a prototype of its autonomous spacecraft by the second half of 2028.

The Chennai-based space tech start-up is developing reusable upper stage space vehicles which, once injected into orbit, can independently operate using their own propulsion systems.

These autonomous and reusable vehicles could, thus, help in *niche* high-value research and manufacturing in sectors like pharma and material sciences that require microgravity environments.

Speaking to *businessline*, Co-founders Abhijeet Bhutey and Vishal Reddy said that unlike popular incumbents such as SpaceX's Dragon and Russia's Soyuz that cannot precisely control where they land, Inbound's spacecraft can land at a designated point.



(L-R) Inbound Aerospace Founders Abhijit Bhutey, Aravind B and Vishal Reddy

LANDING TECH

"Most spacecraft use circular parachutes that reliably slow the rate of descent. But what they cannot do is precisely guide the spacecraft to the final landing point. For our spacecraft, we have a more rectangular parachute with a steering mechanism — like the ones used in skydiving — designed to to guide the payload to the final location," Reddy said.

Inbound recently completed a 1 km drop test to validate the parachute tech and is planning the next tests at 3 km, 8 km and 30 km. The company is also looking at this parachute technology as a standalone business for defence and emergency response applications.

FUNDING

As for the spacecraft, Bhutey said it had reached a technology readiness level (TRL) 4, with further developments to be done based on the launch service provider.

"For the test launch, we are still evaluating the various options like SpaceX's Falcon 9, Skyroot's Vikram and some Japanese rockets," he said.

In the long term, the company expects revenues of around $3-$4 million per launch. It is preparing for a seed round in the range of $11-25 million, primarily to secure a launch vehicle for the 2028 test mission as well as to fund further R&D.

Inbound also recently signed an agreement with Australian space infrastructure company Space Angel Group to use its facilities for landing. Bhutey said the company is looking at Australia as a landing site as India develops its re-entry ecosystem. "It is an interim thing for the next maybe two-three years," he said.

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	217.58	212.94	218.66	220.80	212.01	65.36	238.10	130.50	12	212.75
360 One WAM	1073.00	1045.00	1067.00	1074.80	1043.40	575.63	1236.20	906.05	-	-
3B Blackbio	1456.20	1584.80	1502.90	1599.00	1475.50	84.31	1599.00	1085.00	-	-
63 MoonsTe [2]	857.65	818.60	857.90	857.90	811.65	162.90	957.70	465.55	66	819.15
A										
AAA Tech	101.50	99.53	101.75	102.38	97.19	66.48	136.00	77.07	-	-
Aadhar Hsg	444.50	436.95	439.15	442.25	435.05	161.83	563.00	430.15	-	-
Aarti Drugs	427.40	429.65	430.85	442.20	425.15	442.11	533.60	318.60	23	429.05
Aarti Ind [5]	489.25	476.60	485.60	487.75	475.50	270.79	551.45	338.20	33	476.35
Aarti Pharm	939.55	914.00	940.00	946.40	910.50	528.12	962.00	585.00	-	-
Aavas	1267.70	1282.40	1256.00	1313.70	1250.00	88.61	1774.95	1050.25	15	1283.70
AB Capital	390.00	382.70	388.05	388.85	380.80	1840.67	430.55	279.05	31	381.05
AB Real Est	1230.90	1191.50	1230.90	1231.00	1181.20	335.64	1914.00	1080.10	-	-
AB Sun Life	1014.50	987.70	1010.00	1015.00	980.00	141.80	1224.90	708.00	-	-
ABB [2]	7052.50	6972.50	7038.00	7041.50	6910.50	209.20	7923.35	4640.50	96	6968.05
ABB Powerpro	31035.00	30260.00	30995.00	30995.00	30000.00	64.78	38785.00	16111.00	-	-
Abbott (I)	26955.00	26740.00	26955.00	27175.00	26530.00	5.52	30598.00	25140.50	35	26758.85
ABFRL	49.14	47.59	49.24	49.60	47.25	3614.92	88.98	47.34	-	47.63
ACC	1236.40	1213.50	1236.00	1236.40	1210.80	151.62	1986.90	1212.00	12	1213.30
ACME Solar	442.90	437.90	440.85	452.45	433.30	1868.41	476.90	195.90	-	-
Action Cons [2]	1226.60	1212.90	1226.40	1226.40	1197.50	230.43	1267.05	746.10	32	1213.05
Acutaas Chem	3272.50	3214.40	3272.50	3273.10	3184.30	202.32	3740.00	1302.00	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	2916.50	2831.10	2924.00	2924.00	2811.00	1259.53	3245.00	1753.45	115	2827.00
Adani Green	1296.60	1235.00	1290.40	1295.40	1225.60	1819.42	1631.35	767.00	298	1237.75
Adani Ports [2]	1788.00	1743.70	1788.00	1791.80	1736.60	1262.58	1891.80	1293.10	145	1741.60
Adani Pwr [2]	202.75	196.14	202.75	203.64	195.36	22266.27	254.15	128.35	32	196.30
Adani T Gas	611.65	594.45	611.50	611.50	593.00	613.17	859.85	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	184.34	180.66	183.02	184.00	180.20	686.19	282.90	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	1338.50	1287.90	1338.00	1338.00	1283.00	1230.23	1789.00	803.10	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	270.60	266.60	270.00	270.00	265.30	33.74	346.95	153.65	28	266.50
AdityaBirlaL	78.72	77.17	78.71	78.85	76.91	397.63	150.79	76.91	-	-
AdityaInfote	3687.50	3723.40	3759.90	3833.90	3710.00	164.86	4094.00	1227.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	619.50	595.15	619.50	619.50	591.20	79.66	705.00	436.55	-	-
AdorWelding	1638.90	1611.70	1630.00	1656.90	1580.00	34.16	1766.40	848.00	-	-
Advait Ener	1906.00	1867.40	1906.00	1927.90	1851.50	48.50	2485.00	1351.00	-	-
Advance Agro	123.12	121.50	123.20	125.66	120.60	359.37	154.00	84.10	-	-
Advent Hotel	126.95	124.62	127.00	127.31	122.88	85.91	345.05	120.02	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	291.15	283.15	290.00	291.20	282.00	177.01	419.80	251.90	38	283.85
Advit Jewels	286.23	265.03	282.44	282.44	263.00	861.23	308.40	161.60	-	-
Aegis Log [1]	1365.40	1308.10	1366.60	1366.60	1300.00	373.93	1528.00	576.00	36	1308.60
Aegis VopakT	287.50	298.55	287.05	301.30	280.25	2120.07	320.95	158.00	-	-
Aequs	246.05	260.10	259.00	274.00	246.96	33667.54	274.39	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	525.70	513.40	524.25	524.95	508.20	752.49	584.15	158.00	-	-
AeroflexEnt	125.64	121.66	125.64	125.64	120.79	258.60	159.60	62.20	-	-
Aether Ind	1767.00	1739.20	1768.00	1785.20	1705.00	318.33	1798.00	728.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	252.50	251.65	252.50	258.00	247.80	783.15	479.40	225.35	-	-
Affle [2]	1578.00	1548.40	1570.00	1575.50	1543.10	100.51	2011.80	1251.85	150	1548.05
AGI Greenpac	803.35	804.80	798.00	836.60	792.35	141.28	896.15	465.00	-	-
AGI Infra	264.55	271.60	267.00	276.00	257.00	3175.31	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia [2]	585.55	572.40	585.00	588.75	567.00	27.92	1076.60	560.00	17	570.20
AIA Engg [2]	3919.40	3841.40	3939.30	3939.30	3823.30	31.14	5175.00	3048.45	28	3837.35
Ajanta Ph [2]	3547.80	3525.20	3546.00	3560.00	3506.00	97.33	3796.95	2335.00	44	3530.60
Ajax Engg	607.75	589.90	614.00	618.05	585.20	174.20	697.55	394.80	-	-
Ajmera [2]	120.82	119.62	119.80	120.90	118.00	289.90	221.23	98.10	20	119.70
Akums Drugs	819.55	799.95	819.55	825.00	798.00	157.39	838.80	409.30	-	-
ALEM PHA [2]	863.75	854.35	870.00	870.00	843.65	211.65	998.00	635.30	21	854.20
Alembic Ltd [2]	106.53	106.91	106.53	108.46	105.15	828.76	117.91	70.64	22	106.83
Algoquant Fi	72.28	69.55	72.20	72.28	68.61	1207.76	76.20	47.80	-	-
Alicon [5]	730.05	716.85	730.00	730.00	712.00	33.31	1024.95	580.55	27	718.20
AlivusLife	1365.60	1345.50	1368.90	1373.10	1337.50	82.95	1493.80	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5274.00	5175.00	5254.00	5273.50	5131.00	101.71	5933.00	5052.05	28	5169.10
ALKYL AMI [2]	1847.70	1799.80	1826.30	1845.90	1791.00	35.68	2115.00	1212.35	41	1797.70
Allcargo Glo [2]	10.67	10.82	10.67	10.99	10.51	8087.05	16.18	7.10	-	10.80
Allcargo Glo	13.73	13.21	13.69	13.69	13.12	1258.67	22.00	12.03	-	-
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	115.52	116.66	124.00	126.20	113.50	5747.16	204.50	86.50	-	116.30
AlliedBlend	715.05	723.45	731.95	739.00	720.25	1807.71	753.80	382.10	-	-
AllTimePlas	201.01	197.91	204.75	205.00	192.11	443.59	314.70	186.00	-	-
Alok Ind	7.50	7.22	7.44	7.45	7.18	12166.10	18.45	6.98	-	-
Alpine Texwo	49.06	48.36	49.88	49.88	48.00	212.83	105.00	48.00	-	-
Alufluoride	565.40	604.70	565.40	644.40	562.60	66.54	644.40	421.00	-	-
Amagi Media	575.65	560.00	578.00	579.85	558.50	197.96	727.40	310.20	-	-
AMAL.	674.40	665.55	672.00	690.00	636.05	29.99	822.00	636.05	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	791.95	774.95	792.00	794.60	772.65	361.59	1023.00	670.00	-	-
Amber	6960.00	6990.00	7001.50	7038.50	6880.00	124.12	8970.00	5404.00	167	6985.00
AMBIKA COTTO	1546.10	1568.00	1546.20	1584.40	1522.50	11.98	1928.50	1100.60	11	1580.30
Ambuja Cem [2]	383.80	374.35	383.80	383.80	374.00	1653.66	588.55	373.95	25	374.90
AmirChand Ja	209.47	201.09	209.54	212.07	200.00	462.37	212.07	117.02	-	-
Amrutanjan [1]	506.35	506.55	506.35	518.00	499.00	47.09	759.00	476.85	24	505.15
Anand RathiW	2126.80	2146.20	2145.10	2164.10	2112.00	394.04	3735.00	1710.60	-	-
AnandRathiS	496.90	500.60	496.00	509.00	488.45	258.88	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	617.40	607.95	615.00	619.80	601.80	1047.97	744.10	403.00	71	608.05
Anant Raj Gl	129.36	126.53	130.32	130.32	126.00	214.14	186.30	109.10	-	-
Andhra Paper	74.05	72.62	73.81	75.00	72.03	261.46	86.89	58.00	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	95.41	95.13	97.40	97.40	94.46	345.91	107.00	63.27	11	95.10
AngelOne	288.00	279.20	286.40	286.40	278.05	4741.37	2867.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	31.51	34.66	32.25	34.66	32.24	23572.27	172.75	12.91	-	-
ANNU PRO	49.33	47.86	49.30	49.82	47.30	1439.01	75.60	46.55	-	-
AntelopusSel	1261.70	1159.45	1260.00	1260.00	1120.85	1450.66	1290.90	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	873.60	851.10	868.00	875.60	849.00	503.13	977.55	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	378.35	367.65	378.00	378.05	365.00	78.19	605.00	337.55	-	-
Anuh Phar	90.42	89.46	89.05	92.50	88.80	105.11	99.50	67.00	-	-
Anup Engg	1677.10	1632.00	1683.20	1689.50	1626.00	21.18	2524.00	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1192.40	1187.10	1198.00	1198.00	1178.50	194.98	1415.00	1045.20	-	-
Apar Ind	17776.00	17263.00	17750.00	17770.00	17147.00	128.72	19269.20	6800.00	61	17272.05
Apcotex Ind [2]	599.40	586.00	599.40	599.40	583.55	68.00	712.45	310.15	19	586.35
Apex	347.60	338.65	345.25	346.10	336.30	99.91	514.20	218.80	21	339.45
APL Apollo [2]	2214.70	2197.00	2210.20	2210.20	2174.90	319.97	2300.90	1660.10	106	2200.00
APOLLO [1]	395.60	408.30	397.45	414.40	388.00	11506.53	466.70	180.80	118	408.30
Apollo Hosp. [5]	8889.00	8860.00	8889.00	8902.50	8804.00	429.43	9326.80	6680.00	81	8862.00
Apollo Pipes	511.45	521.20	511.00	526.85	503.50	321.45	668.80	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	400.10	389.60	396.10	398.40	388.30	453.77	540.30	365.35	13	389.65
Aptus V Hsg	244.60	237.47	244.00	244.00	237.00	710.15	332.00	193.03	-	-
Aqylon Nexus	18.56	18.00	18.93	19.38	17.72	419.47	2247.00	17.72	-	-
Archean Chem	482.55	482.75	482.90	484.90	471.85	188.12	704.25	446.00	-	-
Ardee Indus	51.66	51.99	51.46	52.50	50.49	3464.64	73.19	46.50	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	90.31	88.48	89.42	92.89	87.80	1424.66	106.20	45.16	-	-
Arih.Capital	93.34	89.81	93.34	93.97	89.05	314.06	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	140.29	132.61	140.22	140.22	132.00	1377.84	178.30	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	125.48	123.22	125.00	127.49	122.50	104.24	180.00	92.62	-	-
Arman Fin	1885.60	1700.10	1830.20	1835.90	1666.20	232.15	2159.10	1302.30	42	1699.85
Arrow green	905.80	891.85	900.00	905.35	876.00	23.33	950.00	342.00	23	893.65
Artemis Med	357.70	365.90	362.20	372.00	350.20	2092.32	378.80	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	417.20	413.75	412.80	416.30	410.00	98.85	572.20	366.60	398	413.25
Arvind Ltd	549.05	543.60	550.25	551.95	542.00	227.66	607.00	278.00	54	543.85
ArvindSmart	614.05	615.75	616.95	629.60	600.00	188.15	707.20	490.35	42	613.80
Asahi Ind. [1]	959.95	933.55	953.00	959.65	931.20	114.53	1072.95	775.05	55	932.80
Ashapura [2]	506.50	502.60	506.50	510.90	500.05	288.64	924.70	456.50	32	502.30
Ashok Leyl [1]	159.08	155.22	158.51	158.88	154.70	12214.13	215.35	134.20	24	155.40
Ashoka [5]	113.12	110.17	112.50	112.78	109.80	537.26	214.35	101.00	16	110.30
Asian Energy	487.75	474.15	490.45	495.90	472.00	295.54	565.70	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	50.69	50.16	50.65	50.67	49.96	662.07	79.08	42.50	-	50.09
Asian Paints [1]	2444.00	2420.00	2437.90	2441.60	2412.90	1097.75	2985.50	2116.00	49	2415.30
ASK Auto.	645.15	650.35	645.15	664.15	634.90	430.17	687.70	375.30	-	-
ASSET RECONS	144.49	142.71	143.40	144.78	140.38	1960.01	157.00	124.50	-	-
Asso Alcohol	644.95	641.55	644.95	667.00	638.00	42.49	1277.00	637.15	-	-
ASTECFE	739.00	711.80	740.00	740.10	706.25	27.96	936.00	512.35	-	711.70
ASTERDM	759.40	747.35	759.40	763.00	739.00	538.79	890.95	519.80	210	747.80
Astha Spint	72.72	39.30	37.03	39.95	37.03	2200.48	140.01	37.03	-	-
Astra Micro [2]	1622.40	1590.10	1622.40	1623.30	1585.00	117.34	1960.00	835.90	86	1590.15
Astral Poly [1]	1399.00	1370.50	1392.90	1392.90	1363.00	233.64	1767.95	1311.90	55	1367.95
Astrazeneca [2]	6505.00	6280.00	6477.00	6477.00	6262.00	10.12	9850.00	6267.25	90	6287.50
Atal RealTe	13.52	13.24	13.50	13.68	12.21	4337.17	36.70	12.21	-	-
AtherEnergy	1497.00	1454.90	1495.00	1520.00	1450.00	3051.40	1744.00	542.50	-	-
Atlanta Elec	1625.90	1613.30	1625.90	1625.90	1550.30	118.33	2152.60	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	448.25	440.55	450.45	450.50	438.25	39.66	596.65	381.00	22	440.85
ATUL.	6070.50	5991.00	6070.00	6070.00	5941.00	22.71	7198.20	5563.00	25	5992.85
AU SFB	1018.00	995.30	1015.20	1016.50	995.00	1347.71	1144.65	719.45	26	998.00
AUGMONT ENTE	877.90	965.65	899.00	965.65	896.00	979.64	1019.80	806.05	-	-
Aurionpro So	669.70	642.50	665.00	670.55	638.55	128.16	1247.15	638.85	32	642.55
Aurob Ph [1]	1712.00	1697.50	1712.00	1713.40	1686.80	657.59	1739.60	1066.00	38	1700.00
Authum Inv	559.60	548.25	555.90	556.95	541.60	112.05	3318.70	400.00	-	-
AUTOIND	81.73	81.86	81.89	84.78	80.42	142.00	103.85	48.41	15	82.00
Avadh Sugar	796.50	808.40	825.30	833.05	800.00	276.33	885.00	307.75	24	802.25
Avalon Tech	2328.50	2310.20	2328.10	2364.60	2296.00	134.42	2618.00	777.30	-	-
Avance Tech	0.81	0.86	0.82	0.89	0.81	12166.05	0.94	0.75	-	-
Avantel	155.94	151.37	155.94	155.94	150.68	866.61	215.00	117.05	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	753.15	741.50	753.10	756.95	739.00	145.61	1592.30	631.45	22	741.70
AvenueSai	15.89	15.41	15.93	15.99	15.36	6856.45	20.50	12.92	-	-
AVT Natur [1]	92.58	86.61	92.50	92.60	86.02	493.70	101.80	53.34	19	86.71
Awfis Space	257.20	250.20	256.85	259.75	249.65	394.02	639.40	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1222.40	1209.90	1211.50	1217.80	1205.00	4771.50	1418.30	1125.50	15	1211.00
AXISCADES [5]	1892.10	1879.50	1890.50	1943.30	1861.00	278.67	2210.00	1061.00	-	1884.40
Aye Finance [2]	167.25	162.49	168.70	168.70	160.41	747.88	197.95	160.45	21	162.65
AYM Syntex	293.95	291.15	290.00	297.50	285.95	52.09	330.00	144.35	91	291.30
Azad Engg	2728.00	2723.20	2740.00	2798.00	2673.10	439.19	2986.60	1360.00	-	-
Azad Ind Mob	87.03	82.30	88.00	89.98	80.00	76.82	98.99	70.41	-	-
B										
Baazar Style	375.80	394.50	383.80	394.55	383.75	4429.31	447.10	229.95	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	11281.00	11024.00	11250.00	11270.00	10953.00	241.33	12470.00	8490.10	28	11009.00
Bajaj Cons [1]	499.50	480.05	501.00	501.05	478.30	416.11	691.15	232.00	28	480.15
Bajaj Elect [2]	318.95	314.65	322.00	324.35	313.00	96.89	575.00	300.70	-	314.90
Bajaj Fin [1]	996.90	985.00	990.00	992.30	974.00	7707.44	1177.60	788.40	34	985.00
Bajaj Finser [1]	1771.00	1752.00	1767.00	1769.00	1739.10	536.95	2194.65	1598.15	126	1750.00
Bajaj HCare	344.15	336.60	346.35	346.35	335.00	65.71	509.90	272.35	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	20.78	20.45	20.75	21.05	20.28	13924.73	26.00	14.89	-	20.47
Bajaj Holdng	10940.00	10800.00	10925.00	10940.00	10791.00	31.44	13245.00	8597.50	40	10849.60
Bajaj HsgFin	83.14	82.52	83.14	83.14	82.00	2875.73	113.45	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	173.14	169.47	171.39	172.00	168.97	75.01	219.64	135.10	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	2189.60	2153.90	2194.90	2194.90	2136.00	82.30	2627.95	905.15	35	2159.70
Balkrish Ind [2]	2185.30	2153.80	2177.00	2178.60	2148.00	74.32	2775.00	1971.50	30	2153.65
Balmer LawIn	66.61	65.56	66.85	66.88	65.40	83.27	79.50	65.16	-	-
BalmerLawrie	164.16	162.48	164.16	164.79	162.30	52.44	213.00	148.35	11	162.30
BalramChini [1]	685.80	680.70	691.00	705.35	672.30	1951.67	781.00	393.40	42	681.30
Balu Forge	506.80	495.10	506.85	507.05	491.90	359.23	678.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	599.85	594.20	600.15	605.00	589.70	67.20	879.60	503.00	20	593.40
Bandhan Bk	187.70	181.00	187.00	187.00	180.60	8979.77	220.70	134.30	22	181.50
Bank of Maha	84.88	80.85	84.50	84.50	80.49	16655.52	94.50	53.92	8	80.75
Bansal Wire	321.40	317.60	322.15	335.00	310.60	326.45	370.00	222.50	-	-
BASF India	3539.80	3495.80	3539.80	3580.00	3482.10	16.97	4821.00	2906.90	24	3493.40
Bata India [5]	629.80	624.70	631.50	633.70	621.00	118.58	1236.85	605.55	46	625.60
Bayer Crop	3717.60	3671.80	3714.90	3714.90	3650.00	55.29	5133.00	3645.40	22	3672.15
BCL Ind.	33.72	32.52	33.40	33.71	32.35	450.98	42.08	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1140.00	1115.00	1140.00	1140.90	1110.30	1314.08	1633.15	1090.00	78	1113.90
Behari Lal	456.75	445.10	452.95	456.25	440.00	262.97	548.00	415.00	-	-
Belrise Inds	247.92	248.62	248.00	254.28	244.24	4151.64	268.20	142.59	-	-
BEML [5]	2036.50	1995.10	2030.00	2035.00	1974.00	214.13	2276.75	1361.10	90	1997.10
BergerPaints [1]	458.35	452.85	458.00	458.85	450.30	354.79	594.20	391.50	45	453.05
Beta Drugs	2098.70	2040.30	2080.00	2100.00	2020.00	12.98	2807.90	990.10	-	-
BF UTILI [5]	524.45	515.90	526.90	529.60	511.10	52.70	834.00	369.00	-	515.90
BHAGIL [5]	394.60	380.85	397.00	397.00	370.10	237.20	397.40	128.15	22	382.05
Bhagynagar [2]	425.55	411.35	446.00	446.00	407.10	133.83	469.80	92.00	-	411.60
BHANSALI [1]	126.43	125.38	126.46	127.90	124.00	793.82	138.50	75.52	16	125.10
BHARAT BI [5]	2162.90	2112.20	2162.00	2165.70	2105.10	14.77	3403.40	2009.45	21	2113.25
Bharat Elect [1]	393.55	385.50	393.45	393.45	384.10	11661.37	473.25	380.35	46	386.00
Bharat Forge [2]	2008.00	1957.00	1980.10	1994.50	1951.20	583.09	2293.00	1182.60	78	1954.00
Bharat Paren	1898.00	2149.80	2093.00	2277.60	2001.00	155.53	2277.60	1125.70	-	-
Bharat Ra [5]	1096.80	1046.20	1102.20	1102.20	1027.80	26.01	3030.25	1035.75	12	1045.35
Bharat Wire	164.97	166.35	163.99	171.50	162.60	282.16	262.20	149.15	17	166.70
BharatCoking	32.03	32.51	32.60	33.45	32.28	13761.89	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	214.09	212.45	214.09	214.24	209.00	47.09	263.18	133.60	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1785.40	1771.40	1772.00	1784.30	1763.70	4683.54	2174.70	1745.00	64	1771.80
Bharti Hexa	1481.80	1426.50	1475.20	1476.20	1422.00	85.87	1955.60	1422.00	-	-
BHEL [2]	418.95	411.90	416.85	416.85	407.25	7754.93	446.75	229.70	59	412.00
Bikaji Fds	573.95	557.90	570.70	570.70	555.25	56.34	768.50	532.75	-	-
Billionbrain	187.06	183.39	186.75	186.79	182.40	16299.71	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	382.15	374.90	380.65	381.15	374.05	2233.04	447.00	337.20	203	375.00
BIRLA CORPN.	850.30	839.10	850.70	852.35	835.00	26.95	1345.00	773.90	26	838.80
Birla Eric	362.45	351.40	365.05	369.70	348.00	274.08	418.00	104.00	23	351.45
Birlanu Ltd	1438.80	1441.00	1438.80	1511.90	1408.10	21.22	1999.00	1190.10	-	-
Birlasoft	274.05	271.25	274.55	275.90	270.00	1023.07	474.00	270.00	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	235.26	227.50	234.99	234.99	227.50	7031.45	325.55	227.50	6	227.90
Bk of India	137.94	129.99	137.50	137.50	129.31	10521.21	178.45	116.35	5	130.45
Black Box	799.75	783.15	800.00	811.50	775.55	608.54	1103.00	444.30	-	-
BLS [1]	224.26	221.22	223.50	223.71	221.00	486.20	358.90	218.45	62	221.20
BLS e-Svc	324.55	320.65	324.50	327.70	319.85	163.64	339.80	124.30	-	-
Blue CloudSo	22.16	21.71	22.45	23.96	21.26	25113.79	24.50	18.85	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	570.65	557.30	565.50	573.70	554.50	194.89	692.90	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1565.00	1575.40	1585.70	1593.50	1562.30	1477.34	2032.00	1432.00	90	1575.00
BlueDart Exp	4746.50	4749.60	4725.00	4795.00	4705.00	6.18	7030.15	4630.50	36	4740.40
BluestoneJew	809.30	786.20	810.00	814.00	775.50	978.97	969.90	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	145.12	149.44	145.12	151.90	138.43	690.63	151.90	43.98	-	-
Bodal Chem [2]	202.02	201.93	202.50	207.70	196.00	1094.10	207.45	41.25	39	201.50
Bom Dyeing [2]	109.83	107.39	109.70	109.70	107.00	244.07	180.55	92.10	105	107.60
BombayBu [2]	1435.20	1415.70	1435.20	1435.30	1412.10	30.40	2135.00	1301.00	123	1415.80
Borosil	264.80	280.80	275.00	283.76	269.00	1497.36	363.40	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	455.15	452.25	455.45	462.65	449.90	308.63	721.00	374.40	-	-
Bosch Home	1811.60	1802.40	1841.20	1865.40	1788.10	62.66	1891.30	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	48250.00	47020.00	48010.00	48010.00	46910.00	15.21	49629.50	28650.05	59	47199.95
BPCL	308.50	302.25	306.95	308.50	301.00	2813.27	391.85	266.55	9	302.00
BPL	44.98	46.41	45.89	50.60	44.78	248.46	86.30	38.00	-	46.44
BrainbeesSol	180.83	184.72	181.80	195.30	178.19	38456.79	389.65	163.37	-	-
Brigade	597.90	583.90	600.00	600.85	580.35	174.68	801.56	461.25	54	584.00
BrigadeHotel	56.13	55.52	56.13	56.59	55.25	60.71	87.79	54.36	-	-
BrightcomGr [2]	9

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
OPTIEMUS	758.55	809.95	761.30	828.90	754.00	3028.58	850.05	289.90	391	810.50
ORACLE FIN [5]	10770.00	10800.00	10749.00	10910.00	10599.00	194.83	12412.90	6232.20	26	10839.85
Orchid Phr	1064.90	1023.40	1064.90	1075.65	1015.00	60.17	1143.50	480.00	-	-
ORIENT CEM [1]	122.16	119.43	121.75	122.84	119.11	462.60	226.90	119.15	12	119.40
Orient Elec.	162.26	160.00	161.10	162.26	158.98	166.21	217.51	149.05	-	-
Orient Hotel [1]	140.93	138.03	142.11	142.11	137.50	670.77	148.95	80.50	33	138.00
Orient Rail	121.12	126.15	122.33	127.90	119.25	74.81	142.00	102.80	-	-
Orient Tech.	237.30	233.81	234.31	237.57	233.10	69.75	513.40	220.80	-	-
Orient.Aroma	533.65	553.15	533.45	558.00	521.80	99.97	570.00	228.00	-	-
Orkla India	555.95	554.30	554.90	559.75	547.05	52.24	760.00	533.25	-	-
OswalPumps	274.95	268.55	273.00	273.60	267.85	256.61	790.00	266.45	-	-
P										
P&G Health	5406.00	5399.50	5400.00	5490.00	5300.00	9.83	6975.00	4707.00	-	-
Pace Digitek	166.35	161.81	166.00	167.00	161.00	548.30	231.95	139.81	-	-
Page Ind	37695.00	37500.00	37350.00	37680.00	37280.00	15.74	43823.90	29800.00	54	37500.00
Pakka	75.06	73.77	77.28	77.28	73.00	82.40	160.30	69.10	-	-
Panacea Bio [1]	372.60	366.45	374.60	374.60	364.30	47.47	647.50	293.10	-	367.75
Panama [2]	473.40	467.35	473.40	483.40	463.30	97.08	600.00	229.00	8	467.40
Panoram Stud	60.46	59.25	61.25	64.80	56.34	3225.06	64.80	40.00	-	-
ParadeepPhos	155.49	155.70	155.50	157.07	153.40	1861.37	201.99	99.70	-	-
Parag Milk	268.90	274.95	269.00	276.55	260.05	2359.33	377.20	178.35	23	275.00
PARAMOUN [2]	59.81	56.35	58.81	59.80	55.73	1945.98	75.57	28.40	30	56.39
Paras Defen	1321.00	1315.00	1320.90	1332.80	1287.00	626.02	1585.00	580.50	-	-
PARIN ENTERP	736.80	720.10	767.00	767.00	703.00	78.72	789.00	703.00	-	-
Park Hotels	104.90	103.57	103.76	106.30	102.00	449.14	158.36	95.10	-	-
Park MediWo	286.35	276.50	283.70	287.75	275.70	352.76	305.00	138.10	-	-
PashupatiCot	79.69	77.27	80.15	80.15	77.00	61.85	1036.40	67.75	-	-
Pasupati Acr	75.87	72.45	75.87	76.44	71.47	225.19	81.29	40.41	-	-
Patanjali Fd	403.95	390.80	400.50	403.05	385.20	3491.54	614.05	328.20	-	-
Patel engg [1]	27.61	26.90	27.54	27.54	26.82	1329.63	38.52	22.08	7	26.89
Paushak	667.15	655.75	654.15	662.30	639.85	34.17	826.75	342.50	-	-
PayTM	1674.00	1635.80	1668.00	1678.10	1625.70	4017.70	1855.50	930.60	-	-
PB Fintech	1166.00	1151.30	1180.00	1213.50	1136.10	10839.19	1964.20	1115.00	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	14.11	13.52	14.55	14.64	13.46	404984.64	14.87	7.45	-	13.52
PCBL	339.60	332.55	338.15	339.60	329.90	905.37	394.00	226.50	-	-
PDS	357.65	349.50	355.00	359.15	347.90	103.41	418.50	246.05	-	-
PENNAR IND [5]	184.90	182.17	185.00	190.00	181.50	1179.46	279.80	128.90	25	182.10
PERSISTENT [5]	5372.00	5328.50	5372.00	5377.50	5285.00	335.53	6597.00	4242.65	48	5321.00
Petronet LNG	286.50	289.85	286.95	293.05	285.75	2937.41	326.40	235.45	10	289.50
Pfizer Ltd.	4000.80	3968.00	4001.00	4028.90	3952.00	21.09	5561.55	3924.90	24	3967.70
PG Electro [1]	518.50	507.00	521.00	521.00	505.10	505.90	644.90	436.85	132	507.00
PGIL [5]	1329.10	1296.10	1329.10	1357.90	1288.80	208.61	1356.55	605.50	207	1297.55
Phoenix Mill [2]	1978.40	1952.20	1973.10	1973.10	1940.10	154.65	2168.65	1465.30	223	1945.55
PhysicsWall	134.36	128.07	133.75	134.19	126.41	7121.68	161.99	77.72	-	-
PI INDUS. [1]	2400.00	2349.00	2398.40	2398.40	2318.50	113.05	3829.90	2193.60	25	2342.50
PiccadilyAgr	613.00	600.50	610.35	611.20	598.70	74.50	809.70	515.00	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1517.20	1503.00	1508.00	1508.00	1486.80	585.75	1707.95	1259.45	60	1499.05
Pine Labs	176.57	173.02	176.97	177.08	170.61	23290.19	284.00	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	2142.70	2149.00	2142.00	2170.00	2054.90	328.99	2326.40	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	210.31	206.59	209.90	212.32	205.21	2664.80	231.93	132.30	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	1162.40	1136.80	1171.40	1171.40	1130.00	71.44	1228.15	677.20	42	1135.60
Pix Transm	1734.80	1724.80	1733.00	1748.70	1711.60	7.44	2089.00	1252.00	-	-
PLASTIBL [5]	202.99	199.86	209.00	209.00	199.00	99.55	215.95	121.00	12	199.50
PN Gadgil Jw	605.50	585.35	617.00	617.80	582.00	751.32	736.40	503.00	-	-
Pnb Gilts	74.73	73.28	74.25	76.00	71.35	295.14	101.45	58.75	13	72.84
PNB Housng	1094.90	1085.00	1086.00	1098.10	1065.40	988.33	1210.80	730.00	12	1081.70
PNC Infra [2]	135.45	131.26	135.96	138.40	130.10	1951.75	310.60	116.25	6	130.75
PNGS Reva Di	524.85	506.05	528.40	531.00	502.45	116.71	644.00	324.25	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	728.95	718.15	728.85	734.45	714.10	38.60	1147.35	692.55	-	718.20
Poly Medicu [5]	1724.40	1636.70	1724.40	1724.40	1611.20	216.87	2093.95	1184.00	49	1636.50
Polycab Ind.	8408.50	8191.00	8400.00	8400.00	8180.00	274.84	10126.00	6663.00	-	-
Polyplex	1086.20	1063.10	1086.20	1090.00	1055.00	30.72	1267.75	743.00	67	1064.05
PonawallaFin	461.55	445.15	461.55	461.80	442.05	1095.56	570.40	361.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	466.80	452.65	468.95	470.00	450.00	274.09	1619.00	427.60	-	-
Ponni Sug(er	399.80	390.00	400.80	411.00	384.00	53.91	454.20	253.50	11	390.25
Power Finan	338.00	330.00	338.30	338.55	329.05	10003.10	486.45	329.05	5	330.15
Power grid	269.50	261.85	269.90	269.90	261.85	10278.46	324.80	250.05	16	262.20
Power Instru	100.47	96.00	100.47	101.00	95.15	102.15	189.70	88.05	-	-
Power Trad	155.09	154.88	155.50	155.79	154.20	1099.04	229.40	149.90	13	154.90
Powerica Ltd	582.95	562.95	584.55	594.25	555.00	142.64	676.95	365.10	-	-
POWERMECH	2407.30	2364.30	2401.20	2401.20	2355.40	24.45	3008.85	1718.00	22	2360.20
Praj Ind.Ltd [2]	315.90	311.95	315.55	315.65	310.40	307.50	427.75	273.05	41	311.60
Prakash Ind.	118.81	115.68	118.81	119.89	114.20	596.57	173.30	110.00	7	115.70
PRANAV CO	100.64	101.39	100.50	103.40	96.49	4417.06	165.10	96.49	-	-
PRASOL CH	756.00	763.80	758.70	773.90	731.00	479.42	773.90	601.00	-	-
Precam	120.66	116.78	120.79	120.79	116.00	102.69	208.00	104.05	31	116.95
Precision Wr [1]	502.60	480.65	500.00	500.00	472.70	492.67	524.00	181.60	50	480.65
Premier Enr	896.40	906.00	892.00	912.70	883.00	1041.47	1134.00	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	680.35	677.05	680.35	680.35	671.55	383.78	829.95	378.80	106	677.00
prestige Est	1477.80	1470.80	1465.20	1470.80	1437.40	576.98	1804.65	1090.45	349	1452.45
Pricol Ltd [1]	759.40	753.10	759.40	764.45	751.10	193.30	822.35	500.30	42	752.15
Prime Focus [1]	315.45	315.20	316.50	328.00	313.25	3939.21	367.25	161.05	-	315.50
Primo Chemic	25.28	28.13	26.00	29.80	25.80	4154.95	29.80	16.10	-	-
Prince Pipe	261.80	257.75	262.00	263.95	255.45	104.95	352.20	205.00	-	-
PRIORITY J	311.73	300.93	314.01	326.00	296.50	479.44	329.55	209.61	-	-
Prism Cement	116.31	115.15	116.75	118.20	114.94	245.70	165.80	97.70	57	115.30
Pritika Auto	17.16	18.87	18.00	18.98	17.35	1141.26	20.99	10.41	-	-
Privi Speclt	3594.10	3605.30	3637.20	3637.20	3556.20	81.99	3785.30	2339.50	-	-
Procter&Gam	7037.50	6888.50	7049.00	7112.00	6875.00	22.68	14493.15	6875.00	28	6888.60
ProstarmInfo	141.17	136.33	142.90	142.90	136.00	248.18	208.70	114.64	-	-
Protean EGov	690.70	691.50	690.70	719.00	675.00	2689.44	909.50	444.00	-	-
Prozone Rlty	56.75	56.26	57.84	57.99	55.59	940.01	72.77	39.55	-	-
Prudent Corp	3097.90	3171.30	3060.70	3186.90	3038.80	27.08	4105.50	2121.00	-	-
PSPPROJECT	806.65	779.10	806.65	806.65	775.00	74.34	1142.00	569.30	46	778.30
PTC Ind.	21810.00	21685.00	21820.00	22040.00	21510.00	8.45	24125.00	14499.00	-	-
PTCFIN SER	26.37	27.12	26.37	29.60	26.20	39757.23	40.51	23.78	8	27.07
Pudumjee [1]	94.47	93.78	95.23	96.67	93.00	153.45	127.00	63.11	10	93.89
Punjab Na [2]	116.60	112.60	116.55	116.55	112.07	14250.16	135.15	98.50	6	112.50
PUNJABNSIND	21.82	21.31	21.82	21.82	21.26	806.11	32.47	20.46	11	21.30
Puravankara [5]	213.87	209.99	212.40	212.65	209.00	73.43	288.65	160.00	32	209.65
PURPLE STYLE	545.55	517.85	538.70	539.95	510.20	48.71	588.90	501.05	-	-
PVP Ven	61.94	58.85	58.85	59.99	58.85	1150.59	72.16	23.10	52	58.94
PVR Inox	1254.60	1225.00	1252.00	1257.40	1219.00	396.42	1357.80	907.40	-	-
Q										
Quadrant Fut	547.50	531.50	537.00	564.90	527.60	1323.80	564.90	248.55	-	-
QualityPower	1517.80	1592.70	1517.00	1593.60	1496.20	365.36	1593.60	581.00	-	-
QUESS	340.90	340.90	342.00	350.00	335.30	675.13	386.35	166.05	21	341.00
Quickheal	147.04	143.40	147.05	147.05	141.52	83.33	371.00	125.00	-	143.00
R										
RaceEcoCh	117.90	121.70	118.01	128.00	118.01	104.61	240.00	84.11	-	-
RACL Geartch	1686.50	1613.10	1696.00	1696.00	1601.20	29.36	1927.70	921.80	-	-
Radiant CMS	35.67	35.70	35.85	36.00	34.90	219.66	57.49	32.33	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	4557.10	4478.30	4545.00	4550.70	4452.50	127.71	4747.95	2504.60	85	4483.95
Raghav Prod.	1699.50	1703.90	1689.00	1729.50	1659.30	54.97	1943.70	561.30	-	-
Rail Tel	260.15	256.15	264.10	265.30	255.05	453.40	400.80	245.00	-	-
RAIN [2]	219.35	215.45	219.00	219.00	210.10	2291.72	251.95	99.85	-	215.85
Rainbow Ch.	1374.20	1372.60	1374.20	1384.10	1347.60	145.80	1610.00	1084.00	-	-
Rajputa Sta	183.46	167.41	182.41	182.41	165.92	799.19	202.22	101.70	-	-
Rajratan Glo	472.50	460.95	472.50	472.50	458.00	49.99	563.95	305.55	-	-
Rallis India [1]	200.38	199.42	200.30	200.50	198.14	469.01	315.50	197.00	17	199.75
Ram Ratna Wr	570.00	568.20	577.40	584.00	559.75	244.15	669.20	268.00	-	-
Ramco Systm	580.20	563.80	580.00	582.45	560.00	33.61	968.20	342.50	70	565.40
Ramco Cem [1]	867.55	848.65	867.55	869.75	845.70	76.18	1214.00	838.40	107	847.75
Ramco Inds. [1]	319.95	310.90	316.10	319.00	306.45	80.80	395.80	230.70	21	310.80
Rane Holdi	1580.60	1584.40	1580.60	1607.70	1534.50	18.62	1897.90	982.05	26	1580.15
RANE MADRAS	1322.30	1325.90	1328.90	1359.90	1302.60	46.93	1439.45	612.50	29	1325.45
Rashi Perip.	893.00	883.95	893.00	893.00	866.20	253.61	967.70	313.05	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	108.58	109.95	109.51	110.80	106.70	2259.91	157.40	106.10	14	109.95
RatanindiaEn	26.96	26.20	26.91	26.95	26.10	934.64	54.50	24.40	-	-
Rategain Tr.	827.75	828.70	827.00	834.00	814.05	175.71	1050.00	437.00	-	-
Ratnamn [2]	2778.30	2748.40	2756.10	2784.00	2724.10	20.54	3342.35	1900.05	55	2743.10
Ratnaveer Pr	333.95	330.95	335.70	340.45	329.00	5822.74	343.75	130.50	-	-
Ravindra Enr	148.77	148.07	149.99	150.51	145.65	84.19	196.45	117.07	-	-
Raymond	1196.65	1179.95	1193.75	1236.00	1142.00	4864.23	1235.75	320.40	-	1179.40
Raymond Life	687.60	672.00	686.00	689.15	665.15	219.83	1246.40	628.25	-	-
RaymondReal	711.30	672.95	712.50	712.50	668.20	1674.91	741.95	349.00	-	-
RAYS OF BELIEF	232.85	223.01	233.80	235.01	221.10	97.67	239.00	208.03	-	-
RBLBank	415.05	407.00	412.00	413.85	404.30	1955.37	429.55	261.70	72	405.60
RECLTD	312.95	303.25	310.10	311.60	303.25	6245.56	390.40	303.50	5	303.50
Redington [2]	407.25	404.85	407.00	409.75	399.10	4235.91	419.55	191.25	23	404.60
Redtape	121.05	119.97	121.00	121.05	117.01	333.31	158.99	107.53	-	-
Refex Refrig [2]	285.80	275.80	287.90	287.90	274.10	197.66	382.05	188.00	13	276.15
RegaalResour	89.98	88.56	89.98	90.74	86.60	330.99	103.00	57.27	-	-
Relax Foot [1]	297.00	290.75	299.00	299.00	290.00	113.00	473.00	236.55	39	290.85
Reli Indlnf	694.55	685.60	704.00	704.00	680.00	50.45	963.65	620.50	100	685.35
Reliance	1226.00	1197.60	1218.00	1219.70	1197.00	13602.35	1611.20	1196.05	41	1198.50
Religare ent	242.27	234.32	242.00	242.00	233.05	222.63	284.85	197.00	-	234.80
Remsons Ind [2]	116.80	120.39	122.29	130.00	116.00	1550.40	152.40	75.36	32	120.15
Renaiss.Glo	167.47	163.23	166.77	166.90	161.70	337.48	173.80	85.00	-	-
RENTOMOJO	507.75	491.35	506.90	506.90	487.70	1705.72	581.95	482.45	-	-
REPCO HOME	347.70	346.75	345.00	348.80	340.00	82.57	455.40	333.90	5	344.90
Repro Ind	288.25	333.80	301.00	345.90	301.00	416.77	596.00	277.55	-	333.30
Respon Ind [1]	161.23	161.60	161.24	165.00	157.51	712.57	242.25	117.80	-	161.95
RestaurBrand	92.51	91.61	93.61	94.49	91.10	2484.46	111.15	57.15	-	-
Rhetan TMT L	15.17	15.91	14.43	15.92	14.42	66655.76	34.87	14.42	-	-
RHI Magnesit	386.45	386.60	387.50	391.65	380.10	431.64	508.30	323.05	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	132.23	127.36	132.00	132.23	127.10	579.32	157.90	78.10	62	127.40
RIR Power El	188.01	186.21	188.03	188.94	183.01	596.77	213.94	154.00	-	-
Rishabh Ins	711.80	713.50	717.30	733.25	701.10	110.95	852.00	315.00	-	-
Ritco Logi.	285.70	277.20	286.00	286.00	274.10	62.16	331.15	167.10	-	-
RITES	199.31	196.11	199.00	199.21	195.01	286.38	259.30	175.10	23	196.15
RK Forgings [2]	704.50	703.10	701.20	715.45	690.15	773.08	772.40	460.15	105	702.50
RMC Switch	219.89	208.96	219.79	219.79	208.00	25.84	530.00	194.10	-	-
Rolex Rings	195.35	193.45	197.87	198.45	190.51	3173.76	1423.10	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	444.20	440.40	445.00	445.25	435.95	33.65	690.30	375.00	-	-
Rossell Tech	1402.70	1398.80	1405.00	1410.80	1342.20	151.25	1505.00	551.90	-	-
Roto Pumps	62.80	62.55	62.52	64.50	62.12	326.14	80.77	47.50	-	-
Route Mobile	463.00	453.45	463.00	464.40	452.00	137.36	819.75	410.70	-	-
RPG lifesc [8]	3050.60	2955.10	3055.00	3087.90	2930.70	46.17	3130.50	1731.25	42	2952.80
RPOWER	20.57	19.96	20.50	20.56	19.80	15330.99	50.70	19.80	-	19.96
RPSG Vent.	837.30	842.05	848.00	858.95	833.00	50.60	1179.00	551.90	-	-
RR Kabel	2528.30	2459.80	2530.40	2536.50	2445.20	140.72	2983.80	1181.60	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	235.62	275.21	250.00	282.74	245.45	61311.13	446.55	213.50	14	277.60
RTNPOWER	7.00	6.86	7.04	7.04	6.85	13063.78	11.94	6.85	-	6.87
Rubicon Rese	1676.30	1592.80	1676.30	1685.90	1575.10	215.21	1899.00	570.75	-	-
RUBY MILLS [5]	491.85	510.60	492.10	522.00	486.80	95.95	521.15	169.65	39	512.95
RUPA & CO [1]	136.07	132.75	135.60	135.60	132.00	109.41	209.60	109.50	13	132.75
RVNL	207.00	202.75	206.06	206.38	202.00	2550.02	400.70	195.15	-	-
S										
S&W Solar	176.65	170.74	175.52	175.91	169.50	902.42	260.80	148.00	-	-
SaatvikGreen	427.45	422.40	424.05	430.00	417.65	87.17	567.00	328.00	-	-
Safari Ind	1464.20	1453.20	1464.00	1474.80	1436.00	23.26	2507.10	1363.10	-	-
Sagility Ind	44.69	43.45	45.00	45.00	43.32	8041.93	57.89	35.83	-	-
Sai Life Sci	1592.20	1582.80	1600.20	1611.10	1564.10	273.97	1697.00	783.85	-	-
Sai Parenter	503.95	509.95	507.60	518.00	492.10	95.53	706.00	400.00	-	-
Sai Silks	77.19	78.14	76.20	79.64	76.20	691.74	223.03	76.20	-	-
Sakar Health	1135.85	1089.65	1136.00	1146.00	1075.00	99.94	1229.85	345.50	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	141.52	141.81	142.47	144.00	141.00	166.03	222.50	108.00	22	141.65
SALASAR [1]	4.70	4.51	4.70	4.76	4.45	6415.03	11.53	4.50	-	4.51
SALSTEEL	93.60	93.03	96.00	96.90	90.25	1006.26	97.90	26.11	-	93.20
Salzer Elec	541.25	535.55	536.05	539.10	527.55	26.26	953.30	488.65	21	536.00
SambhvStee	159.12	154.00	159.97	162.15	153.00	3011.72	162.15	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	159.19	150.16	154.05	155.98	149.70	1467.90	217.30	127.00	-	-
Samman Cap.	140.61	138.82	140.61	141.00	138.48	2900.13	192.95	129.00	-	-
Samvard.Moth	165.71	162.37	165.00	165.49	161.30	9738.84	173.27	101.01	-	-
Sanathan Tex	523.20	517.55	526.00	530.35	515.00	74.28	544.30	352.60	-	-
Sandhar	574.00	576.55	570.10	585.70	568.30	117.49	764.10	423.90	19	577.30
Sandur Mang.	184.79	181.51	186.09	186.40	180.50	530.23	273.00	160.80	-	-
Sangam India	619.90	629.30	622.00	634.00	609.05	89.48	675.95	391.50	25	628.50
Sanghvi M [1]	456.00	444.30	458.90	460.05	442.45	182.96	532.40	221.00	24	444.40
Sanofi Cons.	3945.30	3976.20	3964.70	3997.50	3834.90	8.70	5255.00	3834.90	-	-
Sanofi ind	3140.20	3103.50	3143.40	3149.90	3075.00	15.03	4896.00	3050.00	21	3103.15
Sansera Engg	4662.40	4457.20	4660.70	4662.10	4436.00	272.71	4743.50	1364.20	-	-
Sanstar	108.42	106.90	108.74	110.00	106.12	176.71	137.49	74.30	-	-
Sapphire Fd	223.61	216.68	223.00	223.00	214.61	398.45	310.50	139.91	-	-
SaraswatiSDL	73.31	81.52	77.50	86.00	76.00	1315.52	90.69	46.15	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	493.15	501.30	494.05	504.20	485.10	558.29	624.00	452.75	20	501.25
Saregama (I) [1]	496.90	489.60	496.85	496.90	487.05	136.80	574.85	305.65	40	489.55
SarveshwarFd	3.53	3.49	3.59	3.63	3.46	1786.99	6.64	2.50	-	-
SASKEN COMM	1691.10	1658.20	1700.00	1711.10	1650.20	17.18	2785.05	993.05	29	1662.10
Satia Ind.	67.00	68.10	66.50	68.99	66.13	191.67	83.80	50.80	-	-
SATIN	236.65	234.40	237.91	239.39	229.01	331.80	274.20	136.25	7	233.90
Saurash.Cem.	55.72	53.35	56.25	56.25	53.15	136.00	72.46	51.40	-	-
SBC Exports	53.02	53.54	53.50	56.90	53.06	22177.25	56.90	21.15	-	-
SBFC Fin.	88.86	86.82	89.00	89.30	86.40	944.83	123.00	79.60	-	-
SBI FUNDS M	531.15	522.90	531.00	531.15	521.05	837.58	624.95	521.05	-	-
SBILIFE	1742.00	1728.10	1742.00	1752.80	1725.00	1337.51	2132.90	1653.00	67	1728.45
SChand Co [5]	145.18	144.65	147.90	150.00	141.11	45.04	202.10	128.00	49	144.65
SchlossBanga	546.15	547.90	546.15	555.00	536.15	378.36	582.85	384.50	-	-
SCHNEIDER [2]	1209.50	1188.20	1209.50	1209.50	1180.90	136.10	1548.30	572.60	147	1187.05
ScodaTubes	136.61	130.53	137.60	137.60	129.03	414.83	181.48	110.00	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	89.02	79.60	87.01	88.71	73.42	37593.06	94.84	30.00	29	79.65
Sedemac Mech	3444.90	3547.80	3445.00	3595.00	3370.00	659.24	3595.00	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	331.10	318.30	331.10	331.10	310.15	2646.41	430.00	276.00	-	-
Senores Phar	1355.20	1351.80	1349.80	1374.70	1340.00	122.01	1599.00	662.45	-	-
SEPC	5.12	4.96	5.12	5.14	4.92	8906.29	12.24	4.65	-	-
Servote.Pwr	70.76	72.34	70.25	72.99	69.51	650.38	141.50	57.51	-	-
Seshaasai Te	381.85	370.35	377.00	381.15	365.05	99.82	437.45	209.11	-	-
SFL [5]	634.60	629.30	640.00	642.40	623.00	112.03	832.00	460.75	45	629.00
SG Mart L	731.00	729.50	725.05	746.00	720.00	121.00	860.60	313.10	-	-
SGFinservLt	609.70	589.75	605.15	609.70	585.25	167.60	727.45	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	23.31	22.91	23.50	23.84	22.78	145721.18	31.75	21.06	-	22.91
Shadowfax Te	282.45	274.05	283.90	283.90	272.55	1972.47	292.20	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	3142.30	3033.50	3149.90	3159.10	3022.20	116.00	3615.20	1770.90	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	466.90	465.15	463.75	473.80	459.00	399.43	838.45	455.50	30	465.50
SHALBY	147.12	143.25	146.50	146.99	142.15	66.37	271.45	125.70	14	143.45
Shank Jewel	91.36	90.42	91.35	94.55	89.97	3144.31	115.90	87.25	-	-
Shankara Bui	1276.10	1256.70	1281.30	1281.30	1250.00	69.12	1380.00	636.00	-	-
Shanti Gear [1]	666.55	633.30	666.55	669.80	633.25	55.36	741.80	385.70	72	635.20
ShantiGoIInt	325.68	308.